The Sunday EXPRESS

NEW DELHI,
OCTOBER 11, 2026
LATE CITY
16+4 PAGES
₹7.00
(₹8 RAIPUR,
₹15 SRINAGAR)



EYE

That Holiday Dish

Manish Mehrotra prepares a no-onion, no-garlic chole bhature from his childhood and tells us why he rarely cooks a recipe straight off a page

DEVOTED TO DANCE Kathak exponent Roshan Kumari, part of celebrated trinity of Sitara Devi and Damayanti Joshi, died this week

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA



Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA



Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister



NADA HABBA
MYSURU DASARA 2026
11-21 October

GRAND INAUGURATION
OF MYSURU DASARA 2026

With the Agra Puja of Nada Devate Sri Chamundeshwari Devi

In the Auspicious Presence and Inauguration by
His Holiness Sri Abhinava Gavisiddheshwara Mahaswamiji
Sri Gavi Matha, Koppal

Date: 11 October 2026, Sunday

Shubha Muhurta:
Between 11:50 AM and 12:13 PM, during the auspicious Dhanu Lagna

Venue: Sri Chamundeshwari Devi Temple,
Chamundi Hills, Mysuru

MYSURU DASARA – BHUVANA SUNDARA
Witness the timeless grandeur of Dasara in the Palace City

"To protect and respect our vibrant culture and tradition,"
is a Fundamental Duty of every citizen. This is affirmed by our Constitution.

CMofKarnataka https://dipr.karnataka.gov.in/ Karnatakavarthe karnataka information

THE SUNDAY EXPRESS

The World

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 11, 2026

GIFTS TO PUTIN WILL NOT BRING PEACE OR ANY BENEFIT TO THE CIVILIZED WORLD, SAYS ZELENSKYY

Trump says Russia to supply diesel to US and global markets

Moscow to supply 300,000 tonnes of diesel now, more later, says President

Reuters
Washington, October 10

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Friday that Russia had agreed to supply diesel to global markets in an effort to lower fuel prices, and his administration temporarily lifted US sanctions on Russian fuel that were designed to deprive Moscow of revenues for its war on Ukraine.

Prices for diesel, used for agriculture, heating homes and trucking, are near a record and risk for Trump's fellow Republicans ahead of the November 3 congressional elections that will determine whether they maintain thin control of Congress. Diesel prices fell after the announcement, but analysts said the deal may not be enough to keep them down.

Trump said on social media he had a "highly successful" discussion with President Vladimir Putin in which they agreed that Russia will immediately supply more than 300,000 metric tons of diesel to US and global markets, equal to about 2.25 million barrels of fuel. The US exports about 1.5 million barrels of diesel per day.



President Donald Trump with President Vladimir Putin at a press meet in Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson in Anchorage, Alaska. FILE

After the call, an envoy for Putin, Kirill Dmitriev, praised cooperation between Russia and the US in a post on X. Dmitriev asked US officials during his visit to Washington last month for licenses to export diesel to the US market to be granted to all Russian major oil firms, sources familiar with the situation said.

In October 2025, the US imposed sanctions on Russian oil companies over Moscow's war that began in 2022. The diesel exports could provide Moscow with billions of dollars in revenues that could help Putin continue the war with Ukraine.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy criticised the deal, announced while a Ukrainian delegation was in the US to discuss how to seek a resolution of the war, as a "weak decision on the part of strong partners."

"Gifts to Putin will not bring peace or any benefit to the civilized world. Russia will 'repay' the diesel with further terror and perfidy," he said on X.

The deal was also criticized by US lawmakers including Trump's fellow Republican, Representative Don Bacon, who said it is time to apply more sanctions that Congress passed recently, not lift the measures. "Now is the time to use those sanctions to squeeze Putin's war machine, not reward a dictator by putting more money in his hands while he continues targeting and killing Ukrainian civilians," Bacon said on X.

The US Treasury Department issued a license allowing importation of Russian diesel until April 7.

Trump said Russia would supply another 500,000 tons in November and a further 1 million tons "immediately thereafter." Even more would follow, Trump said, "based on the condition of their diesel refineries," which have been damaged by Ukrainian attacks.

3 children among 20 killed in Russian strikes on Ukraine

Kyiv: Russian strikes killed at least 20 people in Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region, Ukrainian officials said Saturday, a day after US President Donald Trump announced a deal to buy Russian diesel that Kyiv warned would help bankroll Moscow's war in Ukraine.

Three children were among those killed when Russian aerial bombs hit residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia, Ukraine's State Emergency Service said Saturday. At least 18 people were wounded.

Missiles also struck Kyiv in a daytime attack Saturday. Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said four people were wounded.

"Today, Russia expressed its thanks for the lifting of sanctions on diesel exports by dropping five glide bombs on residential buildings in Zaporizhzhia," Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy wrote Saturday on X.

US 'may' join Saudi strikes on Houthis, says Trump as Riyadh airport is hit again

Associated Press
Cairo, October 10

THE AIRPORT in Saudi Arabia's capital, Riyadh, was attacked again Saturday and evacuated, two regional officials said, just days after three Saudi citizens, including a pilot, were killed as the kingdom faces an extraordinary series of assaults in the new front in the Iran war.

President Donald Trump told reporters he was evaluating whether the US should join Saudi strikes against the Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen who have claimed this week's attacks on King Khalid International Airport as well as other Saudi airports, military facilities and oil infrastructure.

"We may. We're going to look at it," Trump said. "We just found out about the recent attack. So we'll make a decision. We move very quickly." In the latest attack, a missile struck a complex housing terminals 3 and 4 for domestic flights at the Riyadh airport and many were wounded, one of the regional officials said.

They spoke on condition of anonymity because they weren't authorised to speak to the media. Ambulances were seen rushing there. The surge in attacks has come in the week since a Saudi-led coalition launched a major military offensive against the Houthis. There was no Houthi statement on Saturday.



President Donald Trump speaks to reporters at the White House in Washington on Saturday. REUTERS

> **"We may. We're going to look at it. We just found out about the recent attack. So we'll make a decision. We move very quickly"**
> **DONALD TRUMP,** PRESIDENT OF UNITED STATES

Saudi civil aviation authorities said operations at the airport had been suspended and the number of wounded and damage were being assessed. The airport had a heavy police presence, with all entrances blocked, and lights around the complex were dimmed.

Flights diverted elsewhere, the Flightradar24 tracker said. Countries including the United States, Britain, Germany, Australia and Canada warned citizens to avoid the airport.

The attacks on airports, military facilities and oil infrastructure in Saudi Arabia, the world's top oil exporter, has rattled markets and the region.

Fighting in Yemen between the Houthis and Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces has escalated, with the Saudi-led coalition providing air support for government forces in an attempt to reverse recent Houthi gains along the Red Sea.

The rebels' gains gave them better surveillance of shipping on a corridor that's a crucial alternative to the Strait of Hormuz, where Iran has been attacking ships. Though the Houthis have told the AP and others they are only targeting Saudi shipping as part of a blockade in retaliation for one imposed on them.

Palestinian leader Abbas postpones polls, cites Israeli restrictions

Reuters
Ramallah, October 10

PALESTINIAN PRESIDENT Mahmoud Abbas on Saturday postponed legislative elections due next month until September 11, 2027, and called a presidential poll for the same date, blaming Israel and the security situation in the Palestinian territories for the delay.

Abbas' decree cited "obstacles posed by Israeli measures" and the need to establish suitable political, security and on-the-ground conditions for "free, fair and inclusive elections", the official Palestinian news agency *WAFA* reported.

In a post on X, Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Saar, pointing to the last Palestinian election having been held two decades ago, rejected Abbas' remarks as "yet another ridiculous lie designed to evade responsibility and accountability."

There had been serious doubts the Palestinian Authority vote would go ahead next month. The Palestinians have not held legislative or presidential elections since 2005-2006, after which Abbas' rival, the Islamist group Hamas, seized control of Gaza, ousting his loyalists. Abbas has governed by decree since his presidential mandate expired in 2009.



Palestinian Authority President Mahmoud Abbas. REUTERS

The Palestinian Authority held municipal elections in April in the West Bank and in Deir al-Balah in central Gaza, the only city in the enclave to participate. The vote was the first election held in Gaza since 2006.

The decree said Israeli military attacks, settlement expansion, settler violence and movement restrictions in the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, along with Israel's continued withholding of Palestinian tax revenues, created challenges for holding elections this November.

Twin 7.7 and 6.6 earthquakes strike Panama, prompt evacuations as aftershocks continue

Associated Press
Panama City, October 10

TWO POWERFUL 7.7 and 6.6 magnitude earthquakes and a series of aftershocks roiled southern Panama Friday afternoon, collapsing buildings near the epicenter and prompting evacuations across the country.

The earlier quake, felt as far away as neighboring Colombia, was centered about 10 kilometers (6 miles) southwest of the remote community of Pitaloza Arriba, in the central province of Herrera, the USGS said. It struck at a depth of 10 kilometers. The USGS initially reported the first quake as magnitude 8, then revised it to 7.6 and later to 7.7.

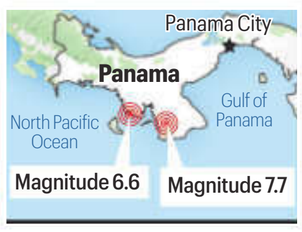
Visibly shaken residents of Panama City, the capital, gathered outside as they waited for news of the quake's impact on Friday. "We felt it very strongly. It knocked things over in the kitchen, but we're okay, though we're very scared," Rosendo Domínguez, 60, who is from Herrera province, where the earthquake struck, told The Associated Press by phone. "Everyone is outside, scared."



Vehicles lie crushed beneath a collapsed hotel after an earthquake struck Penonome, Panama, on Friday. AP

Multiple aftershocks continued to rattle Panama, including several measuring magnitude 5.8, 5.5 and 5.2. Seismologists at the University of Panama recorded more than 45 aftershocks, though many were too weak to be felt.

• POWERFUL QUAKES JOLT PANAMA



Despite the strength of the successive quakes, Panamanian President José Raúl Mulino said authorities had not documented anyone killed as of Friday evening, though he cautioned that could change in the coming hours or days.

"Nobody was ready, and no one is ever ready for this type of disaster," Mulino said, after calling for calm earlier in the day.

Tennessee execution survivor Christa Pike discharged from hospital, returns to prison

Associated Press
Nashville, October 10

CHRISTA PIKE, who survived Tennessee's attempt to execute her by lethal injection, has been moved back to prison, her attorneys said Saturday.

Pike, 50, was discharged from the hospital and is back at the Debra K Johnson Rehabilitation Center, the women's prison where she was housed for 30 years, her attorneys said in a written statement.

"She is grateful to the first responders and her medical team for their care in these extraordinary circumstances. She is continuing to receive medical care at the prison, and we will continue to track her recovery," the statement said.

Pike had been hospitalized since surviving two doses of pentobarbital as the state attempted to execute her on September 30 for the 1995 beating and stabbing death of classmate Colleen Slemmer. At one point she was on a ventilator and her attorneys did not expect her to survive. However, they said Pike woke up and began talking and walking with assistance.



Christa Pike

The Death Penalty Information Center says Pike is the first person to survive after receiving lethal injection drugs during an execution.

Israeli airstrikes kill five people in Gaza, say medics

Cairo: Israeli strikes killed at least five Palestinians in the Gaza Strip in two separate attacks on Saturday, health officials said. Medics said an Israeli strike killed four people near Panda Mall in Gaza City, while another killed one person in the Tuffah neighbourhood further south of the city.

The Israeli military said the two strikes targeted militants, without giving further information. Israel has stepped up strikes against Hamas in recent weeks, saying the Palestinian militant group has been rearming and carrying out attacks in violation of the ceasefire.

Hamas denies rebuilding its arsenal or planning attacks and accuses Israel of undermining a US-brokered ceasefire agreed a year ago. REUTERS

French policing under scrutiny as student protest injuries mount

Reuters
Paris, October 10

FOURTEEN-YEAR-OLD Eden suffered a broken jaw and multiple smashed teeth when he was struck by a tear gas canister directed towards him at close range by a police officer last week during student protests in France, his parents and family lawyer said.

The teenager had been sitting on a wall looking at his phone metres away from the protest in Saint-Ouen-l'Aumone, the lawyer said. An officer approached him and struck him with a baton, prompting Eden to respond with a kick, according to the local prosecutor. A second officer fired a tear gas grenade with a Cougar launcher, hitting him in the face.



Police clash with students during nationwide protests in Paris. FILE

"(The officer) shot him in the mouth and left him lying on the ground, without even calling the emergency services," said lawyer Elsa Marcel. The family, who asked for Eden's second name to be withheld to protect their privacy, has filed a complaint for attempted murder, she said.

A police spokesperson said they do not comment on ongoing investigations. The prosecutor's office said in a statement that the student had confronted the police and the officers tried to push him back. The officer was placed under formal investigation on charges of assault by a public official resulting in permanent disability or disfigurement on Tuesday, eight days after the incident.

The case is one of 24 under investigation by the IGPN internal police watchdog linked to the policing of a more-than-two-week-long wave of student unrest over conditions in schools.

Poland: Third school attack in week, 3 injured

Warsaw: Police say a third attack at a Polish school in less than a week took place on Saturday, when a 21-year-old woman injured three people inside an educational institution in the capital, Warsaw, police said.

The attacker used a "dangerous object" to attack a 17-year old woman and ended up hurting two other people, aged 17 and 24 respectively, Jakub Filipiak, a spokesman for Warsaw police, said. None of the injuries was life-threatening.

The attack came after police Saturday detained 76 people in Poland and checked nearly 50,000 schools nationwide as part of efforts to prevent further violence following two school attacks earlier in the week. AP

• BRIEFLY

CHINA

Former mayor of Wuhan city gets 14 years in jail for bribery



Former mayor of Wuhan City Zhou Xianwang. FILE

A FORMER mayor of a Chinese city hit by the coronavirus outbreak more than six years ago was sentenced Saturday to 14 years in prison after being convicted of bribery. While Zhou Xianwang has drawn criticism for his handling of the early stages of the outbreak in Wuhan, a city in central China, the court statement did not mention that, but focused on him receiving bribes. The court also fined him 5 million yuan ($747,000). The Shangqiu Intermediate People's Court said Zhou used his various positions to assist others on matters such as business operations and administrative approvals between 2003 and 2025. He accepted money and valuables totaling more than 60.5 million yuan ($9 million), it said, adding the amount was exceptionally large.AP

• A TEAM OF MARINE ARCHAEOLOGISTS IS INVESTIGATING WHETHER A SUBMERGED OBJECT OFF A REMOTE PACIFIC ISLAND IS AMELIA EARHART'S MISSING PLANE

89 years later, a new search for Amelia Earhart's missing plane

Steve Gorman
Los Angeles, October 10

A US-BASED team of marine archaeologists has set sail for a tiny island in the far western Pacific seeking to examine the latest tantalizing clue to one of the 20th century's great unsolved mysteries: the 1937 disappearance of famed aviator Amelia Earhart.

Backed by Purdue University, an institution long affiliated with Earhart and her legacy, the group aims to learn whether a submerged object detected by satellite imagery in the island's lagoon six years ago is the wreckage of Earhart's twin-engine Lockheed Electra 10-E airplane.

Such a finding would conclusively prove the hypothesis of some scholars that Earhart and her navigator, Fred Noonan, crash-landed on or near the coral-ringed atoll and perished as castaways there, hundreds of miles from their intended refueling stop.

After embarking from Los Angeles earlier this month, the group was expected to arrive on Tuesday, October 13, local time at Nikumaroro, an uninhabited speck of land in the remote Phoenix Islands, part of the archipelago nation of the Kiribati Republic.

"Finding Amelia Earhart's Electra aircraft would be the discovery of a lifetime," Richard Pettigrew, head of the Archaeological Legacy Institute in Eugene, Oregon, who is leading the effort in conjunction with Purdue, said in press materials for the mission.



Amelia Earhart on July 30, 1936. US NATIONAL ARCHIVES, REUTERS

Purdue general counsel and expedition member Steve Schultz, who was in Fiji conducting advance work for the expedition last week, said in an interview: "This would be solving one of the great mysteries in aviation history, certainly one of the great mysteries of the 20th century,"

The mission has its skeptics. Chief among them is rival Earhart explorer Ric Gillespie, co-founder of TIGHAR, short for The International Group for Historic Aircraft Recovery, and author of the 2024 *One More Good Flight: The Amelia Earhart Tragedy.*

Gillespie has led a dozen expeditions of his own to the atoll over three decades and is the leading proponent of the Nikumaroro castaway theory. But he predicted the Pettigrew-Purdue team would find no airplane wreckage or anything else of consequence left on the island.

The Purdue team credits Gillespie with laying the groundwork for its theory, citing artifacts found on the island, including a 1930s glass jar of freckle cream and a jackknife similar to one Earhart carried.

Gillespie also examined forensic records of skeletal remains found in the 1940s, radio operators' logs of bearings from distress calls after Earhart vanished, and a photograph taken months later that he said showed what appeared to be the Electra's landing gear. REUTERS

BRAZIL

Police kill man who held 13 children hostage

BRAZILIAN POLICE killed a man Friday after he held 13 children at knifepoint for more than two hours at a school in the southern city of Curitiba, authorities said. None of the children were injured. Parana state police spokesperson Leticia Martins told journalists outside school CMEI Sao Braz the man jumped one of the walls, broke into a classroom and kept children and staffers as hostages. She did not disclose how the suspect was killed or the ages of the children involved. AP

SUDAN

41 killed in drone strike near Ethiopian border

A DRONE strike blamed on Sudan's notorious paramilitaries hit a gathering of displaced people on the border with Ethiopia and killed 41, a rights group said. Friday's strike by the Rapid Support Forces took place in the Abu Shandi area in Sudan's Blue Nile province, according to Emergency Lawyers, which tracks the war in northeastern African nation. Among the dead were eight children and many women, the group said. A spokesperson for the RSF didn't respond to a request for comment. AP

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DEVOTED TO DANCE
BY SUANSHU KHURANA

Kathak exponent Roshan Kumari, part of celebrated trinity of Sitara Devi and Damayanti Joshi, died this week



DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Lockdown, crackdown

4 EX-CMs IN 7,000 DETAINED over CEC protest; Jantar Mantar sealed off

CJP'S DIPKE, DAS, RANKA held as flight lands in Delhi, whisked away

SC TO HEAR TODAY PLEAS over detentions, Metro and train restrictions

People on roads bundled into buses, taken away by police; Delhi won't be held hostage, says CM

Alok Singh, Pragynesh, Sakshi Chand, Nirbhay Thakur, Tabshir Shams, Devansh Mittal, Drishti Jain, Mishal Mussaddique, Sophiya Mathew & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, October 10

AN ESTIMATED 7,000 people were detained across Delhi Saturday as police and Central forces, enforcing a citywide lockdown put in place Friday night, launched a sweeping crackdown through the day to thwart the Cockroach Janta Party's protest calling for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Managing to sequester Jantar Mantar, the site for a planned sit-in by the CJP which protested there for days in July over exam paper leaks until Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan resigned, police clamped down even before the protests could begin this time,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

RELATED REPORTS, P 4, 5, 6



Security personnel chase protesters at Connaught Place in New Delhi, Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Ground Zero barred, protests pop up across city; CJP issues Sunday call

Alok Singh, Nirbhay Thakur, Pragynesh, Tabshir Shams, Devansh Mittal, Drishti Jain & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, October 10

DILLI HAAT, Safdarjung flyover, scattered spots around Connaught Place, Raj Ghat.

With Jantar Mantar, the site of the Cockroach Janta Party's planned sit-in, being turned into a fortress by security personnel, protesters fanned out across the Capital, with small groups holding "flash demonstrations" at different places Saturday afternoon.

Late at night, the CJP vowed to continue the protests, seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and called for another demonstration at Jantar Mantar at 10 am Sunday.

With CJP leaders detained, Ajinkya Shinde, the youth platform's national organisation incharge, said, "The government must have thought we will

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• 'FLASH DEMONSTRATIONS'





Near Baba Kharak Singh Marg in New Delhi, Saturday. GAJENDRA YADAV

EXPRESS special

'Isko Jantar Mantar bana dete hain': Kin outside, spirits up in detention centres

Detainees, except CJP leaders, released







Ex-CMs Mamata Banerjee, Arvind Kejriwal and Pinarayi Vijayan being detained in New Delhi. PTI, @PINARAYIVIJAYAN/X

Sophiya Mathew & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, October 10

FORMER KERALA Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan. Actor Raj Zutshi. Social media content creators filming reels. A middle-aged man who said he was taking a relative to the hospital when the police stopped him in Central Delhi. And hundreds of other protesters.

They were among those picked up by the Delhi Police and taken in buses and vans to makeshift detention centres across the Capital, as it sought

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Rupee near 97 vs dollar, RBI unveils measures to curb speculation

New Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve requires banks to set aside 20% of derivative contracts in cash with RBI

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 10

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) early Saturday announced a raft of measures to defend the rupee and curb speculation including a novel mechanism borrowed from the Chinese playbook.

Called the Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR), this requires banks to now set aside in cash with the RBI 20%

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

e EXPLAINED

Tighter control

For market participants accustomed to greater flexibility, the new rules mean tighter controls, additional costs and closer scrutiny. This will raise the cost of taking large currency positions and restrict rebooking of cancelled contracts.

CARNEY MAY BE REPUBLIC DAY GUEST

2 Canadian Ministers to visit India next week with 300-member mission

Doubling trade to $70 bn by 2030; PM visit in Dec on table

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 10

THE CANADIAN government is sending two senior ministers to India next week to prepare for Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit in December and conclude the trade pact as Delhi is considering PM Mark Carney as a possible chief guest for Republic Day in 2027.

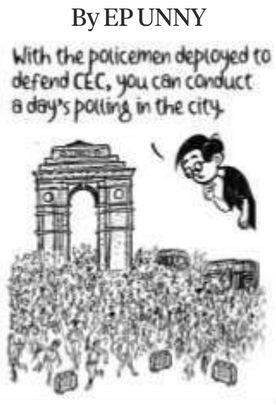
Both ministers are of Indian-origin, Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand and Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu, officials told *The Indian Express* Saturday.

Sources said Anand will hold a bilateral meeting with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, while Sidhu will meet

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



Bid to create anarchy with foreign help: BJP chief slams CJP, Rahul, Kejriwal

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, October 10

AS PROTESTERS and Opposition leaders, seeking the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, were stopped from converging at Jantar Mantar and detained by police across the Capital Saturday, BJP president Nitin Nabin accused Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal and the Cockroach Janta Party of attempting to "destabilise" the country by creating "a state of anarchy" with the backing of "foreign powers and alliances".

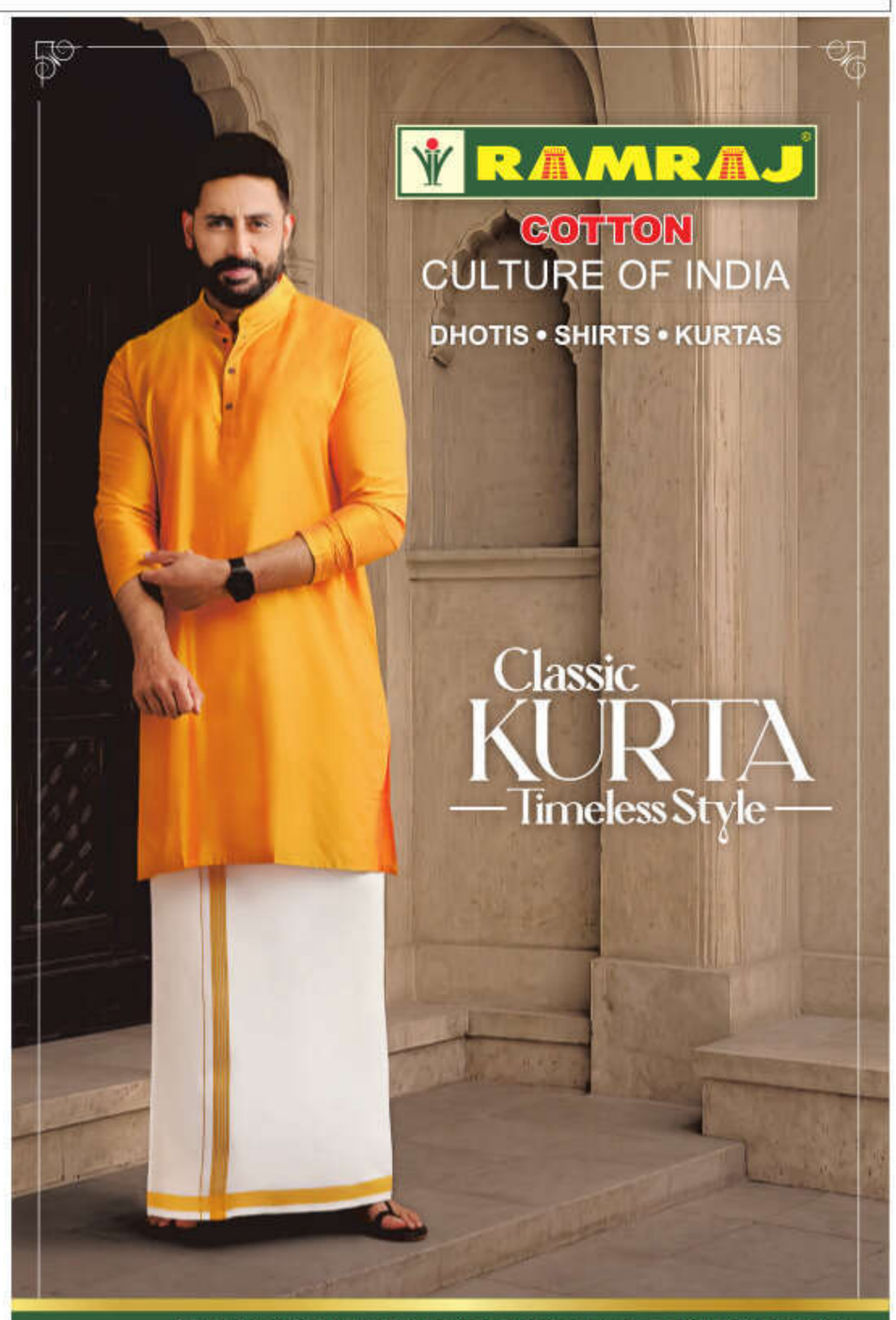
Speaking to reporters, Nabin warned the Opposition leaders and the CJP that the government would deal sternly with their "nefarious intentions" and that BJP workers would foil their "designs" on the ground. His remarks came

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• PM NARENDRA Modi will visit Chennai where he will lay the foundation stone and dedicate projects worth over ₹13,000 crore.

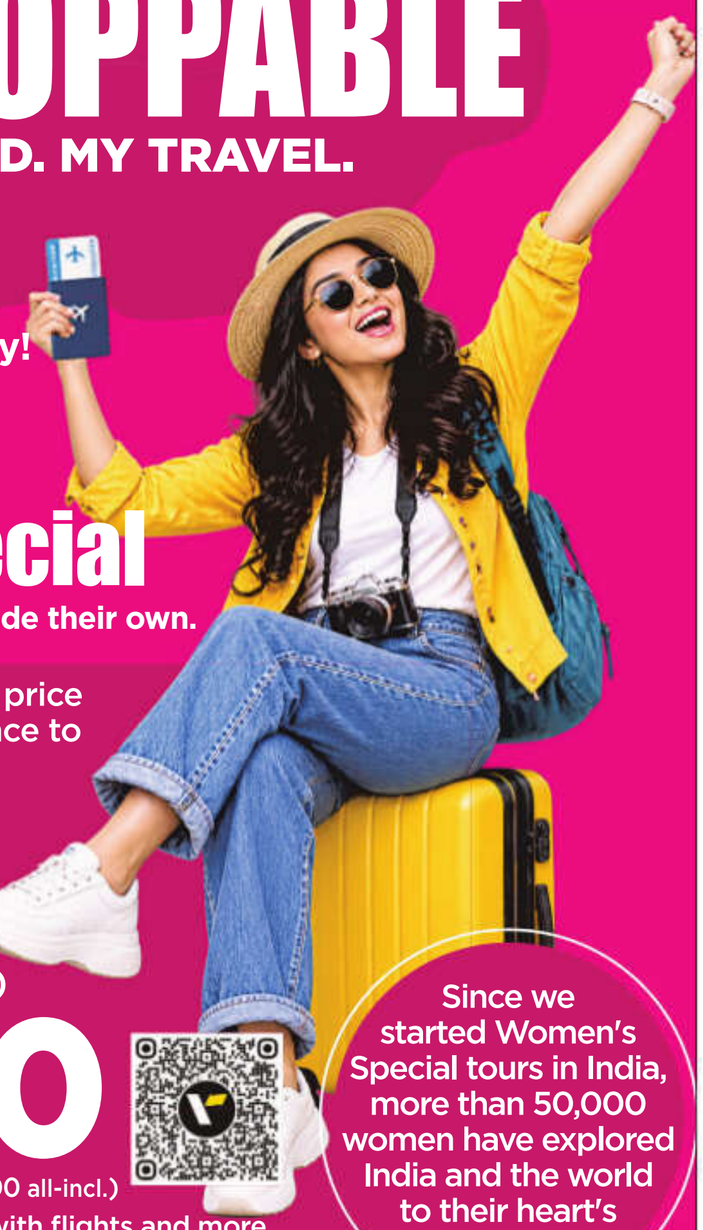
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RBI

of the forex derivative contract they enter into of over $2 million involving the rupee. This makes protection from a fall in the rupee more expensive. The RBI can change the exact percentage of the forex derivative that needs to be set aside by banks in cash.

The rupee has come precariously close to its lowest ever over the last few days, and is inching closer to 97 against the US dollar. Global crude oil prices are also sizzling above the $100 per barrel mark. To strengthen market discipline, curb excessive speculative activity and bring greater transparency to foreign exchange transactions, the RBI has restricted rebooking cancelled foreign exchange derivative contracts, reduced the threshold for transactions without establishing underlying exposure, and strengthened documentation requirements. These changes could significantly alter how banks, corporations, financial institutions and currency traders manage their foreign exchange positions.

Forex reserves dipped by $12.95 billion to $734.60 billion during the week ended October 2. The rupee has remained under pressure despite the huge inflows of over $143 billion under the FCNR scheme. In calendar year 2026 alone, the rupee has fallen 5.5 per cent.

Higher oil prices also lead to imported inflation at a time when retail inflation is forecast to touch 5.2 per cent in FY27 and the RBI is on a rate hiking cycle. It hiked repo rates by 25 bps to 5.50 per cent on October 7. For the RBI, signs of fresh discontent in the forex market were visible the same day when despite the policy rate hike, the rupee fell. Higher interest rates should theoretically strengthen the rupee as supply of the currency is expected to fall.

For market participants accustomed to greater flexibility, the new rules mean tighter controls, additional costs and closer scrutiny. Saturday's measures will raise the cost of taking large currency positions, restrict the rebooking of cancelled contracts and force banks to verify underlying exposures.

The message is clear: the foreign exchange market must serve genuine economic needs, not become a playground for unchecked speculation.

$100 mn window down to $5 mn

One of the most consequential changes is the reduction of the threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing the existence of the underlying exposure. The RBI has slashed the existing limit from $100 million to $5 million equivalent across authorised dealers. The corresponding threshold for exchange-traded currency derivatives involving the rupee has also been reduced from $100 million to $5 million equivalent across all recognised stock exchanges taken together. This means a 95 per cent reduction in the threshold. Market participants can no longer rely on the earlier, much higher limit to undertake qualifying derivative transactions without establishing the underlying exposure. The tighter threshold is intended to reduce the scope for large positions that are not adequately linked to genuine foreign exchange risks. However, this should not be interpreted as a blanket ban on all currency derivatives above $5 million.

Rebooking no longer an option

The RBI has also moved to prevent repeated cancellation and rebooking of rupee-involving foreign exchange derivative contracts. Under the new direction, authorised dealers must not permit users to rebook a foreign exchange derivative contract involving the Indian rupee, whether deliverable or non-deliverable, if the contract was cancelled with any authorised dealer after the issuance of the directions.

The restriction applies to rebooking cancelled contracts, not to every new derivative transaction. The RBI has also clarified that rolling over contracts at maturity will continue to be permitted, subject to existing regulatory requirements.

Analysts said repeated cancellation and rebooking can create opportunities for users to change positions as market conditions shift. Tighter restrictions make that flexibility harder to exploit and encourage greater discipline before entering into contracts.

No double-hedging

The RBI is also strengthening the checks designed to prevent the same underlying exposure from being hedged through multiple authorised dealers.

Banks must now obtain and retain an undertaking from users entering into rupee-involving foreign exchange derivatives to hedge contracted exposures. The undertaking must confirm that the same underlying exposure has not been hedged with another authorised dealer. This requirement places greater responsibility on both customers and banks.

The objective is to improve transparency and reduce the risk of duplicate hedging, where the same commercial exposure is used to justify multiple derivative positions. For legitimate businesses, this means additional paperwork and stronger internal controls. For banks, it means tighter compliance processes and a greater need to scrutinise customer declarations.

20% forex risk reserve: A direct cost for banks

The introduction of the Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve by the RBI is another major development. For covered foreign exchange derivative contracts involving the rupee with a notional value exceeding $2 million equivalent, authorised dealers must maintain a reserve with the RBI in cash equal to 20 per cent of the rupee equivalent of each transaction's notional amount.

The requirement applies to the specified contracts used to hedge current-account exposures where the user purchases foreign currency against the rupee. Banks will need to set aside cash for the prescribed reserve rather than freely deploy that money elsewhere. The requirement could increase the cost of providing covered derivatives, influence pricing and encourage banks and customers to reassess how they structure their hedging transactions.

The reserve is not automatically a 20 per cent fee charged to the customer. It is a cash reserve requirement imposed on authorised dealers for the specified contracts.

Why the measures now?

The rupee has faced intense pressure from adverse capital flows, currency hedging demand and a challenging global environment. On October 9, 2026, the rupee closed at around 96.73 per US dollar, close to its record low, despite a recent interest-rate increase. Against this backdrop, the RBI appears to be targeting a key source of pressure that it can regulate directly: activity in the derivatives market. When participants buy dollars or build positions anticipating rupee depreciation, those transactions can amplify demand for foreign currency and intensify market volatility.



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Lockdown, crackdown

making large-scale detentions, shutting 45 Metro stations until evening, stopping the movement of trains and barricading key roads.

While CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained inside an aircraft and whisked away, several Opposition leaders, including former Chief Ministers Mamata Banerjee, Arvind Kejriwal, Pinarayi Vijayan and Manik Sarkar, were stopped and taken to detention centres where they were held for hours. Groups of marching protesters, several journalists covering the protest, as well as dozens of people who claimed to be bystanders, were picked off the road, bundled into police vehicles, and taken to detention centres.

From the afternoon, protesters in groups of 100-150 broke into spontaneous flash protests at several places including Dilli Haat, Safdarjung flyover, Raj Ghat and Connaught Place. They too were detained.

Dipke, Das and Ranka, the CJP's top three leaders, were detained by police who entered the aircraft on which they arrived in Delhi from Mumbai around 10.20 am. They were whisked away to separate undisclosed locations.

In a video released later, Dipke announced that "from now onwards", Ajinkya Shinde, the CJP's national organisation in-charge, "will lead the movement."

Later in the day, after news came that Dipke had lost his paternal grandmother, Delhi Police gave him the option to either stay detained in Delhi or travel to Maharashtra to be with his family. In a video, Shinde said the CJP's protest would continue "until Gyanesh Kumar resigns", and gave a call for another march to Jantar Mantar at 10 am, Sunday.

Last month, an investigation by The Indian Express revealed that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had objected on record 14 times in 10 months to steps taken by the Commission under CEC Kumar, from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

Neha, leader of the students' organisation All India Students' Association (AISA) and one of the most prominent faces of the protest, was detained near Dilli Haat, along with activist Yogendra Yadav and advocate Prashant Bhushan. Around 7 pm, Neha posted on social media that police had released her from detention.

Earlier, climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, who had sat on a fast alongside Neha during the CJP's protest at Jantar Mantar in June-July, had announced that he would be compelled to begin a hunger strike or a padayatra if Neha and others were not released by Sunday.

Popular YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, who is based abroad but had come to India ahead of the protest, was picked up from his home in Gurugram's Sector 56 early in the morning and taken to a Crime Branch office, police sources said.

Former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee was detained outside her Delhi residence along with other leaders of the Trinamool Congress.

"This has gone beyond Emergency. It has become a super Emergency," Banerjee said, and announced that she might join the INDIA bloc's planned march to the Supreme Court Monday.

Leader of Opposition in the Keralam Assembly and former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan was detained and taken to Chhatrasal Stadium. Several other Left leaders, including former Tripura Chief Minister Manik Sarkar, were also detained.

"Delhi is witnessing the Modi government's ruthless crackdown on democracy," Vijayan posted on X. "The BJP cannot evade the questions on electoral integrity and silence those demanding accountability through state repression. No repression can extinguish our resolve to defend the Constitution and the right to vote," he said.

Former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal was detained along with several senior AAP leaders including Sanjay Singh and Saurabh Bharadwaj outside Kejriwal's Lodhi Estate residence. Policemen lifted Kejriwal by his legs and chest and carried him to a police bus.

Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi announced that the protests would continue, and dared Prime Minister Narendra Modi to do "whatever he wanted".

"Narendra Modi, (Home Minister) Amit Shah, (RSS Sarsanghchalak) Mohan Bhagwat, Gyanesh Kumar, and (National Security Adviser) Ajit Doval, the villains of this story, are slowly finding the space closing around them. We are closing that space," Gandhi said in a video posted online.

"Mr Modi, do whatever you want. Call out all the police: 10,000, 20,000, 50,000, whatever you want... Arrest all the young people. Arrest us all. We are surrounding you, and we are not going to back down," he said.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta hit back at the Opposition and protesters, saying "Delhi will not be held hostage".

"There will be a resolute fight against the politics of spreading anarchy under the guise of democracy and challenging the people's mandate," she said.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin alleged that the Opposition was "attempting to destabilise the country in collusion with foreign powers".

While Saturday's protests did not see large-scale violence similar to July 20 when the CJP led its march towards Parliament, some scattered incidents were reported. In the evening, stones were thrown at a bus full of detained protesters near Jhandewalan. Police said six of their personnel, including a woman member of the Pink Force, sustained injuries while detaining protesters.

'Isko Jantar Mantar bana dete hain'

to thwart the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP's) planned protest at Jantar Mantar on Saturday.

Police set up these centres across all its 13 districts in Delhi, including Chhatrasal Stadium in north Delhi, about 13 km from Jantar Mantar, and Rajiv Gandhi Stadium in Bawana, around 38 km away.

Late on Saturday evening, all the detainees, except CJP leaders, were released.

Chhatrasal Stadium

Around noon, routine activities at the Chhatrasal Stadium sports complex continued alongside the detention operations. Athletes were still practising as police buses brought in protesters and their supporters. Near the entrance, a large pavilion tent was being prepared to serve meals, drinking water and refreshments to police officers and Central Armed Police Forces personnel deployed at the site.

Inside the complex, as police vehicles pulled up, officials collected detainees' details. Sources said Pinarayi was already inside the complex, having been detained in the morning near Kerala House, next to Jantar Mantar. He was released later in the evening.

One group said they had been picked up from New Delhi Railway Station and Chelmsford Road in Central Delhi.

Protesters complained there were no arrangements for food or water for them for hours. "The situation turned so bad that roughly 500 staged a protest over water. Then, late evening, water was provided but was insufficient for the swelling crowd," said Shivansh Shukla, a final-year law student at Delhi University.

Detainees continued to be brought in throughout the day, even as small groups that had been brought early on left, including Zutshi.

Fifteen journalists covering the protest were among those brought to the stadium. News-laundry journalist Anmol Pritam said: "While we were reporting, all journalists were detained. Four of us were picked up from New Delhi Railway Station and brought here on a bus."

Delhi Police sources said the detained journalists were released in the afternoon.

Slogans continued to ring out from inside the complex, audible to even those gathered outside. "Vote chor, gaddi chod (Vote thief, leave power)!" and "Inquilab zindabad!", were among them.

By late evening, relatives and well-wishers of those detained began arriving. Brajesh Kumar, a guest lecturer at Delhi University's Campus Law Centre and an advocate at the Delhi High Court, said he was there for 12 of his law students, detained in the Jantar Mantar area.

Kumar said police were asking detainees for their full names, addresses, places of origin, details of whom they had come with, and whether they were affiliated with any political party. He alleged they were also being told they would not be released by 6 pm unless they provided the information.

"One of my students called me and said, 'Sir, I wasn't even there. They are asking me for my details. What should I do? They have detained me and are asking for my name and address'. The student was crying and asking whether he should give the details," Kumar said.

A brief confrontation broke out between police personnel and people who had gathered to enquire about the detainees.

"*Nahin mil sakte, bilkul nahin mil sakte, kaise mil sakte ho? Jail mein mil sakte ho. Koi right nahin hai. Aap le aao court se aadesh* (You cannot meet them, absolutely not. How can you meet them? You can meet them in jail. You have no right. Bring a court order)," a senior Delhi Police officer said when someone asked to meet his detained friends.

Others wondered why their relatives had been detained in the first place. Vishaka, 20, from Adarsh Nagar, said her brother-in-law had been picked up while buying vegetables at Gole Market. "He has not committed any crime. Still he has been taken inside... for what?"

She said her brother-in-law sent updates through voice and video calls until his phone battery ran out. Internet jammers had also made it difficult for them to stay in touch, she added.

Rajiv Gandhi Stadium

At Rajiv Gandhi Stadium in Bawana, the athletics area was cordoned off to accommodate the detainees.

Among those held there was a middle-aged man who said he had no connection to the protest and had been picked up on Mahadev Road while taking a relative to hospital. "I have nothing to do with the protest. They picked me up asking me why I was there," he said from inside a police bus.

Two social media content creators seated behind him said they had been detained while filming reels near Jantar Mantar.

A large group brought to the stadium included Delhi University students from Kerala. Tamanna, 19, a second-year political science undergraduate, said they had begun marching peacefully from Daryaganj towards Delhi Gate at around 11.45 am.

However, the police stopped the group a few metres into the march and called three buses to transport the students to detention centres, she said.

Meera, 23, a stylist and graphic designer from Chhattarpur, was among another group detained at the stadium. "I had gone to the protest with my flatmate and reached around 11 am. It was very empty. We found some SFI people. There was commotion as some of them had jumped the barricades, but I stayed back and we started chanting," she said.

Meera alleged that the police then surrounded the group and began separating protesters. "We were holding hands. They pulled us till the van one by one. A woman constable tried to snatch my phone and I resisted. It had recordings of the clashes. I put the phone inside my top. Many police officers searched me; there were seven of them. They forcibly took my phone," she alleged.

Describing the atmosphere inside the detention area, Meera said chanting and sloganeering continued. She said many were assembled around a professor – later identified as former Kannur University Vice-Chancellor Gopinath Ravindran – as he held an impromptu lecture on democracy. "Everyone has circled around him and are chanting. '*Isko* Jantar Mantar *bana dete hain* (Let's make this place Jantar Mantar)', someone said," she recalled. While there were also anti-police slogans, some protesters were trying to calm the crowd, Meera said.

Ground Zero

return home after the detentions today. This fear on the part of Modi, Shah shows we have won half the fight."

"As many people as you detain, we will not go back until Gyanesh Kumar resigns. We will head to Jantar Mantar again at 10 am tomorrow," Shinde said, urging people to join the demonstration in large numbers and continue protesting even if stopped by police.

Earlier in the day, the barricading of roads, mass detentions, massive deployment of security personnel, and travel restrictions made it impossible for protesters to reach Jantar Mantar. With senior CJP leaders detained in the morning itself, the protesters tried to figure out plans and where to go in the absence of any word from the top. Finally, they broke up into scattered protests at different locations, which also led to clampdowns by police.

Dilli Haat

Once it became clear that Central Delhi was inaccessible, All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha, along with other student activists, launched a march from INA towards Jantar Mantar around 1 pm. She was accompanied by advocate Prashant Bhushan and activist Yogendra Yadav.

The demonstrators carried posters and banners demanding the removal of Gyanesh Kumar, and the scrapping of SIR.

They were stopped by police near INA Market-Dilli Haat, with a large number of security personnel putting them into buses, from where they were taken to different police stations.

But even as these leaders were detained, an increasing number of protesters, responding to the AISA's call for a march, kept arriving outside Dilli Haat. Police went on to detain them as well. Officers said around 200 protesters were detained from near Dilli Haat until 6.30 pm.

The Dilli Haat authorities closed the popular market for visitors.

Safdarjung flyover

The Safdarjung flyover near INA itself became a protest site for a few hours when Neha and others were stopped there on their way to Jantar Mantar, leading to a standoff with police.

At around 3 pm, around 50 people gathered there, chanting "Gyanesh Kumar must resign". Atul, a student from Hindu College, said: "They detained Neha and (CJP leader Abhijeet) Dipke and thought it would break our morale. But it has not. We will not stop until we get the resignation this time too (of Gyanesh Kumar, after Dharmendra Pradhan during the July protest)."

Bala, a Dalit activist, said: "We are coming from Jor Bagh Metro Station, and are now going towards INA." Central Delhi might have been blockaded, Bala said, but "we plan to ultimately make our way to Connaught Place". Soon after, police cleared the flyover and a bus carrying Neha and others started moving by 3.30 pm.

However, crowds surged again on the flyover as protesters regrouped. They were met with barricading at the end of the flyover, and a confrontation ensued for the next two hours between police and the protesters.

Eventually, the protesters were pushed back by police and the flyover was cleared around 6 pm, with around 50 protesters detained and the rest scattered.

Connaught Place

Across Connaught Place in Central Delhi, several small protests, comprising a few dozen people each, kept erupting throughout the day.

One such protest was held in the Outer Circle, where over 100 people managed to reach, dodging several barricades and layers of preventive measures. While most were detained within minutes of assembling in the Outer Circle, others managed to give the police the slip.

Around 100 protesters gathered at another location in Connaught Place, and began jeering and raising slogans. A police team rushed towards them from the Rajiv Chowk Metro Station, and chased them away.

"The police are busting every attempt and detaining everyone here. We came prepared with protein bars, water and masks, but they weren't of much use today," said Sidharth, a 23-year-old protester from Noida.

Gole Market, Sansad Marg

Two rounds of flash protests by activists of the SFI, trying to breach the barricades towards Jantar Mantar, made for most of the action in this highly secure New Delhi area. The first was around 1 pm, when about 50 SFI supporters barged through the barricades near the PTI building on Sansad Marg, overturning them.

As police tried to push back the first few, a larger group came charging through. The police then resorted to lathicharge and detained around 30 people.

Another flash protest started at 2.45 pm at Gole Market. About 100 protesters started a march towards Jantar Mantar, clashing with CRPF personnel who tried to stop them. A batch of protesters managed to walk a short distance, chanting 'Inqualab Zindabad' and 'Jai Bhim'.

A flash protest also broke out on Shankar Road near Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital at around 4 pm. Around 20 protesters sat in the middle of the road, chanting "Gyanesh Kumar, resign".

Police hauled them away and pushed them inside a bus.

Raj Ghat

Around 50-70 protesters, including members of student outfits, marched for over 1 km on the Ghata Masjid Road towards Raj Ghat, until they were detained at a traffic signal.

They had been evading the police since the morning and sitting in parks and spaces around the area, before assembling near Ghata Masjid Road. They raised slogans such as "Modi sarkaar *istifa do, istifa do* (Modi government, resign)", "Gyanesh *tumko jaana hoga* (Gyanesh, you must leave)".

"I am here fighting for basic rights, which have been stolen from the people – the right to vote and the right to freedom," said Ashish, one of the protesters, while distributing pamphlets to hawkers.

BJP

amid the row over US billionaire Elon Musk's posts over the "delay" in the India launch of his satellite communications company Starlink. Musk has targeted industrialist Mukesh Ambani, referring to him as the "prime minister" and the "real boss of India". Responding to Musk's earlier post blaming unnamed "oligarchs" for the delay, Gandhi had replied: "Welcome to India, Elon. Wait till you discover the other guy."

Nabin said, "An attempt is being made to create a dangerous atmosphere in the country. An attempt is being made to destabilise the fact that most of the 140 crore people of the nation are contributing towards its development in peace. This is being done by two anarchic groups, which include the leader of the INDI alliance, Rahul Gandhi ji, and the group being led by Arvind Kejriwal's colleagues, the CJP."

"I want to tell them both: the people are watching both of you closely, and the anarchic competition between you two. You are competing over who can trigger more destabilisation. But your designs will not succeed. Who are these people? They are those who have been rejected by the people. Whether it is Rahul Gandhi's INDI alliance or Arvind Kejriwal and his CJP," he said.

Instead of learning a lesson from their defeats, these leaders, the BJP chief said, had "decided to destabilise the nation".

"I want to say that you are attempting this for your political objectives and at the direction of foreign powers. At a time when the nation is moving forward despite a global crisis, you are not able to digest its progress," he said.

"The kind of words that Rahul Gandhi, Arvind Kejriwal and those from the INDI alliance are using, words which are being used by the so-called youth leadership of the CJP... the youth of Bharat is watching," he said.

"The way you are attempting to challenge the country's constitutional framework and its democracy, and the insulting language you employ against individuals holding the nation's highest offices, will never be accepted by India's 140 crore citizens, and you will certainly face the consequences," he said.

Nabin said people would never allow the "nefarious intentions" of such leaders who relied on "foreign forces" for their politics which is "up for sale". Challenging democracy "in the name of the Constitution with the support of lies is an insult to the people's mandate," he said.

"They are challenging the country's democracy because Prime Minister Narendra Modi is at the helm with the people's mandate and trust in his favour," he said.

"But today, I am warning you that the BJP and the patriotic people of the country will give you a befitting response. The way attempts are being made to create a tense situation, the Government of India will deal with it strictly, and at the same time, BJP workers will also stay among the people and thwart your designs," he said.

The BJP, in a post, recalled that the CJP protest in July had resulted in injuries to "children and police personnel, and public property was damaged".

"Therefore, it is extremely important to prevent the recurrence of such violent incidents. These precautionary restrictions have been imposed in Delhi to ensure the safety of the general public," the BJP said.

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan called the protest an Opposition "conspiracy to trigger anarchy" and said the "success of our industrialists" was not palatable for some. He attacked Rahul Gandhi for "supporting" foreign critics.

Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad said Saturday's events had witnessed "Indian democracy destroying the quest for anarchy", delivering the message that the country will be governed through Parliament, not the streets.

A *PTI* report from Balrampur in UP quoted Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath praising Prime Minister Modi's leadership, while accusing the Congress and its allies of abandoning political decorum and attempting to push the country towards anarchy.

Addressing a public meeting in Balrampur, Adityanath said "the double-engine government is not going to accept this anarchy" and "under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi, no one will be allowed to play with India's honour, pride and glory".

Targeting the Opposition parties, he said, "When they win elections, they attribute the victory to their capabilities; when they lose, they blame EVMs."

Canada

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal.

Sources said that there is a "strong possibility" the two will also meet Prime Minister Modi.

Modi is expected to visit Canada in December, just before his likely visit to the US to attend the G-20 summit. The US will host the 21st G20 Leaders' Summit on December 14-15, at the Trump National Doral Miami resort in Doral, Florida.

Anand and Sidhu are expected to speed up negotiations for the trade pact between India and Canada pushing the process closer towards signing.

If all goes as per plan, sources said, there is a possibility of inviting Canadian PM Carney as Chief Guest for the Republic Day celebrations on January 26, 2027.

Sidhu said Saturday that he will lead the Team Canada Trade Mission to India, Canada's largest commercial engagement in India in recent years, with stops in Mumbai and Bengaluru.

"From October 12 to 17, Sidhu will lead nearly 300 delegates who will connect with Indian decision makers, key industry players and potential clients to expand commercial relations and build new partnerships that create good-paying jobs at home. This is the largest trade delegation Canada has sent to India in over 30 years," a statement by the Canadian government said Saturday.

The trade mission will include businesses from Canada's aerospace and space, clean technologies and energy transition, information and communication technologies, life sciences and agri-food sectors.

It will build on Minister Sidhu's work to deepen Canada's trade relationship with India, which includes ongoing efforts to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement by the end of the year, it said.

Sidhu said he was headed to India "to secure new opportunities for our businesses and workers in one of the world's fastest-growing markets." He added: "By matching Canadian expertise in sectors like aerospace, agri-food and clean technology with India's growing demand, we will diversify our trade and attract new investment. This is how we will more than double our trade with India to $70 billion by 2030."

Canada is aiming to double exports to markets beyond the United States over the next decade, including doubling two-way trade with India to $70 billion annually by 2030.

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Barricades everywhere

Deserted streets, restrictions and protesters at detention centres

Pragynesh, Nirbhay Thakur & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 10

AT 6 am on Saturday, New Delhi resembled a war zone – checkpoints every 200 m, paramilitary troops, riot-control vehicles and an eerie silence. Roads lay deserted as security forces prepared for CJP's protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The contrast with CJP's July 20 'Sansad Chalo' march was stark. Then, barricades had lined Parliament Street, but traffic continued to flow. Police had detained some protesters, but only a bout of violence and a lathicharge were reported. Anyone with a microphone and a camera had a free run, showcasing everything live despite limited Internet connectivity.

This time, every major road leading to Jantar Mantar – Parliament Street, Ashoka Road, Minto Road, Mandi House, Kasturba Gandhi Road and Barakhamba Road – was barricaded. More than 3,000 security personnel were deployed around Parliament Street alone, with two to three layers of barricades and around 100 personnel manning each layer. At no point were more than two to three vehicles allowed on the road.

What stood out were the low-floor buses. Around 20 orange DTC buses and larger private buses stood between Parliament Street and Jantar Mantar, ready to transport detainees to holding facilities.

The security personnel did not wait for violence to break out. Any group of five seen on the road and they were pushed into the buses. "We predicted that a maximum of 5,000 protesters could reach close to New Delhi. So, we arranged between 60 and 70 buses," an officer said.

By 9 am, police had detained around 250-300 protesters allegedly hiding around Connaught Place, including in public toilets and inside Bangla Sahib Gurdwara. "We found that they had gathered at night and hid to join the protest tomorrow," a senior officer said.

Inside the fortified New Delhi area, police checked journalists' identity cards, sometimes refusing to accept digital credentials. By 4 pm, reports had emerged that journalists from some digital media organisations had been detained.

Police also issued warnings through loudspeakers. "We request media personnel to not engage with protesters or come in the way of police personnel," the speaker blared. With Internet services suspended, visuals of detentions around Connaught Place were uploaded hours after the incidents.

More than 1,500 women policemen were deployed, officers said, alongside five additional companies of women paramilitary personnel. Groups of women officers marched along Parliament Street, Janpath and Ashoka Road, checking IDs and manning barricades.

In a video showing CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke being detained from an aircraft, three women police officers can be seen entering it to take him into custody. Women officers were also seen carrying out detentions at the ITO intersection.

Several policemen wore body cameras. "Last time, there were allegations of us starting violence. We want to record the exchange with a protester," an officer said. At least 15-20 police personnel were seen wearing Meta smart glasses. However, a source said the personnel wore the glasses on their own and were not directed to do so.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta criticised the protest, accusing the Opposition of disrupting public life.

"Rejected by the citizens of the country, Rahul Gandhi and Arvind Kejriwal, along with their B-team CJP, want to turn Delhi into an arena. Who will take responsibility for the hardships faced by office-going employees, daily-wage labourers who earn a living for their families, and patients trying to reach the hospital? Are your political ambitions bigger than the livelihood, safety, and peace of lakhs of families in Delhi? Be reminded, holding Delhi hostage will not be permitted," she posted on X.



Protesters being chased by security personnel at Connaught Place on Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

•PROMINENT DETAINEES

8 AM: YouTuber Dhruv Rathee; **picked up from Gurugram**

11 AM: CJP's Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das; **from IGI Airport**

11.30 AM: CJP legal team head Ratna Singh and policy lead Mehr; **from South Delhi**

12 PM: Ex-Kerala CM Pinarayi Vijayan; **near Kerala House**

2 PM: AISA chief Neha, senior advocate Prashant Bhushan and activist Yogendra Yadav; **from Safdarjung Flyover**

2:30PM: AAP leaders Arvind Kejriwal, Sanjay Singh, Saurabh Bhardwaj and Kuldeep Kumar; **from Central Delhi**

2:30PM: Former CM of West Bengal, Mamata Banerjee; **from South Avenue Bus Stand**



X/YOGENDRAYADAV

AISA chief Neha, advocate Prashant Bhushan, activist Yogendra Yadav & CPI(ML)'s Dipankar Bhattacharya.

'Our fight for accountability far from over': After July march, protesters hit roads again

Tabshir Shams & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, October 10

AJEET SINGH packed sandwiches and sachets of ORS before taking his scooter out of his Paschim Vihar home shortly after 9 am on Saturday. A teacher, he had injured his legs during the Cockroach Janata Party's (CJP) July protest. Three months later, he was back on the road, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

At the police barricades that had sprung up around his neighbourhood, one officer asked him where he was going. "To meet friends," he replied and was allowed to go further.

But he did not get far.

At Punjabi Bagh, where he met friends Aaliya, who runs a salon in Rohini, and Tushar Kumar, a political science graduate, the group was stopped and kept under detention for three hours. Tushar had suffered injuries to his abdomen and eyes during the July protest and had been admitted to Lady Hardinge Hospital along with Singh.

After prolonged persuasion, the police allowed the group to proceed only to be stopped again near RK Ashram Marg.

This time, they didn't argue with the security personnel. They took a narrow lane near a Jain temple and emerged at Gole Market, where they parked their vehicles and walked the remaining stretch. Around 4 pm, they marched towards Bangla Sahib Gurdwara.

For 27-year-old Hameed, an engineer from Thiruvananthapuram who wants to pursue a career in music, there was little question of returning home after learning of the protest called by CJP.

"I knew I had to be here," he said around 1 pm, shortly after being detained by the Delhi Police. Hameed had participated in the July protest in Mumbai, where he had been living for three years.



Police detain protesters on Saturday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Staying at his brother's place near the airport, he still faced trouble getting here despite leaving early. While getting a cab took time, the journey took around one-and-a-half hours to reach Raj Ghat. He then walked for over 2 km to meet other protesters.

"I can't stay at home and do nothing...," he said.

Along with members of the Disha Students Organisation and the Revolutionary Workers Party of India, Hameed managed to march nearly a kilometre from Ghata Masjid Colony towards Raj Ghat before the police detained protesters.

For a 31-year-old filmmaker from Noida, participating in the protest meant travelling to a friend's place in Delhi the previous night to avoid being stranded by Metro restrictions. On Saturday morning, she took the Metro from Palam to Lal Quila, carrying a camera.

Having participated in the July protest at Jantar Mantar, she said Saturday felt more scary. In July, she had been surrounded by friends; this time, she came alone and met fellow protesters on the way.

"For me, the protest has a longer history than just CJP. They're just remobilising it today. I feel like everyone is frustrated," she said.

Nitin Raj (26), a corporate employee from Ghaziabad, had also participated in the July protest and stayed at Jantar Mantar for a few days. On Saturday, he left home at 7 am to join the demonstration.

At a border checkpoint, he was asked where he was going by security personnel. "I said I had office work," said Nitin.

He made it as far as Sarai Kale Khan in a bus. After that, autorickshaws refused to take him to CP. "I had to walk to CP. Almost 10 km. I reached at 4 pm, and met Ajeet and the others."

Ajeet said the police response had prevented many from joining. "Police personnel made announcements from masjids and mandirs, and went door to door asking people to stay home. Restrictions on Metro services and buses compounded the difficulties," he added.

"Still, so many people came. They walked and they protested," he said.

After 5 pm, the group moved towards INA and joined the protest there before leaving as more demonstrators began being detained.

Was it worth it?

For Ajeet, success would not be measured by another resignation. "In July, a minister quit and, after that, nothing changed. Accountability is still missing," he said.

"If we can make people aware that the ECI's SIR is wrong, and that Form 6 directly affects our democracy and our right to vote, that is our victory."

Asked about the future of the protest, he said, "The movement will continue."

For the filmmaker from Noida, even the brief march was a small achievement. "It feels like a small win," she said.



TASHI TOBGYAL



GAJENDRA YADAV

(Above) Protesters clash with police near Baba Kharak Singh Marg; security personnel at CP late Saturday night.

HC Bar Association condemns detention of lawyers, 'excessive' use of force by cops

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, October 10

BY SATURDAY afternoon, purported videos had started circulating on social media showing senior advocate Shadan Farasat being picked up and detained by Delhi Police officers.

"It has become a police state. The value of a citizen is nothing today ... they (policemen) suddenly came towards Yogendra Yadav. I was trying to stop them. They tore my shirt and threw me inside a moving bus," Farasat said, adding: "I was worried ... my leg could have come under the bus."

Later in the day, the Delhi High Court Bar Association (DHCBA) condemned the detention of several lawyers and the alleged use of excessive force by police against people who attempted to take part in a protest demanding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

"The DHCBA expresses its strongest disapproval of the excessive and disproportionate use of force against the protesting lawyers, including women advocates. Video footage that has surfaced depicts lawyers, including Senior Advocates, being physically dragged by the police," a resolution read.

Lawyers who participated in a march near the Supreme Court Saturday also complained of alleged "disproportionate" police measures.

"We were holding the preamble in our hands. The protest was so peaceful. We were shoved into buses...They tore the Preamble," advocate Smiti Verma said. Senior advocate Nandita Rao was also detained, she added. Senior advocate Dinesh Dwivedi — whose elder brother Rakesh Dwivedi represented the Election Commission of India in the SIR matter — was also among the detainees.

"The right to peacefully assemble and express dissent is a fundamental constitutional guarantee ... maintenance of public order cannot be used as a pretext for arbitrary detention or excessive force against peaceful protesters," the resolution said.



A grab from a video shows senior advocate Shadan Farasat's detention on Saturday.

No cabs, Rs 100 e-rickshaw rides: Protesters struggle to gather

Nirbhay Thakur, Pragynesh, Mishal Mussaddique, Devansh Mittal, Drishti Jain
New Delhi, October 10

POLICEMEN STATIONED at Metro stations operational near Jantar Mantar, vehicle checks at city borders, hundreds of detentions, and massive deployment of security personnel: these were among the steps taken to prevent protestors from reaching the site of the demonstration called on Saturday by CJP and AISA against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged discrepancies in the SIR exercise.

The limited availability of cabs also added to the difficulty of demonstrators in reaching the protest site with drivers, working with app-based platforms, unwilling to go to Central Delhi. Commuters said they couldn't find taxis to take them near to the protest site.

"I have been getting requests to go to Connaught Place since morning with some even tipping and increasing prices to Rs 800 of rides that would normally cost Rs 300-400. But I'm not accepting because I don't want to get stuck for the whole day," said Lucky, a cab driver.

Sources in Uber said the firm had not received any formal communication or order from authorities, asking them to restrict or regulate services.

E-rickshaw drivers also raised fares with protesters struggling to find transportation, as per passengers.

Amid the closure of 45 Metro stations in Delhi, the Patel Nagar station was the one closest to Jantar Mantar, which was operational. With over a dozen CISF personnel deployed inside, it had 20 police personnel stationed outside.



A bus carrying detainees. GAJENDRA YADAV

There, Tazud (26) from Nagaland was waiting for the acquaintances he made — via an online group of people who want to go to the protest — to show up. "I couldn't attend the July protest so I don't want to miss it this time. I scrolled through comments on Instagram and found a group of people who were planning to go to the protest alone, and created a group at midnight," he said.

However, getting from the Metro station to the site was a struggle. Auto drivers refused to ferry people to Connaught Place and other places nearby.

Drivers of shared e-rickshaws were charging Rs 100 per passenger for the 5-km ride. "All roads to CP are blocked. We have to go around the barricades and take a long route," said one of them.

Jay Kumar, who works as a telecaller in Noida, boarded the Metro from Noida's Sector 16 and reached Central Delhi's Barakhamba Road, only to realise that the gates did not open there. He then went to the Yamuna Bank Metro station.

"I am a fan of Dhruv Rathee. I know that he has been detained, but I still want to go and see what is happening," he said.

There, shared autos were charging Rs 100 till Barakhamba Road, from where protestors walked to the protest site, about 2 km away.

At the nearby Akshardham Metro station, commuters were greeted with police barricades.

Barricades manned by Noida Police, Delhi Police, and the Border Security Force were put up along the Delhi-Uttar Pradesh border in Chilla where commercial buses were stopped and checked.

"We're checking in case large groups of people are trying to reach Delhi," a traffic police officer said.

A Delhi Police personnel stopped a private bus, checking the list of passengers on the conductor's phone and going through the pick-up and drop locations. "We're also stopping commercial four-wheelers," he said. Strict checks were in place at the DND flyway too. Shared commercial vehicles were being stopped and their belongings checked.

CJP calls fresh protest today; 30,000 cops to remain deployed



Security personnel deployed along Baba Kharak Singh Marg in New Delhi on Saturday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Sakshi Chand, Alok Singh & Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, October 10

WITH THE CJP calling for another protest at Jantar Mantar at 10 am on Sunday, Delhi Police will maintain heightened security across the Capital following Saturday's demonstrations and mass detentions. Around 30,000 police personnel, supported by 200 companies of paramilitary forces, will remain deployed, with barricades at Parliament Street and Jantar Mantar staying in place.

The fresh call for mobilisation comes amid uncertainty over the release of detained students, activists and CJP leaders.

Ajinkya Shinde, the CJP's national organisation in-charge, announced the 'Chalo Jantar Mantar' protest in a post on X, urging supporters to assemble at 10 am on Sunday. "We had gone to Jantar Mantar demanding the resignation of Gyanesh Kumar, who snatched the voting rights of 12 crore voters. But this dictatorial government, led by Modi and Shah, detained all our leaders – Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das – as well as all student leaders and volunteers," Shinde said.

"They think that if they detain us today, we will retreat out of fear. This fear on the part of Modi and Shah shows that we have already won half the battle. This is the beginning of a new struggle. I want to tell Modi and Shah that we will break their arrogance just as we did before. We will not stop protesting until we secure Gyanesh Kumar's resignation," he added.

"I appeal to everyone to turn up in large numbers tomorrow. Wherever the Delhi Police stops you, make that place your Jantar Mantar," he said.

According to a CJP statement, more than 15,000 people, including students, civil society members and political leaders, had faced detention and police action.

Delhi Police said its deployment on Sunday would remain the same as on Saturday. "Measures involving Metro and train services could be taken depending on the situation," an officer said. Sources in the police said personnel would continue monitoring sensitive locations across South, Central and New Delhi districts, including INA, Raj Ghat and Red Fort. The decision follows demonstrations at several locations on Saturday, including INA and Connaught Place. With Sunday likely to see further mobilisation, police are anticipating that protesters could again move towards Jantar Mantar, Connaught Place and other parts of Central Delhi.

"Police will review the situation by Sunday evening before deciding on the deployment required for Monday," an officer said.

With several students and activists still awaiting release as of Saturday night, AISA and SFI leaders said they had not yet decided on their next course of action. However, the CJP-SFI-AISF alliance said it would issue a call for a protest in the coming days. N Sai Balaji, a key AISA activist and former JNUSU president, alleged that some of the organisation's workers had been brutally beaten in detention and had not yet been released. Madhurima Kundu, another AISA activist, said the immediate focus remained on securing their release.

Sources in the police said those detained had been kept at around 30 detention centres across the city. As of late Saturday, police had not released three CJP leaders or YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, and their locations had not been disclosed, sources said.

Those detained could be released late Saturday night or by early Sunday morning, they added.

'Police can't force them out': Hundreds take refuge at Bangla Sahib, several detained

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, October 10





Over 100 protesters were detained near Bangla Sahib in New Delhi on Saturday. GAJENDRA YADAV

AS THE Capital turned into a fortress in the wake of a protest call by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, hundreds of demonstrators from across the city and other states took refuge in Gurdwara Bangla Sahib in New Delhi. On Saturday afternoon, over 100 demonstrators, who had gathered outside the gurdwara, around 1 km from the office of the Election Commission of India (ECI) at Ashoka Road, were detained by the police.

A staff member of the gurdwara management told *The Indian Express* that the police urged the gurdwara management to send the protesters out, but "the management refused to do so".

"People have been peacefully sitting, sleeping and eating here. Anyone, who comes inside the gurdwara is a visitor to us. Police are not allowed inside. Police can come only when there is a serious criminal incident, but these are students who have come to protest, which is their right. They cannot force them out... they are not criminals," the staff member said.

He said protesters were coming and going through the day. In the afternoon, some of them stepped outside the gurdwara's main gate in groups and were detained.

Yash Sen, who came from Agra to attend the protest, said, "Any person who goes outside is being detained. I have been here since last night, and there were many others with me."

Kamaljeet Singh, a devotee who came to Bangla Sahib along with his wife from Madhya Pradesh two days ago to offer prayers, said, "Since last night, around 1,000-2,000 student protesters have arrived at the gurdwara and are staying here. Early in the morning, around 8 am, police came to detain them, but the management did not allow them to enter the gurdwara. Some police personnel entered the premises near the main gate and dragged some students out, but the management firmly asked the police to leave and not enter the premises."

Around 150-200 students were detained from outside the gurdwara, Singh added.

One of the protesters, Anuradha Mewara, said, "I came from Rajasthan to participate in the stir and demand the resignation of the Election Commissioner. I was detained outside the gurdwara. They made us go around in a bus and dropped us near the Red Fort."

Some students inside the gurdwara said they were ready to step up the demonstration as CJP takes next steps. Yohan Makwana, who came from Gujarat, said, "We will turn up tomorrow as per the further updates." Afzal, a resident of Seelampur in Delhi, said, "I will come again tomorrow. "

Protester beaten, stones thrown at bus of detainees

Shashwat
New Delhi, October 10

EVEN AS the movement remained restricted in the Capital amid stringent security checks following a protest call by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and All India Students' Association (AISA) against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, tense moments unfolded near Palika Bazar in New Delhi on Saturday.

"Long live Delhi Police! Long live Gyanesh Kumar!": a group of 20 people raised slogans as they surrounded a young protester around 2 pm and started beating him.

"We'll slap anyone who abuses (Prime Minister Narendra) Modi. Gyanesh Kumar should be awarded the Bharat Ratna, and if Delhi Police are beating people, they're doing the right thing," said one of the group members.

Senior police officers said that they have not received any complaints but have taken cognisance of the videos being circulated online of the incident. The incident is being probed, an officer said.

Meanwhile, another footage showed some people throwing stones at a bus holding detainees in Jhandewalan.

The incidents came as Delhi was turned into a fortress after the CJP and student outfit AISA called for a protest against the alleged discrepancies in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision exercise of voter rolls. Among the thousands detained were CJP founder Abhijit Dipke, his colleague Saurav Das, and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee.

Former AAP member, techie: Ajinkya, CJP's new face of protest

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 10



Ajinkya Shinde holds a presser.

COCKROACH JANTA Party national organisation in-charge Ajinkya Shinde has been tasked to lead the protests by the youth platform following the detention of CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and other top leaders on Saturday.

Dipke and his colleagues Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained by the Delhi Police from an aircraft shortly after their flight from Mumbai landed at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport around 10.20 am on Saturday. The three were whisked away to an undisclosed location. Police sources said they were being held separately from each other.

Soon after, in a 20-second video posted on social media, Dipke said that Das, Ranka and he had been arrested, and that "from now onwards, Ajinkya will lead the movement".

The video was released while Dipke was purportedly in detention; however, sources said it was pre-recorded.

A resident of Alibaug in Maharashtra, Shinde is a former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) worker who campaigned for the party during the 2016 Goa Assembly elections and later worked for the party in Maharashtra.

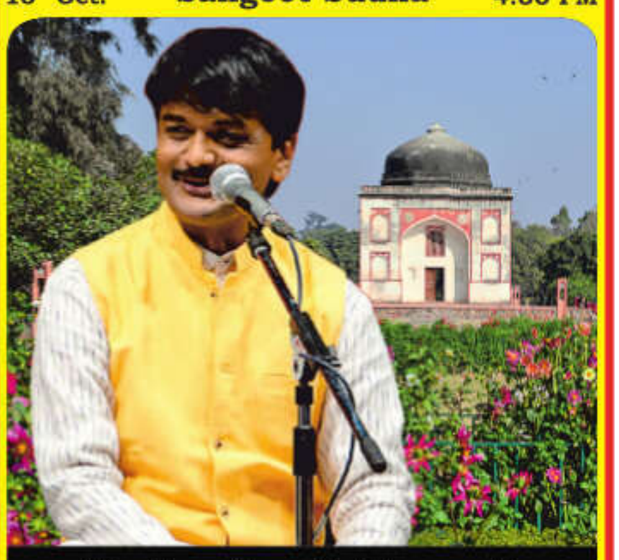
A computer science graduate, Shinde worked for a Pune-based IT company for several years. He quit a high-paying job in the IT sector before joining AAP following the anti-corruption movement led by Arvind Kejriwal. Shinde has been associated with the CJP since its formation. He participated in the protests in Delhi in June and July against the NEET examination paper leak, and has since become a member of the CJP's core team.

In a video message after he was tasked to lead protests, Shinde said, "As you may know our three CJP leaders were detained at Delhi airport by the dictatorial Modi-Shah government. This dictatorial government has once again become afraid of the unity of the people of this country. You may remember that the last time the entire country came together at Jantar Mantar [in June-July this year], we shattered the arrogance of the Modi-Shah duo."

"That is why", Shinde said, "to prevent people from reaching Jantar Mantar, they stopped trains, shut down bus services, and detained people wherever they were coming from."

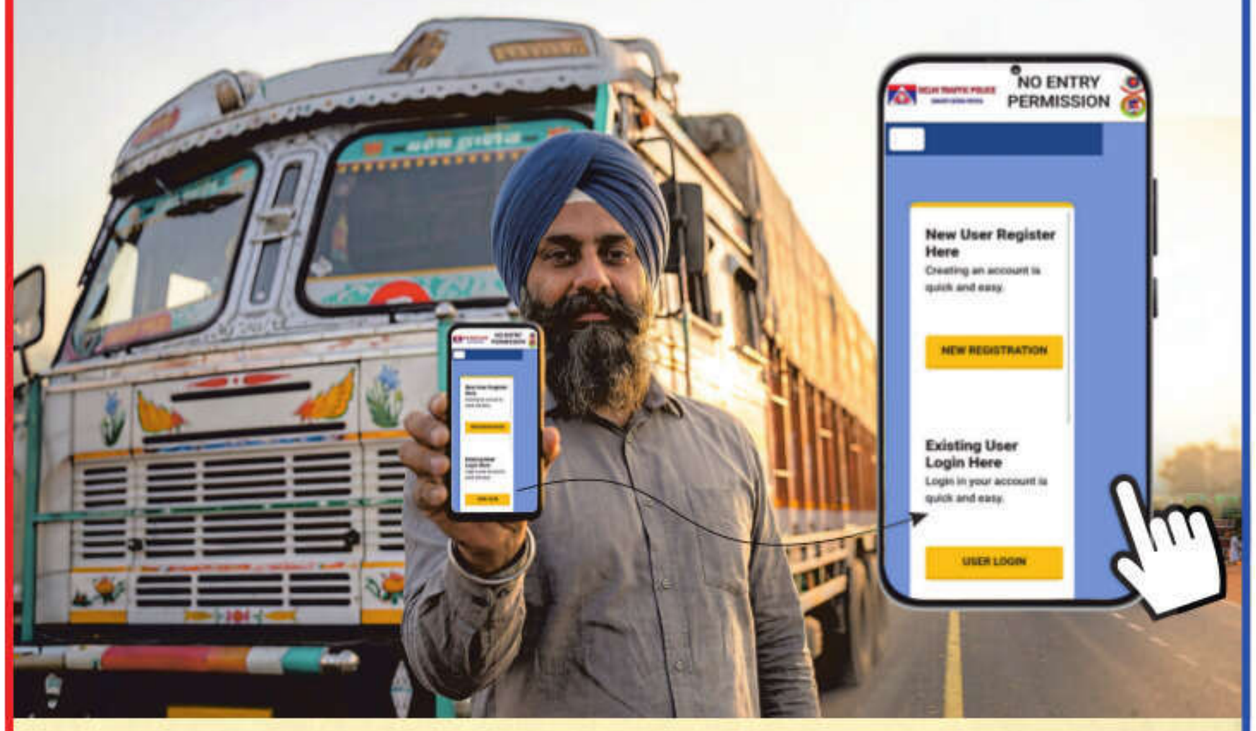
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NOTIFICATION
Adv.No.001 / Estt (T) / 2026 Dt.11.10.2026
Applications (Two copies along with one soft copy) are invited in the prescribed format from eligible candidates for appointment to the following posts in the University (1) REGISTRAR & (2) CONTROLLER OF EXAMINATIONS.
For further details, application form, qualifications and general instructions please visit the University website www.tndalu.ac.in. from 11.10.2026
The last date for receipt of application is 10.11.2026 by 5.45 p.m.
Any addendum / corrigendum shall be posted only on the University website. The University reserves the right either to fill or not to fill the post without assigning any reason whatsoever.
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The Sonepat Hindu Educational & Charitable Society
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ELECTION NOTICE
It is notified to all the life members of The Sonepat Hindu Educational & Charitable Society, Sonepat that election of Office Bearers i.e President, Vice-President, General Secretary, Treasurer & Members (Seventeen) to the Governing Body/Managing Committee of The Sonepat Hindu Educational & Charitable Society, Sonepat and also election of Members (Eleven) & Staff Representative (Teaching -2 & Non-Teaching-1) each of Governing Bodies of Hindu College, Sonepat, Hindu Girls College, Sonepat & Hindu College of Education, Sonepat run by The Sonepat Hindu Educational & Charitable Society, Sonepat is to be held on 22.11.2026. Election schedule will be as under:-

Date & Place on which nomination Papers shall be presented	27.10.2026 to 31.10.2026 (10.00 A.M. to 3.00 P.M) Hindu Vidyapeeth, Kath Mandi, Sonipat
Date on which the nomination papers shall be scrutinized	02.11.2026 & 03.11.2026 (11:00 A.M. Onward)
Date for withdrawal of candidature by a candidate	04.11.2026 (10.00 A.M. to 3.00 P.M)
Date on which symbols shall be allotted to the contesting candidates	05.11.2026 (11.00 A.M)
Place & Date on which the Poll, if any, shall be held	22.11.2026 (8.00 A.M to 5.00 PM) Hindu Vidyapeeth, Kath Mandi, Sonipat
Date, Time and place on which the votes polled shall be counted	22.11.2026 Immediate after the close of the poll Hindu Vidyapeeth, Kath Mandi, Sonipat

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& Governing Bodies of Hindu College, Hindu Girls College
& Hindu College of Education, Sonepat – Election 2026

Delhi protest: SC to hear contempt petitions against authorities today

Pleas challenge detention of Opposition leaders, shutting Metro, cancelling trains

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 10

THE SUPREME Court will hold a sitting on Sunday to hear petitions seeking initiation of contempt proceedings against authorities for detaining Opposition party leaders, cancelling train services and temporarily closing Delhi Metro stations in the wake of Saturday protests by the Cockroach Janta Party and other groups seeking Chief Election Commissioner (CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana will hear the petitions.

One of the petitions by Senior Advocate and TMC Rajya Sabha MP Menaka Guruswamy questioned the preventive detention of Opposition leaders, including four former chief ministers, saying it amounted to suppression of the fundamental right to peaceful protest. The plea challenges their detention from their residences and from the streets. It also challenges the detention of other protesters moving towards Jantar Mantar.

Another petition filed by Advocate Shailendra Mano Tripathi seeks contempt proceedings against Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) Chairperson D Thara for alleged violation of the SC's October 9 order against temporary closure of Delhi Metro services and cancellation of trains. The petitioners alleged that the measures taken by the authorities were disproportionate.

On Friday, the SC had directed the Centre to ensure that there was no "complete prohibition" on the movement of Metro and trains coming to Delhi on October 10, saying they cannot bring everything to a halt. "It appears that the notifications are overreaching, as they impose a complete ban upon essential public transportation," the court said and asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to impress upon the authorities "to reassess such prohibitions" and ensure that the response remains proportional.

The SC added that "there shall be no outright prohibition on the movement of Metro trains, a prudent decision may be made to permit the operation of Metro trains and other rail services in a suitable and regulated manner. Such a decision should be widely publicised to prevent further inconvenience."

It also asked the authorities to issue a traffic advisory intimating the public about the service availability.

The plea said: "Notwithstanding the solemn judicial mandate and the assurance recorded before the Bench of Hon'ble the Chief Justice, the contemnors have consciously maintained a blanket shutdown across transit corridors, persisted with unwarranted train cancellations, and failed to issue or publicise transparent traffic and transit advisories. This deliberate recalcitrance has severely crippled public life across the National Capital Territory, stranded essential travellers and amounts to an intentional attempt to bypass and undermine the authority and majesty of this Hon'ble Court."

Following the SC order, the DMRC had revised its earlier decision and reduced the number of stations that would remain closed to 45.

At Chennai event, Rahul says PM silencing voices

ENS & PTI
Chennai, October 10



Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay and Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in Chennai on Saturday. PTI

CONGRESS LEADER Rahul Gandhi on Saturday said in Chennai that "Mogambo Modi" is destroying India's democracy. The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi of indulging in "vote chori".

"PM Modi is silencing voices; as you saw in Delhi, the entire city was shut down, and police were beating students. The BJP also unleashed its goondas who beat up students," Gandhi said at the sixth edition of his youth outreach initiative, 'Chhatron Ki Goonj', which was earlier held in Kota, Dehradun, Prayagraj, Pune and Indore.

"The problem is, Mr Modi does not understand that the game is over. The drama that he has been doing for the past 15 years is coming to an end. We will ensure that Modi pays for the crimes he has committed against the country," he said.

"Mogambo Modi" is destroying India's democracy, he said, referring to the villain from the Bollywood film, Mr India. As Gandhi delivered the line, the screen behind him played a scene from the 1987 movie with Modi's face superimposed on Amrish Puri. He said his message to students is that they should not fear anything, stressing that all those who attacked the Constitution and democracy will be brought to justice.

Gandhi also alleged that Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah have launched a "full-scale attack" on Tamil culture, language and history. "Amit Shah openly says that Hindi will be imposed on Tamil Nadu. It is Modi and Shah who are stifling curiosity. This is happening through the New Education Policy; a three-language formula has been imposed," he said.

Claiming that Tamil Nadu is being punished through the design of delimitation, he said, "We won't allow Modi to attack Tamil culture, language and history."

LoP vows to defeat regime

Chennai: On a day flash protests took place at several places in Delhi, Gandhi said that he was proud of the youth of India, claiming that PM Narendra Modi and others around him "are slowly finding the space closing around them".

Gandhi appealed to the youth to keep protesting and said he has been fighting "Narendra Modi and the RSS for over a decade now". "The core characteristic of these people is cowardice, he said. "...We are going to ensure that this regime and the people who have attacked our Constitution are defeated."

Meets CM Vijay

Earlier in the day, Gandhi had lunch with Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay. Gandhi arrived at Chennai airport around 12.30 pm and travelled to Vijay's Neelankarai residence. This was his most significant political engagement in Tamil Nadu after a long period in which his appearances in a state once central to Congress's national Opposition strategy had become strikingly rare.

A day after hosting Gandhi, Vijay is scheduled to appear with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on October 11 for the inauguration of the first operational stretch of Chennai Metro Phase II - their first joint public appearance since Vijay became CM.

The programme is administrative, with Modi set to inaugurate the 14.64-km Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch and travel with Vijay by Metro from Poonamallee to Porur. But its political optics are difficult to separate from the event. For Modi, travelling beside one of Tamil Nadu's most popular political figures provides a powerful public frame in a state where BJP has struggled to acquire one of its own. For Vijay, the sequence is equally striking. Lunch with the principal national Opposition leader Saturday, a Metro ride with the PM Sunday, the obligations of governing place him physically beside the two poles of national politics.

2010-batch IAS officer appointed Deputy Election Commissioner

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 10

THE APPOINTMENTS Committee of the Cabinet on Saturday appointed 2010 batch IAS officer Prakash Rajpurohit as Deputy Election Commissioner in the Election Commission of India, filling the vacancy caused by the premature repatriation of then-DEC in-charge of electoral roll and IT division Sanjay Kumar to his parent cadre in August.

Rajpurohit's appointment was one among 27 Joint Secretary or Joint Secretary equivalent appointments approved by the ACC, as per the order by the Department of Personnel and Training. The Rajasthan cadre officer has been serving as Joint Secretary in the Department of Defence Production under the Ministry of Defence since May this year. As per the order, he has been appointed till April 2030.

Kumar had been DEC from August 2024 till August this year, when he was prematurely repatriated to his parent cadre and posted in the Delhi government. He had been responsible for the electoral roll and IT divisions of the ECI, and had signed the ECI's June 24, 2025, order initiating the SIR in the country.

As reported by *The Indian Express* last month, the functioning of the IT division of the ECI had been one of the issues raised by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi in internal communications. One of the decisions they had raised objections to was the removal of Kumar as the DEC in-charge of IT in July.

According to ACC order, Vivek Khare, a 1996 batch Indian Telecom Service officer, will be the Joint Secretary, National Testing Agency (NTA), and Varnali Deka, a 2009 batch IAS officer of Assam-Meghalaya cadre, will be the Joint Secretary, National Health Authority.

EXPRESS special

'All of Delhi... entire country is Jantar Mantar for us now'

EXPRESS interview



JOHN BRITTAS
RAJYA SABHA MEMBER

FORMER KERALAM chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, Rajya Sabha member **John Brittas** and former state minister K N Balagopal were detained by Delhi Police from the Kerala House, just metres away from Jantar Mantar.

The detentions came during the protests called by the CJP in the Capital.

The Left parties are supporting the protest. Brittas spoke to **Asad Rehman** on his detention, the situation in Delhi and the protests across the country demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. Edited excerpts:

What happened when Pinarayi Vijayan, you and some other CPI(M) leaders were detained?

Unfortunately, we were taken in a small police jeep. For three and a half hours, the vehicle was plying on Delhi roads. This was done despite us saying that take us to a police station or a jail. Till 2.30 pm, we were on the road. Pinarayi Vijayan is one of the senior-most political leaders of the country... And this is how Delhi police treated him. He is undergoing medication and is a senior citizen. Forget about Balagopalam and me...

How do you see the overall situation in Delhi since Friday?

The overall situation... I can tell you that we are at Mandir Marg police station and it is 5.30 pm. There is a virtual police raj and clampdown in Delhi. Today morning, when I left my place, it took me two hours to reach Kerala House. I was stopped at six to seven places. I have never seen a situation like this in Delhi.

We saw the CJP leadership, including Abhijit Dipke, being detained from their flight. What do you have to say about that?

What I don't understand is how can people be picked up from a plane. Don't you think it is against civil aviation security? Somebody is picked up. What is the crime they have committed? Is it someone who robbed a bank? They have given safe passage to those who have taken thousands of crores. And those protesting in a peaceful manner are picked up. We were just standing in front of Kerala House just because it is close to Jantar Mantar. We were rounded off, picked up and detained... Someone says this is a democracy. Actually, basic rights and civil liberties are being trampled on.

We were travelling because we were taken in a police jeep. Even in Old Delhi areas, which were supposed to be unaffected, we saw small groups of people, students protesting and raising slogans. We saw them being sternly and brutally handled by the police. I have never seen Delhi like this in 38 years. All roads are blocked. I have never seen such a complete siege. I don't know the number of security forces deployed here. They say 48,000. But I think it is much more.

We have seen LoP Rahul Gandhi lead protests in Delhi over the past few days. Today, he is in Chennai. As his ally, what do you make of his absence amidst protests in Delhi?

I don't want to comment on that because it is a decision of an individual leader who leads another political party. They had decided to take a break of two days — INDIA bloc MPs. At the same time, we had conveyed that we will participate in the protests at Jantar Mantar... At the end of the day, INDIA bloc will resume protests on Monday. That was the decision.

What is the plan for Sunday and how do you see the situation panning out over the next few days? What will be the plan of action for Left student organisations and parties?

The government thinks that preventing us from entering Jantar Mantar today will be the end of the struggle. There is nothing like that. The agitation will continue in different ways and forms. We want to make all of Delhi Jantar Mantar. All of Delhi is Jantar Mantar for us now. The entire country is Jantar Mantar.

We have seen political parties lead protests over the last few days. Would you describe the protests on Saturday any differently? How do you see this movement and how would you describe it?

I feel this is a 360-degree movement in the sense that every section of society in some way is participating. Even former judges, bureaucrats, activists, politicians, housewives... everyone is associated in some way. A judge may not come out on the roads. But emotionally they are supporting the cause. The spectrum is very wide.



Sonam Wangchuk

Wangchuk warns of fresh fast if detainees not released

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, October 10

CLIMATE ACTIVIST Sonam Wangchuk on Saturday condemned the detention of student leaders and activists in Delhi, calling the situation "a state of undeclared emergency" and warning of another fast unless the detainees are released.

"Several youth leaders, MPs, journalists and activists were arrested in Delhi today. Yesterday, when I appealed for peace ahead of today's protests, I believed the world's largest democracy would allow peaceful protests. But it now feels like an undeclared emergency. I condemn this in the strongest terms. If the detainees are not released within 24 hours, I will consider another peaceful protest, whether a hunger strike, sit-in or protest march, in Leh or Delhi. I hope these issues are resolved before we take these steps," Wangchuk said in a video.

Condemning the detentions, Wangchuk said he hoped the government would resolve the issues through dialogue. "I had never imagined that the biggest democracy in the world would be under an undeclared Emergency. I was happy there were so many leaders to lead the movement, but I now learn that they have all been arrested. I hope those arrested will be released soon. I will be compelled to consider an Anshan Fast or Padyatra March if they are not released by tomorrow".

Dipke's kin slam Govt, say honest youths are being put behind bars

Express News Service
Pune, October 10



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and co-conveners Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were detained from an aeroplane at the Delhi airport on Saturday. PTI

EVEN as the Delhi police on Saturday detained CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, his family slammed the Centre for putting "youths who are fighting honestly for the country and democracy" behind bars.

"No action is taken against wrongdoers roaming free; however, youths who are fighting honestly for the country and democracy are being put behind bars," said Anita Dipke soon after her son was detained by Delhi police.

Anita accused the government of trying to suppress the voice of youth who are peacefully raising their voices against it. She said today the country presents a picture where democracy and citizens' fundamental rights are in danger. "Before he left for Delhi, I had a phone conversation with Abhijeet, during which he expressed the possibility that he could be arrested," she said.

"My son is not fighting for his own selfish interests, but for the common people of the country. Against this injustice, Ambedkarite organisations and conscious citizens will surely take to the streets and raise their voice," she said.

His father, Bhagwan Dipke, also slammed the government. "My son has been continuously working for the welfare of society and the country. Seeing such a youth being detained from a plane like a criminal causes intense pain in my heart. In a democracy, everyone has the Constitutional right to express their opinion and register opposition in a peaceful manner. Suppressing the voice of opponents with guns and police intimidation in this manner is wrong. Against this oppression, all progressive and Ambedkarite organisations should come forward and stand firmly," he said.

On a day Abhijeet was detained, his grandmother passed away in Hingoli. Savitribai Dipke passed away at her native village Santuk Pimpri. She was 75. Abhijeet's parents left Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar for Hingoli early morning. The final rites will be performed on Sunday morning.

India slams UN rights body for raising concern over mass detentions

Divya A
New Delhi, October 10

THE UN Human Rights Office has expressed concern over the mass detentions of civil society members, lawyers, and journalists in Delhi during protests organised by the CJP on Saturday.

They also called for an immediate and unconditional release of protestors detained during the day. India's permanent mission in Geneva has dubbed the "concerns" as misplaced, "causing an unwarranted interference in the internal affairs".

UN Human Rights spokesperson Thameen Al-Kheetan called upon Indian authorities to respect and fulfil the right to peaceful assembly, noting that restrictions must meet strict tests of necessity and proportionality.

In their response, the Indian permanent mission to the UN in Geneva said, "India is the world's largest democracy, where the right to peaceful assembly is guaranteed by our Constitution and safeguarded by robust institutions, an independent judiciary and a free media... As in every democracy, Indian citizens exercise this right subject to reasonable restrictions in the interest of public order. The authorities, for their part, act in accordance with the law, and our courts remain available to all for redressal of any grievances."

The concerns are therefore misplaced and constitute an unwarranted interference in internal affairs of India. In their statement, UN official had said, "We are concerned by reports of mass detentions in India of demonstrators, protest leaders, members of civil society organisations, lawyers and journalists, before and during today's large-scale demonstrations in Delhi." We also urge the authorities to engage in meaningful dialogue to address the concerns.

Policemen reach Rohtak village to detain protester, villagers take them hostage

Express News Service
Chandigarh, October 10



The villagers also refused to let the police team leave until they or a senior explained their actions in writing. EXPRESS

A POLICE team's attempt to detain a Zila Parishad member to prevent him from attending a protest in Delhi triggered a hours-long stand-off with villagers in Haryana's Kabulpur on Saturday, with hundreds of residents instead "detaining the officers" and refusing to let them leave until they or a senior explained their actions in writing.

The confrontation began around 6 am when a team from Shivaji Colony police station, led by Station House Officer Rakesh Kumar, reached the residence of Jai Dev Dagar, a Zila Parishad member. According to Dagar, the police intended to detain him to prevent him from travelling to Jantar Mantar in Delhi for a protest organised by the CJP.

Dagar made a few phone calls and within minutes, hundreds of villagers gathered outside his residence. They confronted the police personnel and insisted that a senior officer from Rohtak arrive to explain the proposed detention. The villagers then refused to let the police team leave, turning the attempted detention into a stand-off that lasted until around 1 pm.

Videos of the confrontation went viral on social media. The impasse ended after the police personnel handed the villagers a handwritten note explaining the reason for their visit. Signed by members of the team, the note referred to prohibitory orders imposed by the Rohtak district administration and stated that Dagar had announced plans to attend the Delhi protest. It added that the police had visited his residence to detain him under relevant provisions of law.

Dagar, however, maintained that attending the demonstration was an exercise of his democratic rights. He said he was not affiliated with any political party but believed in standing up for justice.

SHO Rakesh Kumar sought to downplay the confrontation, describing Dagar as a law-abiding citizen who had cooperated with the police. He said the team had visited Kabulpur because Dagar had announced that he would attend the demonstration, which, according to the police, lacked the necessary permission. It was the police's responsibility to prevent people from gathering at the venue, he said.

On the circulation of videos of the incident, Kumar said villagers were free to record and share the footage, adding that the police had no intention of stopping them from doing so.

Tushar Gandhi, actor Imran Khan among 600 detained in Mumbai

Express News Service
Mumbai, October 10

OVER 600 people, including actor Imran Khan and Mahatma Gandhi's great-grandson Tushar Gandhi, were detained in Mumbai on Saturday as they attempted to participate in support of the protest led by CJP at Jantar Mantar in Delhi.

The protesters had not obtained permission to hold demonstrations at various locations in Mumbai, prompting the police to step in and detain them before they could assemble, DCP Ragasudha said. Around 100 people were detained in the eastern region and 45 in the western region, while they were heading towards August Kranti Maidan and Hutatma Chowk in South Mumbai. A few members of Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA) also reached Hutatma Chowk to protest when they were detained, said the officer.

Mumbai Police detained Tushar Gandhi, president of "Ham Bharat Ke Log" near National College in Bandra, while he was on his way to August Kranti Maidan. Gandhi later posted on social media that he had been taken to DN Nagar police station. However, police denied that he had been arrested.

The protesters were released later in the day. The Gamdevi police have registered an FIR naming 12 people, including Tushar Gandhi. Police have also booked over 300 unidentified persons under BNS sections 223 (disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant), 126(2) (wrongful restraint), and 189(2), 189(3) and 189(5) (offences related to unlawful assembly).

Police personnel were deployed at several prominent locations across the city, monitoring the movement of protesters and preventing them from assembling at a single location.

NIA to probe 'larger conspiracy' in mid-air attack on Indian pilot

Agency registers FIR to probe if the Omani first officer, who stabbed Machchhar in the cockpit, acted alone or as part of some module

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, October 10



Captain Smit Machchhar

THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency (NIA) on Friday has registered an FIR into the mid-air attack on Indian pilot Captain Smit Machchhar aboard flydubai flight 1073, with the Centre directing the agency to probe a "larger conspiracy" behind the incident in which an Omani first officer allegedly stabbed the captain in an attempt to hijack or crash the aircraft.

The case was registered on Friday under the National Investigation Agency Act, 2008, after the Centre said the matter carried grave national and international ramifications.

According to the complaint, the information before the Centre states that Flight 1073 departed Dubai at 7.05 am on September 30, carrying 174 passengers—most of them Israelis—and six crew members, with Captain Machchhar and an Omani first officer at the controls.

"At around 9.21 am, while flying near the Jordan–Saudi Arabia border, the aircraft dived rapidly and turned back into Saudi airspace," it said.

According to the passengers' accounts set out in the FIR, the first officer stabbed Captain Machchhar during the flight in an apparent attempt to hijack or crash the plane.

The attacker was later overwhelmed and restrained by passengers and crew.

The captain sustained deep cuts to his head and hands in the attack.

"Other flydubai pilots on board subsequently landed the aircraft safely at Prince Sultan bin Abdulaziz Airport in Tabuk, in Northwestern Saudi Arabia, at 10.45 am. The first officer was arrested by Saudi authorities following the landing," the complaint said.

The FIR records that the information discloses the commission of offences against Machchhar, an Indian national, under the Anti-Hijacking Act, 2016, and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967 — both of which are scheduled offences under the NIA Act.

The Centre said the gravity of the offence, its grave national and international ramifications, and the need to unearth a larger conspiracy required a thorough investigation by the National Investigation Agency.

"The registration of the first information report marks the formal launch of the federal agency's investigation into the September 30 incident, which will examine whether the first officer of the aircraft acted alone or as part of some module," an official said.

FIR likely against former CM Pinarayi, daughter, son-in-law tomorrow

Express News Service
Thiruvananthapuram, October 10

THE VIGILANCE and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) will on Monday register an FIR against former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T Veena, son-in-law Muhammed Riyas and others in connection with the payoff scandal involving Veena's IT firm.

A single bench of the High Court on Friday directed the VACB to register an FIR against Vijayan and others under relevant sections of the Prevention of Corruption Act, based on a report the ED submitted to the state police chief last month.

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) is also probing allegations that Veena's firm Exalogic Solutions received illegal payments from Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited when the CPI(M) was in power.

Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala on Saturday said that the government would comply with the HC directive. "VACB will register the FIR on Monday. We are not going to appeal against the HC verdict. It is the policy of the government to comply with the court order."

On the government's earlier decision to order a preliminary probe based on the ED report, Chennithala said it had adopted a principled stand in accordance with the law. However, the HC had held that a preliminary probe was not mandatory before registering an FIR, he said.

Last month, the government ordered a preliminary inquiry after the ED submitted its report to the state police seeking registration of an FIR.

CPI(M) leaders have indicated that the verdict will be challenged. Party central committee member and LDF convener T P Ramakrishnan said, "There are courts above the High Court. The party will utilise the legal options against this dangerous trend," he said.

After the Congress government ordered a preliminary probe, BJP alleged the decision stemmed from an understanding between the CPI(M) and the Congress.

It pointed out that an I-T Department report on CMRL had named Congress leaders among those who received payments from the company. An appeal against the single-bench order would have helped BJP strengthen its allegation.

Cong veteran Babaria dies

Ahmedabad: Senior Congress leader and former AICC general secretary Deepak Babaria died at a hospital in Ahmedabad after a prolonged illness, party leaders said on Saturday. He was 75.

A behind-the-scenes man and close confidant of Rahul Gandhi, Babaria had been with the Congress since the 1970s. Though he never held an elected position, he was an organisational leader and a keen strategist, and was involved in creating the party's election manifestos.

Based in Ahmedabad, Babaria had been in hospital in recent days. He is survived by two daughters. **ENS**

Church vandalised in West Bengal amid protest over alleged conversions, probe on

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, October 10

A CATHOLIC church in West Bengal's Nadia district was allegedly vandalised on Friday evening after a group of people gathered outside the premises claiming religious conversions were taking place there.

The incident at St Louis Catholic Church in Jalalkhali, Krishnanagar, occurred amid recent allegations of attacks on prayer meetings and Christian congregations in different parts of the state. *The Indian Express* has reported similar incidents in North 24 Parganas, Howrah, Purba Bardhaman and Purba Medinipur districts.

"A complaint has been received and an investigation is on," a police official at the Krishnanagar police directorate said.

"We had a four-day prayer meeting programme and took permission from the police. However, on Friday evening, some people gathered outside the church and, using loudspeakers, claimed that conversions were going on," Father Vincent George of St Louis Catholic Church said, speaking to *Express* over the phone.

"Around 6 pm, people pelted stones, entered the church premises, vandalised the makeshift gates, and the glass cover of statues," he added.

Following the alleged vandalism, Christian community leaders attempted to block the road in front of the church, leading to a scuffle with the protesters. The police rushed to the spot and controlled the situation. Later a complaint was lodged at the Kotwali police station. "We have stopped our programme," Father George said. "We don't want such incidents to be repeated."

Christian community leader Herod Mullick, the founder of Bangiya Christiya Pariseba (Bengal Christian Council), said such incidents were happening frequently in different parts of the state. "We call upon the administration and local authorities to launch an immediate, impartial investigation, maintain law and order, and swiftly apprehend and book all the miscreants responsible," he added.

Meanwhile, Arindam Kar of Vishwa Hindu Parishad alleged that religious conversions were taking place in several parts of the state. "It is not only in Krishnanagar...conversions with the lure of money and miracles are being carried out. Such conversions are common," he said.

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ई–निविदा सूचना

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्र सरकार/राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र शासित/अर्द्धशासिक/सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों के कार्यों का कम से कम चार वर्ष का अनुभव रखने वाले ठेकेदारों/फर्मों से ई–निविदायें आमन्त्रित की जाती है। ई–प्रीक्योरमेंट सोल्यूशन द्वारा निविदायें द्विस्तरीय पद्धति से खोली जायेंगी। कार्यालय आदेश संख्याः वाई.ई.ए./GM (P)/2026/588 दिनांक 09.10.2026 के अनुपालन में यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण की कार्यों में संविदाकार द्वारा यदि न्यूनतम दरदाता (L1) द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू (BOQ) लागत से 10%: तक कम दरें कोट की जाती हैं, तो कोई अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा नहीं करनी होगी। लेकिन यदि न्यूनतम दरदाता द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू लागत से 10% से अधिक कम दरें कोट की जाती हैं, तो 10% से अधिक जितना भी प्रतिशत कम दरें कोट की जाएगी, प्रत्येक 1% पर 1% की दर से अतिरिक्त सुरक्षा/परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा करानी होगी। उक्त अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी अनुबंध का निष्पादन (एग्रीमेंट करने का समय ठेकेदार द्वारा जमा कराई जाएगी तथा परफॉर्मेन्स गारन्टी एफ०डी०आर०/सी०डी०आर०/बैंक गारन्टी/एन०एस०सी० के रुप में न्यूनतम संविदाकार द्वारा अनुबन्ध गठन से पूर्व देनी होगी, जो कार्य के अन्तिम बीजक होने के बाद वापिस होगी।

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
1	Supply and stacking of bhusa and green fooder for two year jewer banger gaushala. yeida WC-06	रू. 313.17 लाख

जिन्हें दिनांक 13.10.2026 से 21.10.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालीफिकेशन दिनांक 22.10.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
2	Construction of C.C Road and Providing and Fixing Interlocking Tiles (Including Const. of Drain) in Village- Faleda Banger, YEA. WC-06	रु0 143.50 लाख
3	C/o Rcc Drain of 130mtr wide road along Sec-21 yea Wc-02	रु० 1782.31 लाख
4	Construction of 6 Nos Tube well UGR and Rising main in Sector-8 yeida Wc-03	रु0 462.48 लाख
5	Providing and Fixing New Handpumps, Rebore and Repair of Existing Handpumps in 107 Villages/R&R (2026) of YEIDA. Wc-06	रु0167.22लाख
6	Providing and Laying Interlocking Tiles, CC Road and brick drain in village manchhipur Yeida WC-06	रु0 82.36 लाख
7	Construction of CC Road, RCC Drain and Providing and fixing interlocking tiles (including construction of drain) in Village- Makshudpur, YEA WC-06	रु0 79.20 लाख

जिन्हें दिनांक 14.10.2026 से 27.10.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालीफिकेशन दिनांक 29.10.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
8	Pond Rejuvenation at Village- Banwariwas, YEA. WC-06	रु0 29.89 लाख
9	Construction of cc road and interlocking tiles at different location in village-Tappal YEA.WC-06	रु0 28.29 लाख
10	Providing and fixing of police booth/traffic booth diferance location galgotias university tiaraha kheda meod rabupura falaida cut ch-32km interchange sabota underpass khurja underpass Yamuna gaur city (ronija) yeida- WC-01	रु0 15.40 लाख
11	Construction of barat ghar in village-Parsol YEA. WC-06	रु0 21.14 लाख
12	Construction of cc road, rcc drain in village-Tappal YEA. WC-06	रु0 11.76 लाख
13	Providing and Laying Interlocking Tiles and Brick drain from Shiv Murti to Lakha Singh House in village Achhepur YEA. WC-06	रु0 16.94 लाख.
14	Operation and maintenance of UGR Hydro abstraction well and water service at faleda banger village (for two years) WC-04	रु0 49.79 लाख

जिन्हें दिनांक 15.10.2026 से 26.10.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालीफिकेशन दिनांक 28.10.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

क्रम सं0	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
15	Development work of Gaushala Faleda Bangar yea Wc-06	रु0 41.53 लाख
16	Providing and Fixing Interlocking Tiles and Rcc drain in village-Udaipur yea WC-06	रु0 13.33 लाख
17	Construction of Boundary Wall of Playground and Open Gym in Village-Siroli Bangar, YEA. wc-06	रु0 41.12 लाख
18	Providing and Fixing Interlocking Tiles in Campus ESS at Sector-24, YEIDA wc-04	रु0 26.02 लाख

जिन्हें दिनांक 16.10.2026 से 27.10.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई–निविदाओं की प्री–क्वालीफिकेशन दिनांक 29.10.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

निविदा प्रपत्र उत्तर प्रदेश इलैक्ट्रानिक्स कारपोरेशन की वेबसाइट **http://etender.up.nic.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं। इच्छुक ठेकेदारों से अनुरोध है कि वे नियमित रुप से उक्त वेबसाइटों को देखते रहें क्योंकि निविदाओं के सम्बन्ध में कोई बदलाव अथवा अतिरिक्त सूचना बेबसाइट पर ही उपलब्ध करायी जायेगी।

महाप्रबन्धक (परियोजना)
यमुना विकास प्राधिकरण

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग/हाउसिंग/कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध हैं। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीद – फरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के भ्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

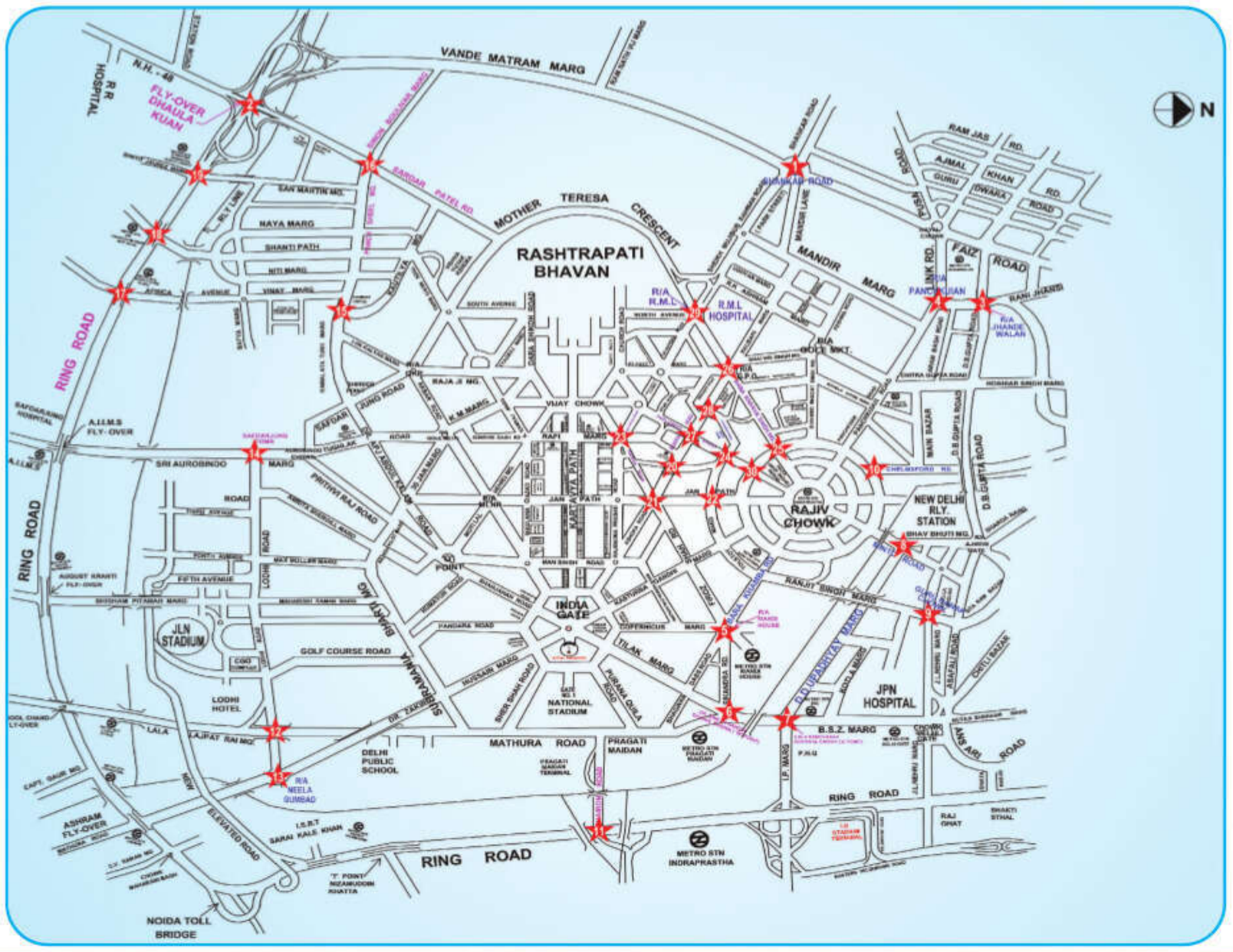
IN VIEW OF LAW AND ORDER SITUATION IN DELHI ON 11.10.2026

TRAFFIC POLICE DELHI

Diversions will be enforced starting from **06:00 AM on 11.10.2026** depending upon prevailing situation.

General public is informed that movement at following points and surrounding stretches might remain affected:-

1. Round About Shankar Road- Vande Matram 'T' Point towards New Delhi
2. Dhaula Kuan Flyover
3. Round About Jhandewalan
4. Round About Panchkuian
5. Round About Mandi House
6. Dr Dinesh Nandini Dalmia Chowk (W-Point)
7. Ram Charan Aggarwal Chowk (A-Point)
8. Minto Road/Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg
9. Guru Nanak Chowk
10. Chemsford Road - Outer Circle Connaught Place T-Point
11. Bharion Road- MGM (Ring Road) T-Point
12. Lodhi Road Flyover
13. Round About Neela Gumbad
14. Madarsa T- Point
15. Round About Samrat Hotel
16. Sardar Patel Marg- Panchsheel Marg Crossing
17. Under Bhikaji Kama Place
18. Under Moti Bagh Flyover
19. Ring Road-San Martin Marg T-Point
20. Round About Ashoka Road - Jantar Mantar Road
21. Round About Windsor Palace
22. Tolstoy-Janpath Crossing
23. Round About Rail Bhawan
24. Jai Singh Road - Sansad Marg Crossing
25. Outer Circle Connaught Place -Barakhamba Road T-Point
26. Round About Gol Dak Khana
27. Round About Patel Chowk
28. Jai Singh Road - Ashoka Road T-Point
29. Round About RML Hospital
30. Outer Circle Connaught Place - Sansad Marg T-Point



DP/9920/2026

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EXPRESS special

A raid, a grudge, a DVR

On July 17, nine men and women walked into an Andheri East firm, switched off the CCTV, seized every mobile phone and told the owner he owed the I-T department over Rs 1 crore. He refused to pay. Next day, the owner checked with the department, which said it had sent no one

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, October 10



The investigation team with the three accused in Mumbai. EXPRESS

ON A humid July afternoon, Rajkumar Kandaswami was at home, a typical two-bedroom set-up in Saki Naka, Andheri East. A businessman in his 50s who runs a company manufacturing medical equipment, he had returned from his office only an hour earlier. His mobile phone rang. It was one of his employees.

"Your office has been raided by the Income Tax (I-T department). Come over quickly to the office or my officials will pick you up," an unfamiliar voice thundered from the other side.

Kandaswami rushed to his office and found nine strangers, six men and three women. They told him he had been found evading taxes and would have to pay over Rs 1 crore to "settle the matter".

He was unnerved for a bit, then regained his composure. He refused to pay. "All my books are clean. I don't owe any department anything," he told them.

"You will end up behind bars," they warned. He didn't budge. Finally, the "raiding party" left.

For his 11 employees, whose phones had been seized, the long day seemed over. But Kandaswami couldn't rest. How could an I-T team leave without any documents? He visited the Income Tax office and learnt that the department had sent no one to raid his premises.

So who were the nine people who had so confidently searched his office? He lodged a police complaint. As the investigation proceeded, he would learn that the trigger lay in a routine action he had taken as an employer a month earlier.

Disgruntled employee

Kandaswami owns Two-M-Ophthotronics Private Limited, which manufactures, imports and exports high-tech ophthalmic and OPD equipment, including operation tables and indirect ophthalmoscopes, from an office in Sahar. On his rolls was a driver, 37-year-old Santosh Kapatkar, who had worked for him for six years.

"He was a difficult employee. For a long time, Kandaswami didn't fire him, thinking it would send out the wrong message," a police officer said. "He would launch into frequent arguments with Kandaswami, even go to the extent of humiliating him. His behaviour had started to affect the office atmosphere."

In June, Kandaswami asked him to leave. Kapatkar refused, allegedly using political contacts to try to get his job back. "I can pay him three to six months' salary without work but there was no question of hiring him again," Kandaswami told those who tried to mediate. Kapatkar got angry. "I will teach him a lesson. I will destroy him," he told other employees, and left fuming. Kandaswami dismissed it as an empty threat.

The making of a plot

In the first week of July, Kapatkar, a Sahar resident, allegedly walked into the I-T office at the World Trade Centre in South Mumbai and met Jyotish Sinha, a 42-year-old constable attached to the department. He told Sinha he had information about a businessman involved in illegal activities. "You should raid him," he said.

According to the police, Sinha asked whether he wanted a "legal or illegal" raid, claiming that he and his associates conducted both kinds "as per the requirement". Kapatkar made it clear he wanted to teach his former employer a lesson. Sinha understood the assignment.

Sinha contacted his friend Jitendra More, a Thane resident involved in impersonation cases in the past, and instructed him to approach Sunil Gore, a 59-year-old constable at the Bandra I-T office who was due to retire in about six months. Jitendra More brought in Reshma Warang, a Nalasopara resident, and the two met Gore. That, police said, was the first meeting to plan the fake raid.

A second meeting in the second week of July allegedly included Income Tax Inspector Suresh Kumar Mishra, 57. Next came Prem Sabnani, a Pune resident and Jitendra More's friend, chosen to impersonate a senior I-T officer. Then Ashok Shinde, a Vile Parle resident.

Kapatkar turned to his own circle, roping in Vinay More, 38, and Pragya Main, both Andheri residents he had known for over a decade. Police said the group wanted more women to make the operation look credible, so Warang contacted Sabina Sheikh of Andheri West and offered her Rs 1,000 to assist.

The nine-member team was ready. Kapatkar, who knew the office layout, briefed them on what to expect.

The day of raid

On July 17, three men arrived at the Sahar office in a rented car, the others on two motorcycles. They switched off the office CCTV cameras, told the employees to stay where they were and collected their phones. The office, around 400 square feet, had 11 to 12 staff. One of the fake officials called Kandaswami from an employee's phone and asked him to come immediately.

Kandaswami informed his wife, who decided to accompany him. The office was 3 km away. They booked a car, since Kapatkar's replacement was yet to be hired.

According to the complaint, two men on a motorcycle approached them. One, in a pink shirt and black trousers and wearing a mask, showed an identity card claiming to be from the I-T department. When the car reached the office, the two took the couple's phones and forced them to sit in the car. Kandaswami later realised they were coordinating with another man and a woman, who had followed them from home on another motorcycle.

Around 5.30 pm, the couple found the team questioning their employees inside the office. A medium-built man in his mid-50s with a thin moustache, in a white floral shirt and black pants, showed Kandaswami a document he said was a search warrant and asked him to sign it. He questioned him about cash transactions and threatened a heavy penalty. Another accused, in a red shirt, told an employee the businessman would have to pay Rs 1 crore to avoid action.

Kandaswami demanded a formal notice. The accused threatened arrest. He kept asking for a legal notice and refused to pay any money. Another member of the group then claimed Kandaswami had withdrawn Rs 1.7 lakh in cash from a customer's account, and threatened a penalty of Rs 1.44 crore. That too failed.

Meanwhile, on the instructions of Kapatkar, who was operating the "raid" remotely, the accused searched cupboards where they believed cash might be kept. They found nothing.

Kandaswami, his wife and the 11 employees were confined for several hours. The team finally left, but not without planting doubt. Why no legal search document? Why leave in a huff? Who gave the tip-off?

The next day, with his chartered accountant, Kandaswami visited the Income Tax offices at Churchgate and Bandra to check whether any raid had been authorised. He also approached the Mumbai Crime Branch and the local police. He was told no raid had been ordered. He submitted a written complaint to the Andheri police in August.

The probe

The "raiding party" made a crucial mistake. They switched off the CCTV cameras but forgot the digital video recorder. "The entire operation was recorded, and the footage became key evidence for the Andheri police. It helped the investigators identify several people who allegedly participated in the raid, including those suspected of having links with the I-T department," said a police officer.

DCP Datta Nalawade said, "During the alleged raid, the group demanded Rs 1 crore from Kandaswami. He refused, maintaining that he had not committed any illegal activity. Instead, he asked the men posing as officials to issue him a formal notice and said he would approach the I-T department and establish his innocence."

Police verified the identities of those in the footage and found two were I-T department employees. An FIR was registered on September 4 for impersonation, abduction and extortion.

Then began the search for the rest. Between September 4 and September 15, police arrested 10 accused from Mumbai, Thane and Pune — Kapatkar; Vinay Ramesh More, 37; Prem Kisan Sabnani, 50; Pragya Harish Main, 27; Reshma Shamrao Warang, 41; Sabina Hafeez Sheikh, 48; Jitu alias Jitendra Namdev More, 52; Ashok Vithoba Shinde, 57; Suresh Mahavirprasad Mishra, 57, I-T inspector; and Sunil Manohar Gore, 59, I-T official. Jyotish Sinha, who introduced Kapatkar to the group, is absconding. He reportedly approached the court for anticipatory bail and is believed to be hiding in Jharkhand.

Police have seized the accused's phones and are examining call records, WhatsApp chats and financial transactions to establish the conspiracy and identify other associates. They are also checking whether the group targeted other businessmen the same way. The involvement of I-T department employees is being independently verified.

Not the first case

Police said Sinha was also named in a similar case registered at the LT Marg police station in 2019. On December 2 that year, seven people posing as I-T officials entered Vijaykumar Angadia Courier Company in Bhuleshwar, claimed to be conducting a raid, and seized documents, cash and phones of around 17 employees. They assaulted some of the staff, took Rs 15.5 lakh in cash, locked the employees and fled. The accused were arrested, and during interrogation they disclosed that Sinha had suggested they pose as officials.

Jitendra More also has earlier cases in Mumbai and Thane for allegedly posing as a GST official. In the Thane case, eight accused, three of them journalists, were arrested in August for allegedly extorting Rs 25 lakh from a shopkeeper. Jitendra More and Shinde were among them, and were already in custody when their role in the fake I-T raid emerged. The Andheri police obtained their custody through production warrants. All 10 accused are in judicial custody.

DCP Nalawade said Kandaswami's clean books blew the cover off the racket. "He was very sure that he did not commit any wrongdoing. He had all his papers in place. That gave him the confidence to fend off the impersonators and approach the police."

9 killed, houses set ablaze in fresh Manipur violence; PM assures help to restore peace

Express News Service
Imphal, October 10

AT LEAST nine people were killed and around 14 houses set ablaze in a fresh outbreak of violence across Manipur's hill districts over 24 hours beginning Friday night, even as Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi, where the PM assured all possible assistance to restore peace and normalcy in the state.

The violence began on Friday night after Domkhonei Touthang, 42, a Kuki woman, was killed in an alleged exchange of fire between armed groups and security forces at Chassad village in Kamjong district. According to police, a joint team of Manipur Police, India Reserve Battalion (IRB) and Border Security Force (BSF) personnel had launched an operation to dismantle alleged illegal bunkers at Chassad when local women attempted to disrupt the drive and unknown assailants opened fire at the security team, prompting retaliation.

Tension escalated later that night when unidentified miscreants set several houses on fire, followed by gunfire between armed groups and security forces. Around 14 houses belonging to Naga and Kuki community were set ablaze.

Local sources said the incident occurred around 9.35 pm during a protest against the alleged arbitrary arrest and detention of Chassad Village Volunteers. The Kuki Women Union also claimed that a 23-year-old man, Michael Ngamminlen Haokip, was shot dead at Chassad, allegedly by Naga rebels.

Violence resumed on Saturday morning when unidentified assailants allegedly attempted to set fire to Chassad police station. Gunfire broke out again around 5 am and continued until 7 am. The Kamjong district magistrate imposed prohibitory restrictions within a 400-metre radius of the police station as a precautionary measure.

In a separate incident in Kamjong district, two Naga village guards — Ngachanso Ningshen, 30, and Leishishan Hungyo, 50, both of Ningchou village — were allegedly killed at around 9.30 am at Ningchou Chingdong village, approximately 17 km southeast of Chassad. Official sources said armed groups operating from across the border may have been involved, though there was no official confirmation.

Earlier on Saturday, at around 5 am, three Naga village guards were reportedly killed in an attack at Makui village, allegedly by a Kuki armed group. The deceased were identified as Machungammamg, Ajinpou Ringkangmai and Robart.

Villagers alleged that one of the victims, identified as Ajinpou Ringkangmai, was beheaded, with images circulating on social media. Security forces were unable to reach the site as firing was continuing at the time of filing this report.

A Naga village volunteer was also killed and two others injured in an ambush allegedly by suspected Kuki militants at Tapon village in Kangpokpi district at around 6 am on Saturday, along the Imphal-Tamenglong road near Makui village. The deceased, Machungwangbou, 35, was a resident of Thalon village. The two injured — Nahason, 29, and Mathangambou, 30 — were evacuated to Senapati district headquarters for treatment. The gunfight continued until noon.

In another incident, a commuter, Sandeep Rai, 30, a resident of Taphou Senapati Nepali village in Senapati district, was killed in an ambush by unidentified armed miscreants along National Highway 202 near Konjang village in Ukhrul district at around 5.30 am. Police said the assailants ambushed him while he was travelling by car. The motive and identities of the attackers remain unknown.

In New Delhi, CM Khemchand briefed Modi on the state government's initiatives to restore normalcy, highlighting the resumption of Imphal-Dimapur-Guwahati bus services and the movement of goods trucks on NH-37 (Imphal-Silchar) and NH-2 (Imphal-Dimapur). He also sought the upgrade of the Regional Institute of Medical Sciences (RIMS), Imphal, to the status of an All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS). Modi acknowledged the government's efforts and assured all possible assistance.

(WITH INPUTS FROM PTI)

AMU to hold student body polls after 8 yrs, removes proctor

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 10

AMID A protest by students for nearly 20 days, Aligarh Muslim University (AMU) has agreed to hold its student union elections after a gap of eight years and replace the current proctor from the post.

The decision to hold the election on November 5 and remove the proctor, Prof Mohammad Naveed Khan, was taken after the university administration held a meeting with the protesting students on Friday.

Prof Naveed Khan has been replaced by Prof Nafees Ahmad Ansari, chairperson of the Department of Political Science.

"With the announcement of the elections and removal of the proctor, we have brought to an end our protest which has been going on since September 21. Yasir Fahad, an MA student who was on hunger strike, has also broken his fast. We will be the first university in the state to hold a student union election after such a long gap," said postgraduate student Abu Maaz, one of the leaders of the protest.

The protest began after the university administration failed to give any assurance on their demand to hold the student union elections, he added.

On September 21, a group of students began the protest inside the campus, demanding that the union election be held. The same day, Yasir Fahad went on hunger strike, and as the days passed, more students joined the cause.

Former students of the university also visited the campus to show their support, while several rounds of talks were held between the university administration and a students' delegation.

Vice-Chancellor Professor Naima Khatoon went to the protest site and offered Yasir Fahad a glass of juice, formally bringing his fast to an end.

Gujarat to recruit former Agniveers into police force without exams, says Sanghavi

Press Trust of India
Surat, October 10

THE GUJARAT government has decided to recruit former Agniveers into the police force without any kind of exams, Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi said on Saturday.

A detailed clarification has been provided through a government resolution (GR), further information will be shared later, he added.

"The state government, has decided to recruit ex-Agniveers into the police force without conducting any examination," Sanghavi told reporters here.

"Earlier, ex-Agniveers had been exempted from the physical test. Now it has been decided that former Agniveers will be recruited under the 20 per cent reservation provided for them... They have also been granted an age relaxation of five years," Sanghavi informed.

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-36
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ई-निविदा सूचना

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Following murder complaint, Mangaluru man's body exhumed 3 months after death

Express News Service
Bengaluru, October 10

AN 86-YEAR-OLD man's body was exhumed from the Derebail Church cemetery in Mangaluru on Friday, nearly three months after his death, for a post-mortem examination and forensic analysis following a murder complaint against his daughter and others.

Mangaluru City Police Commissioner Sudheer Kumar Reddy CH said the exhumation and post-mortem examination were part of the investigation. "We are awaiting the post-mortem findings to establish the cause of death. Further action will be taken based on the findings", a police officer said, confirming that no arrests have been made so far.

Albert Rego, a resident of Kottara First Cross, died on July 19. The Urwa police registered a case of murder under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) on September 5, based on a complaint filed by his friend, Herald Pereira, who alleged that Rego was subjected to physical and mental harassment over property-related disputes and suspected foul play in his death.

Pereira said Rego had been in good health and was not suffering from any illness. He suspected that Rego might have been murdered or poisoned over property dispute and sought an investigation into the circumstances of his death.

According to the complaint, Rego had confided in Pereira that his daughter, Maya Rego, had allegedly been harassing him for several years, pressuring him to transfer his property to her name. Rego had also allegedly told Pereira that he had made a will in Maya's favour under pressure, while his other children were unaware of it.Pereira alleged that Rego had expressed fear that Maya might kill him over the property. He also claimed that Maya frequently quarrelled with her father.

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Sd/- MANAGING DIRECTOR, AGICL, Amaravati

Deported Jahanara and Mumtaz still 'missing', Gauhati HC warns state, Centre says search on

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, October 10

AS TWO women pushed across the border into Bangladesh before their final appeals were decided in court remain "missing", the Gauhati High Court has demanded answers from the Assam government on when the Nagaon Foreigners' Tribunal (FT) prepared its opinion regarding them.

On October 7, a Bench of Justices Kalyan Rai and Pranjal Das warned that if the state failed to provide the date and time as to when the opinion regarding Jahanara Begum and Mumtaz Begum being "foreigners" was readied, the court would presume that "it was not made ready within the appropriate time" before the two were taken into custody by police.

While the two cases are being heard separately by the same Bench, a near-identical order has been given regarding both of them, which was uploaded on the High Court's website on Thursday.

At the hearing, the Centre told the court that the Ministry of External Affairs was trying to trace the women. Its counsel said an inquiry into their whereabouts was ongoing and sought more time.

It was only after the families moved the High Court that the authorities disclosed what had happened to the women. On June 22, the state government's counsel told the court that both women had been handed over to the BSF. Two days later, the Centre's counsel said they had been deported to Bangladesh on the intervening night of June 13 and 14.

In September, the court directed the Assam government to probe when the Nagaon FT decided its fresh opinion regarding Jahanara, 47, and Mumtaz, 43, leading to their deportation, and said: "...if required, the said authority shall seize and send the Tribunal's computer which was used to prepare the said opinion to forensic experts to find out the time when the said opinion was finally made ready."

The cases of Jahanara and Mumtaz, with the court ordering Rs 2 lakh each as compensation to their families, are strikingly similar. A resident of Bagariguri village in Nagaon district, Jahanara got relief from the High Court in April this year, which set aside a 2019 opinion by the Nagaon FT declaring her a foreigner, saying it had failed to take into account the testimony of three of four witnesses.

Her son Mujahidul Islam said the court sent the case back to the FT for a fresh decision, and that Jahanara accordingly appeared before the tribunal on May 29. At the hearing, he said, the Member, Tribunal, refused Jahanara's plea for an adjournment and called the Border Police, who took her away before a fresh opinion had been passed by the FT.

The state government claims the FT once again declared her a foreigner that day, and that police held her from near the tribunal campus around 1.30 pm. A police diary records her arrival at the Juria police station at 4.02 pm. By evening, her fingerprints and photograph had been uploaded on the Foreigners' Identification Portal, Assam's database of declared foreigners.

Even as the family looked for her, Mujahidul said, he heard on June 1 that Jahanara had been moved to the Matia holding centre for alleged foreigners in Goalpara, more than 250 km away. He said he met Jahanara there the next day and applied for a certified copy of the FT's new opinion, which was released only on June 5.

When a relative went to Matia the next day with a vakalatnama, the family was told that the Border Police had already taken her away.

The state told the court that on June 2, the Nagaon District Commissioner issued an order under the Immigrants (Expulsion from Assam) Act, 1950, giving Jahanara 24 hours to leave the country. Police then took her to the Eraligool holding centre in Sribhumi district on June 3, more than 400 km from Nagaon, from where she was moved to the BSF's charge on June 13. In an affidavit to the court, the BSF said she was deported the same day, adding it had "no role in the process of determination of a foreigner" and only executed the state government's orders. It also said that Jahanara was deported in the presence of the Assam Police and an anti-human trafficking unit.

The family, which was still in the dark and had moved the High Court, got an order from the court on June 22 telling the BSF not to expel her. On June 24, the Centre's counsel told the court that she had already been deported.

As reported by *The Indian Express* earlier, Mumtaz similarly got relief from the High Court in April, which said the FT had failed to consider the evidence on record and sent the matter back for fresh consideration. But on May 30, when Mumtaz appeared before the tribunal, she was told she would be arrested, and was taken to the office of the SP (Border) in Nagaon and her details uploaded onto the Foreigners Identification Portal.

She was kept at the Nagaon Sadar Police Station, and on June 1, like Jahanara, shifted to the Matia camp. Papers later produced in court showed that on June 3, the same day as Jahanara, Mumtaz was moved from Matia to the Eraligool centre, and on June 13, pushed across the border by the BSF.

The state has defended its actions saying that declared foreigners "vanish from their last known address", and that given their status, they are not entitled to the full rights of a citizen.

In their September 3 order, Justices Kalyan Rai Surana and Susmita Phukan Khaund disagreed with this. They also called the Nagaon District Commissioner's expulsion orders as "farcical", given that the women were by then already lodged at the Matia detention centre. The court also held that the officer's direction that the women leave India within 24 hours "is a totally absurd proposition".

The Bench invoked the Supreme Court's decision in Roy V D vs State of Kerala, which held that Article 21 provides protection "not only to citizens of India but also to aliens".

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BJP has mastered reach, not listening



AVIRAL PANDEY

THE BJP has spent years building one of its biggest political assets in Uttar Pradesh: a network that reaches far beyond election campaigns. Its workers are present in villages, neighbourhoods and polling booths. Its welfare schemes have created a direct connection with millions of beneficiaries. Its message can travel from Lucknow to a village in UP with remarkable speed.

But, as UP heads towards the 2027 Assembly polls, there is another question the party cannot afford to overlook. The issue is no longer simply whether the BJP can reach voters. It is whether those who carry its message into villages and neighbourhoods still believe that the party, and the administration, are listening to them. That may prove to be a more consequential question than the familiar debate over anti-incumbency.

The concern is reflected in a complaint that has surfaced repeatedly within the ruling party and government, that political access does not always translate into administrative access. BJP workers and elected representatives have spoken of police officials, tehsils and other local offices who do not respond or take their concerns seriously.

This is not merely a complaint about bureaucracy. For a worker, the ability to get a citizen's problem heard is part of the political authority they carry. A worker can be loyal to the BJP, campaign and vote for it, yet begin to feel politically powerless if that authority no longer works in practice.

That is the kind of dissatisfaction that conventional opinion polls are unlikely to capture fully. A voter may receive a government benefit and remain unhappy with the local administration. A BJP worker may mobilise people for a party event and then find that even the citizen's basic grievance cannot be heard. An elected representative may have won an election but still struggle to get an administrative problem resolved.

The common thread is not necessarily declining loyalty. It is declining efficacy — the feeling that political connections no longer produce results.

For a party like the BJP, that can become particularly damaging because its organisation is not simply an election machine. It is also an information system. Booth workers, local office-bearers and elected representatives are the people who know where resentment is growing, which local issue is acquiring political force, which official is inaccessible and which government promise is beginning to lose credibility.

But an information system is useful only when information travels in both directions.

The BJP has to restore a two-way connection: government must respond to citizens, but the political organisation must also be able to carry citizens' experiences back into government

If workers can carry the government's message to citizens but cannot carry citizens' complaints back to government, the political network begins to work in only one direction.

The 2024 Lok Sabha polls offered a warning about the limits of political transferability. The BJP's tally in UP fell from 62 seats in 2019 to 33 in 2024. These results had multiple causes, but they demonstrated something important: voters can distinguish between different levels of politics. Support for a national leader does not automatically translate into support for every candidate.

The BJP appears conscious of that vulnerability. According to a recent report on the party's internal assessment, more than 100 of its sitting MLAs are facing grassroots-level anti-incumbency. The party is examining not only individual candidates but also constituency-level feedback, organisational performance and local friction.

Yet the number of vulnerable MLAs may be less revealing than what lies beneath it. An unpopular MLA can be replaced. A damaged relationship between the organisation and the administration is harder to repair.

This is where reports of booth-level fatigue become significant. The question is not simply whether workers will turn up on polling day. It is whether they continue to believe that their work has meaning when there is no election underway.

A grassroots worker's political capital depends partly on their ability to help people navigate the state. If a worker repeatedly tells citizens their complaint will be heard, but nobody responds, their credibility suffers.

The BJP's challenge is not merely to energise its cadre. It is to make the cadre effective.

Administrative responsiveness can quickly become an electoral issue. Polls are often shaped by accumulated experiences: a police complaint that goes nowhere, a certificate that takes months, or a citizen who discovers knowing a party worker does not necessarily help. Collectively, these incidents can alter how people understand the state.

Youth frustration over exams and recruitment is also about uncertainty and the absence of a dependable channel through which their concerns can be heard.

The BJP has to restore a two-way connection: government must respond to citizens, but the political organisation must also be able to carry citizens' experiences back into government. That is ultimately what will determine whether its formidable grassroots machinery remains an electoral advantage.

UP will vote on caste, welfare, employment, and Hindutva. But underneath these questions is another one that may be less visible and more consequential: when an ordinary citizen knocks on the political system's door, does someone inside still have the ability, and the authority, to answer? And for the BJP, there is an even harder version of the question. Does the worker standing at that door still believe they can open it?

Pandey teaches at Patna University

Congress party must do more than protest



FIFTH COLUMN

BY TAVLEEN SINGH

IN TIMES of political protests and government crackdowns, the role of a commentator like your humble columnist becomes fraught with charges of partisanship. This is what happened last week. While trawling social media platforms, I came upon a video of Priyanka Gandhi and some Congress ladies sitting in a circle, like at a wedding *sangeet* party, singing a song the Cockroach Janta Party made famous. Except that the target of the song was not 'Bal Narendra' but Gyanesh Kumar. Same tune, same gesture of rocking a baby to sleep, but the words were changed.

When the song was sung by young girls in Jantar Mantar, it had a resonance that was lost in this version. This made me express what I thought was an honest opinion about what is good for the cockroaches not being good for senior members of our oldest political party. By this I meant that the Gandhi siblings needed to come up with more than street-fighting to win public trust. And a few more elections than they have so far. Why have the party's think tanks not found the time to draw up a list of concrete reforms to the Election Commission and especially the process of appointing election commissioners?

This is not something I would expect the cockroaches to produce, but it is something that our main opposition party should already have come up with. Instead, their only demand is for the chief election commissioner's resignation. What real difference will this make? It will embarrass the government for a moment, and then a replacement will be chosen, who might be as much a lackey of the government as Gyanesh Kumar has appeared to be.

Never did I believe that this small criticism of the opposition party's tactics on 'X' would result in me being reviled for being senile, irrelevant and partisan. Aah... and that charge that always comes up, which is that I 'hate' the Gandhi family, because I was dropped from Sonia Gandhi's inner circle and have not got over this rejection. For the umpteenth time, I want to clarify that I was never in this inner circle, and if anyone knows that my friendship with Sonia ended, because of an article I wrote in *India Today*, they know this from me. Congress party trolls are every bit as abusive and viciously personal as those who defend Modi, so I found my timeline filled with such vitriol that I hesitated to open it.

What it has given me a chance to do, though, is to make a few suggestions that I hope the devotees of the dynasty take up with the Congress party's ruling family. Nobody stops them from street fighting, as a political tactic, but as India's only opposition party at the national level, should they not also give us alternatives to what they think the government is doing wrong? Rahul Gandhi bangs on about how every 'institution' has been destroyed by the Modi government, so can he suggest guardrails? Can he give us concrete examples of damage done? Can he lay out a detailed plan for reform? Is that not how the opposition is supposed to perform in a democracy?

Speaking of which, may I suggest that Rahul Gandhi stop repeating ad nauseum that democracy has been destroyed since Modi became prime minister. He has said this so often, and for such a long time, that the charge has lost its sting. It would be so much more interesting if he came up with an explanation of where he sees democracy being "destroyed" and in what way. Unless this happens, he leaves himself open to the charge often made that the only reason he says this is because he seems to find it so very hard to win elections.

He may have won a few more elections if he had gone to voters with a specific plan of what he would do differently if he became prime minister. What would he do differently with the economy? How would he reduce the corruption that is eating into the very soul of our ancient land? How would he improve the appalling state of government schools and hospitals? How would he improve governance, especially at the municipal and village level? How would he deal with the unemployment crisis? I could go on and on.

As for those of you who have spent the past week hurling abuses at me on social media, I have a small request. Please stop calling me "aunty". I am not related to you and have no wish to have any ties with people who spend their entire time vomiting bile from the safety of anonymous handles. You may believe that Rahul Gandhi and his sister are remarkable leaders for taking to the streets to shout slogans and create chaos. I happen to believe that in the exalted position they find themselves in, there is a lot more that they need to be doing.

In most democratic countries there are such things as shadow cabinets and alternative models of development. So why has the Congress party, after twelve years in the opposition benches, not been able to yet tell us what they will do differently if they come to power in Delhi? It is clear from the endless protests we have seen in recent months that people are looking for an alternative.

A lesson from Anne Carson and her Nobel



AISHWARYA KHOSLA

FOR ONCE, the bookies got it right. At the end of September, Ladbrokes had Anne Carson at 33/1, but a day before the Nobel Prize in Literature was announced, she was joint favourite, with the Chinese novelist Can Xue. The Nobel was once famous for its surprises; think Bob Dylan, or Abdulrazak Gurnah. But that is in the past. This year, Carson was clearly the safest bet. Since the Academy's 2018 scandal, the winner has alternated between men and women, and after László Krasznahorkai won last year, people expected a woman. She might be a safe pick, but her ideas are seismic, and I dare say, a few Indians might do well to at least hear.

Carson is a classicist who wrote her doctorate on Sappho, an ancient Greek lyric poet, and spent more than three decades teaching ancient Greek at Princeton, McGill and Michigan. Her first book of poems appeared when she was 42, late in an age when 12-year-olds are published authors. Everything original in her work rests on the unglamorous labour of reading dead languages line by line, year after year, until she produced something unconventional, thought-provoking, and original, despite its classical basis.

Not just original, Carson, whom one might be scared to approach for fear of arcane, complex prose, is one of the most playful writers. Proof that you cannot break a tradition in an innovative and original way until you know it inside out.

In *Autobiography of Red* (1998), she takes the surviving scraps of a lost poem by Stesichoros, a Greek poet who told the story of Herakles' monstrous victim Geryon partly from the monster's side, and turns them into a novel in verse about a shy, winged teenager who falls for a careless Herakles and gets his heart broken. In her translations of Sappho, she prints brackets where the papyrus is torn, rather than smoothing over the gaps. She writes that Stesichoros' fragments read as if someone had torn up the poem and buried it in a box, and she tells the reader, "Here. Shake," a line any author would do well to remember. An example of her playfulness and comfort with gaps is the title of Red Doc>(2013), which comes from the name of the file on her computer, an accident, which she simply kept. When a stray keystroke sent the book's margins haywire, she left them that way too.

Carson's Nobel comes in a year of epics on the big screen, from Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* to Nitesh Tiwari's *Ramayana,* which releases next month. But we have sadly lost Carson's brand of playfulness, a hallmark of Indian tradition. The *Ramayana* exists in hundreds of tellings: in Sanskrit, Tamil, and Bengali; in Jain, Buddhist, and folk versions; and across Southeast Asia. In some, Sita is Ravana's daughter; in others, Ravana is the tragic hero. Each was in dialogue with the others, and that is how the story survived for 2,000 years. The scholar A.K. Ramanujan made this argument in his essay 'Three Hundred Ramayanas'. In 2011, Delhi University dropped the essay from its history syllabus after protests.

Our epics are increasingly treated as scripture to be guarded, not literature to be reread and argued with. They have become rigid sermons rather than a dialogue that connects our culture and beliefs across generations. In today's India, a filmmaker's costume choice can start a controversy, and a novelist's reinterpretation can invite a police complaint.

These stories matter to millions, but refusing dialogue, gaps and asterisks included, risks freezing them. The *Ramayana* and *Mahabharata* did not survive two millennia by being told the same way twice. Perhaps the next retelling should be a dialogue with Gen Z, Alpha and Beta.

India has a growing body of retellings in English and Indian languages, and readers hungry for them, but what it lacks is confidence that comes from knowing the material inside out like Carson, and the belief that a retelling can deepen reverence rather than threaten it. If there is a takeaway, let it be this: that the study of Sanskrit, Tamil and Pali deserves funding as seriously as engineering.

The Academy's choice may not have been bold, but the writer it chose stands for a rebellious idea that the classics stay alive only when each generation has the knowledge to understand them and the nerve to remake them.

Carson ends one of her best-known prefaces by inviting readers to shake the box. We, too, should be brave enough to shake ours.

The writer is copyeditor at indianexpress.com

The aloo posto burger is not as innocent as it looks



KAUSHIK DASGUPTA

Now the potato patty sits inside a bun where the rice ought to be GETTYIMAGES

A CAFE CHAIN has put an *aloo posto* burger on its Durga Puja menu. And a section of Bengalis is incensed — perhaps understandably. The potato mashed, its edges crisped and browned, will presumably be folded into the nutty texture of poppy seed paste, pressed into a patty and tucked into a toasted bun. The umbrage, very likely, is not about the burger itself, but about seeing something intimate, pocket-friendly and comforting being recast in the language of fast food. When a dish has lived in one's home for generations, giving it a new form does risk making innovation feel like intrusion.

One of the oft-repeated accounts of eastern India's culinary history is about how *posto* became a part of the everyday meal. It is the story of a food born, in part, of the human instinct to make do with what is available. Cultivated in enormous quantities to supply the East India Company's extractive colonial trade, the opium poppy left its tiny white seeds behind for use in local kitchens. Soaked and ground on the shilnora, the grainy texture of the seeds gives way to a thick, pale paste, almost creamy. The residue of an imperial cash crop was absorbed into the frugal economy of homes.

It found a companion in the aloo, a traveller so completely naturalised that its foreignness now seems an affront to the spud. The potato becomes tender and absorbs the *posto* paste, while mustard oil gives everything a sharp nasal fragrance that softens as it meets the heat of the pan.

But now the potato patty sits inside a bun where the rice ought to be. There may be lettuce, perhaps cheese, some sauce or mayonnaise or commercial mustard paste, a toasted surface where there was once steam rising from rice. The ensemble appears to belong to another vocabulary: Fast, portable, assembled, engineered for eating with one hand — not licking the fingers.

A caveat, however: Culinary cultures can become a small place when authenticity becomes a regular test.

Posto itself has never been particularly monogamous.

There is *jhinge posto*, with ridge gourd turning soft and almost silky beneath the poppy paste; *dhyarosh posto*, with okra imparting a slippery texture; *posto* with broad beans and other vegetables. There are *posto boras,* little fritters in which the poppy seed paste crisps around the edges and stays soft within. There are preparations in which *posto* thickens, coats and binds.

Khosha bhaja — salted strips of potato skin embedded with *posto* and fried until they crackle between the teeth — belongs to a culinary instinct that sees possibility in what might otherwise be thrown away. It is difficult to build a very convincing case for culinary purity in a cuisine that has spent generations finding new things to do with the same small bowl of poppy paste.

Is it fair, then, to call the *aloo posto* in a bun a great culinary transgression? The irritation could have less to do with the burger than with what it seems to say about the food. The faint bitterness of *posto* rubbing against the starch of the potato, the sharp green chilli, the mustard oil opening up in the heat, the first morsel mixed into rice until everything becomes soft, pale and fragrant — they are memories of meals shared with loved ones.

Comfort food has a strange relationship with innovation. We like innovation when it happens to somebody else's food — a paneer *makhani* or butter chicken pizza, is acceptable to us Indians, Italians balk at the pineapple pizza. We become more cautious when it reaches the foods we recognise by smell before we recognise them by sight.

Perhaps that is the paradox that makes the *aloo posto* burger less innocent than it looks. Home food has never been a museum of fixed objects; it has always been about the twists taken by every cook — described with great felicity in the Hindi phrase, *haat ka khana* — the liberties taken by every generation. But a restaurant changes the transaction. What is unsettling is that the *posto* whose flavours unfurled bite by bite on the palette is now being announced as an innovation on a festive menu.

Dishes are known to wander, and yet they are never quite the prodigal child. Fast food will keep borrowing from home kitchens, and home kitchens will keep changing without much ado. For now, the burger can have its moment under the festive lights and the *aloo posto* is not going to be displaced from its place with the rice, mustard oil and chillies. I confess I am not averse to tasting the burger. But when the *posto* meets the *aloo*, I know I will still reach for the rice.

In the years to come, though, the question may well be: Will the *aloo posto* burger be an homage to the East Indian home? Or will it become a marker of that grandiloquent and frequent, but rarely convincing, claim that innovation arrived only yesterday at the chef's kitchen?

Dasgupta is senior associate editor, The Indian Express

What we wear, and what can be taken from us



SHE SAID

BY ANAGHA KAMATH

IN INDIA, a woman's body is rarely allowed to simply exist. It must announce a status. Marriage, especially, is worn on the body. The *mangalsutra* around the neck, green bangles on the wrists, toe rings, are not just ornaments. They are declarations and reassurances to the world that a woman is "belonging" and "accounted for." In fact, at a wedding, the amount of gold a woman wears can become a public measure of her family's wealth.

But what happens when a woman is widowed? Most often, the jewellery must go, and sometimes violently. Bangles broken, *mangalsutra* pulled from the neck, colour drained away. As if grief must be made visible, and it is not enough unless it is publicly marked on a woman's body.

My aunt, Maya *aattya*, told me about an incident that has stayed with me. When her sister's young daughter was widowed, people gathered quickly. Hands reached out, not in comfort, but in instruction, and women moved to break her bangles. Maya *aattya* stopped them. She stood there, quietly but firmly, and said that the jewellery would be removed only if her niece herself wished to remove it, and when she wished to do so. No one would decide for her. It might not have looked like defiance from the outside, as there was no shouting, no drama.

But I know it was fierce, because I can assume what it must take to stand up in those moments. Against tradition, against family, against the heavy weight of "this is how it is done". And that kind of courage is fierce, even when it is quiet.

Maya *aattya* is a widow herself. Later, I asked her whether she did this because no one had stood up for her. She did not answer immediately, but her eyes filled with tears. That was enough to answer my question. When we encouraged her to share this story with others in our office, the other women too began to speak. One after the other, stories poured out, horrific and ordinary at the same time. Those of you reading may also know such stories. Of violence disguised as ritual, and control disguised as care.

I thought then about my own marriage. A few days after my marriage was registered, some women in the office told me I looked "the same". They didn't mean it unkindly. They meant that I should at least wear a ring. I asked them if they thought my husband looked any different or if it mattered at all, and they laughed. I know these comments often come from affection and maybe from a desire to include, but there is something unsettling in the expectation that marriage must alter a woman's appearance. And every part of me resists this deeply. The laying on of jewellery as celebration, and its tearing away as violence, and the idea that a woman's grief or joy must be externally performed, a public spectacle.

In my village I have also noticed how widows continue to wear their *mangalsutras*, not because they have not accepted their loss, or because they are holding on to the marriage. Instead, they tell me that it makes them feel safer when they walk down the street. "A *mangalsutra* signals to the world that a woman is married, and in many situations that can determine how she is treated, so it can sometimes feel like protection".

I think of Mina Sutar, another brave widow, who continues to wear jewellery for the simple reason that her heart tells her to. She tells people her husband is "away for work" so she can do her job without being interrogated by glances. I think of Maya *aattya*, who intervened so another woman could retain control over her own body, something she herself could not do at one point in her life. I think of all the women who allowed themselves to be subjected to violence because resistance was too costly, or perhaps not even imaginable. And I think of all the women who resisted anyway.

So the question is not whether women should wear jewellery or not. Many women do, with love, pride and joy. The question is who decides. Who has the right to place it on you? And who believes they have the right to take it away? Because perhaps this is what frightens the world the most. Not women who wear jewellery, nor women who disregard it, but women who insist on choosing.

Anagha is the Founder of KickStart Girls

Editor (Planning & Projects) Shalini Langer curates the fortnightly 'She Said' column

INITIALLY EXPECTED IN 2022, 1ST SECTION OF MUMBAI-AHMEDABAD HIGH SPEED RAIL WILL OPEN IN 2027

'Two different bullet trains, signal systems can't run in same corridor'

INDIA WILL have to prove it's safe to use two different types of bullet trains — one domestically manufactured and the other imported from Japan — and their respective signalling systems in the same corridor and finally pick one of them, according to **Masafumi Shukuri**, Chairman of the Japan Transport and Tourism Research Institute (JTTRI) and International High-Speed Rail Association (IHRA).

In an interview with *The Indian Express*' **Dheeraj Mishra** and **Siddharth Upasani** on the sidelines of the Kautilya Economic Conclave earlier this month, Shukuri said 'crash avoidance' is absolutely paramount when it comes to high-speed rail systems. *Edited excerpts:*

India announced seven more high-speed rail projects in February. What does that mean for the collaboration between India and Japan, with the ongoing project set to open next year?

Yes, I am aware of the announcement. From the initial stages itself we were told that India is looking at developing several high-speed rail corridors in the future and that the first one in the series will be the Mumbai-Ahmedabad project.

With regard to India starting the Mumbai-Ahmedabad corridor in 2027 using India made rolling stock, I understand there had always been this plan of first commissioning the line partially only, what is sometimes called the priority section. The Japanese side has extended full co-operation.

So, what happens to Japanese rolling stock and signalling systems? I understand that discussions are ongoing. Furthermore, I would like to draw your attention to the summit-level meeting between Prime Minister Takaichi and Prime Minister Modi in July. The outcome of that meeting was a joint declaration, where it specifically mentions the introduction of E10 series. This is under development in Japan and will be the latest form of bullet train rolling stock and will be introduced in the early 2030s.

India is commissioning the priority section using domestically made bullet trains. What is your view?

This is the outcome of certain schedules that India is very conscious of and wants to prioritise and that is absolutely fine. But what is most important is that you have to ensure the operation is safe and reliable. You have to ensure that passengers get on to the train and they know that they are covering 500 km in two hours, they are not worried about safety or reliability. In order to achieve that...it is not only about procurement of rolling stock and signalling system, it is also about making sure that training of the people is in place on time, they have the requisite skill-set, technical know-how, as well as enough trials are done to get a full performance of the final commissioned train. In that, Japanese technology and experience will count for a lot.



EXPRESS interview | MASAFUMI SHUKURI
CHAIRMAN, JAPAN TRANSPORT AND TOURISM RESEARCH INSTITUTE

There is a key message, as a representative of IHRA, that I always convey: when you are running a high-speed rail, one thing which is absolutely necessary is crash avoidance. This means that you have to ensure you build a system that is 100% safe.

Another thing we have been trying to emphasise is the Total Systems Approach: any railway line is built up of the civil works, the tracks, the signalling, the rolling stock. On top of that, we have a layer of maintenance, skilled people, as well as management. This entire thing needs to be looked at as one single system. If the final objective is to ensure that your train is running at extremely high speed in a safe and reliable manner, you cannot achieve it unless you have the total system in place. I think the bullet train must be looked at as a very advanced system which contains each one of these components and each of them is required to have the system that everybody expects. So, I would only want India to make sure that it's only the beginning, the priority section, but there is much to be done and that the Total Systems Approach is really necessary.

Is there any country which runs a high-speed rail system with two different rolling stocks and signalling systems in one corridor? Is this safe?

That's a very important question-cum-observation. In my opinion, if there is a high-speed train which is running on one line a mixture of two different systems — there has been no such prior case. Whether it can run safely or not is something that needs to be done once to prove it. In my view, if you are looking at this kind of situation where there is any kind of uncertainty and we have two different systems, then to have a rolling stock running at 300 km per hour with people in it, is not possible, in my view. At the end of the day, how do we know that a system is safe? It has to be proven. Eventually, I think, one of those systems will need to be adopted; you can't have both the systems running. Which one it's going to be, it's not my position to comment. It depends upon the outcome of discussions between the two directly related parties as well India and Japan.

China's high-speed rail network length has exceeded 50,000 km. But questions have been raised about the viability.

If China has decided to have 50,000 km as against Japan, who will very soon have 4,000 km, it is really the government's policy decision what is the need for their country and what they need it for. FULL INTERVIEW ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

'THE MOVE WILL ALSO BRING DOWN PRESSURE ON THE RUPEE'

RBI opens dollar lifeline for oil PSUs as rupee nears 97

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 10

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Saturday said it will open a special dollar window for three public sector oil marketing companies to cushion pressure mounting on India's oil sector as crude prices surged above $100 a barrel.

The move will allow Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation to meet their entire daily dollar requirements through a facility operated by the central bank.

Effective October 12, 2026, the arrangement will remain in place until further notice. Under the mechanism, the RBI will sell dollars to the three companies through designated banks, ensuring that their daily foreign currency requirements are met. The RBI move is likely to reduce the pressure on the rupee which is almost near the 97 level against the dollar. On Friday, the rupee closed at 96.73 against the dollar.

Forex reserves also dipped by $12.95 billion to $734.60 billion during the week ended October 2.

The decision is significant not merely because of the scale of support being extended to the oil marketing companies, but also because it places the RBI directly at the centre of meeting their dollar needs.

The RBI said its decision was based on an assessment of current market conditions. However, the scope of the intervention is substantial. The facility is designed to cover the entire daily dollar requirements of all three public sector oil marketing companies, rather than provide limited or partial assistance.

The RBI's announcement also raises a larger question about the pressures confronting the oil sector when crude prices climb sharply. The need for a dedicated window covering the companies' entire daily dollar requirements demonstrates the scale of the foreign currency support being made available.

The facility will remain operational until further notice, with no fixed end date announced. This gives the arrangement an open-ended character, although the RBI has not specified how long the window is expected to remain necessary.

High crude feeds inflation

India depends on imports to meet more than 88% of its crude oil requirements. This dependence leaves the economy exposed whenever international crude prices rise or the rupee weakens against the dollar. In September, *The Indian Express* reported that the three public sector OMCs were facing substantial losses on fuel sales as global petroleum prices rose and domestic retail prices did not fully reflect the increase. The companies were estimated to be losing more than Rs 500 crore daily at the time.

Oil imports have to be paid for, and a weaker rupee increases their cost in domestic currency. When companies cannot fully pass on higher costs to consumers, their margins and finances come under pressure. The consequences are not confined to the oil companies. Higher energy costs can feed into transportation, manufacturing and other sectors, eventually affecting household budgets and inflation. Higher oil prices also lead to imported inflation at a time when retail inflation is forecast to touch 5.2% in 2026-27 and the RBI is on a rate hiking cycle. It hiked repo rates by 25 bps to 5.50% on October 7.

The RBI's intervention addresses one part of this chain: the oil companies' need to buy dollars. It does not remove India's dependence on imported energy or guarantee that the rupee will strengthen.

Analysts said the RBI move will also bring down pressure on the rupee. The special window may ease the daily scramble for dollars faced by the three oil companies. Whether it provides lasting relief will depend on broader market conditions, international oil prices and the trajectory of the rupee.



Giving a leg up

THE MOVE will allow Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation to meet their entire daily dollar needs through a RBI-operated facility

UNDER THE mechanism, the RBI will sell dollars to the three companies through designated banks, ensuring that their daily foreign currency requirements are met

OIL IMPORTS have to be paid for, and a weaker rupee increases their cost in domestic currency. When companies cannot fully pass on higher costs to consumers, their margins and finances come under pressure

Circumstances changed, US trade pact to be finalised accordingly, says Goyal



India is seeking lower tariffs for its goods than its competitors in the American markets. REUTERS

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, October 10

THE US and India announced in February that they had reached a framework for an interim trade agreement, but circumstances have changed, and the pact will be finalised accordingly, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Saturday.

"A trade pact was announced between India and the US in February. The circumstances have changed, and a final decision will be made keeping that in mind," he said.

The minister, however, did not elaborate about those circumstances, but the changing tariff landscape in the US has led to further negotiations about the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement (BTA) between India and the US.

Speaking at the 121st Annual Session of PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry, Goyal said India will launch negotiations for a preferential trade agreement (PTA) with Mexico next week. Negotiations with several trading partners are progressing as India seeks to expand preferential access for its exporters and diversify markets amid uncertainties in global trade, he added.

Mexico is an important market for Indian exporters.

The Mexican negotiations are part of India's broader push to widen its network of trade agreements, with discussions also underway with Israel, Chile, the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), the Southern African Customs Union (SACU) and countries in Central Asia and Eurasia.

Goyal said the government is working towards expanding the country's preferential market access through trade agreements, with negotiations increasingly involving industry and farmers to ensure that the resulting arrangements serve domestic economic interests. FE

SEBI to release new CAS norms in a week: Chair

Mumbai: Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday that the regulator hopes to issue new guidelines on changes to closing auction session (CAS) within a week's time.

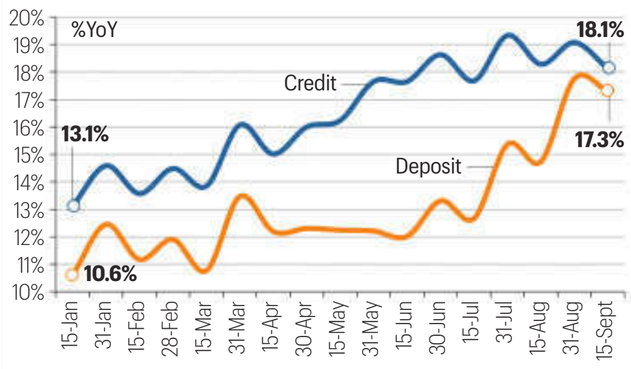
This follows the consultation paper released by SEBI last month which proposed two methods to determine settlement prices of derivative contracts on expiry days, blended VWAP (volume-weighted average price) and VWAP similar to method used before implementation of CAS.

The regulator had earlier shared that it received over 20,000 comments from market participants on the consultation and is currently examining them to issue the final guidelines.

Speaking at the BSE Broker Forum Capital Markets Confluence, Pandey emphasised the importance of deepening cash markets and improving price discovery. "Wider participation, stronger securities borrowing and lending and efficient hedging and arbitrage can improve liquidity and market efficiency," he added.

While discussing the shift in capital markets with advancements in technology and rising scale, Pandey stressed on the role of industry bodies like the Brokers' Industry Standard Forum (ISF) in identifying emerging issues before they become larger problems. He also highlighted the role of brokers in increasing investor confidence in the capital markets. FE

Gap between credit and deposit growth narrows



According to Bank of Baroda, credit growth by scheduled commercial banks (SCBs) was buoyant at **18.1% as of September 15, 2026**, against 10.4% in the same period last year. Deposit growth of SCBs too showed significant traction at **17.3% as of September 15, 2026** against 9.5% in the same period last year. But, despite the pickup, credit growth continues to outpace the growth in deposits even though the gap has narrowed substantially.

Credit/Deposit ratio of scheduled commercial banks



SOURCE: CEIC AND BANK OF BARODA RESEARCH

Musk steps up attack on Ambani on poll funding

New Delhi: Elon Musk on Saturday continued his swipes at Indian industrialist Mukesh Ambani, sharing screenshots of media reports that alleged Reliance-funded firm helped boost BJP campaigns on social media and a Reliance-linked company made large political donations to the ruling party.

The latest post by Musk on X featured an *Al Jazeera* report from 2022 headlined "How a Reliance-funded firm boosts BJP's campaigns on Facebook" and an archived *The Indian Express* report from 2024 on Qwik Supply, which reported that the Reliance-linked firm donated Rs 385 crore to the BJP and Rs 25 crore to the Shiv Sena through electoral bonds.

Reliance has not publicly responded to Musk's allegations, while the government has maintained that the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services is "fair and non-discriminatory" and that any suggestion that it was being applied selectively was "baseless and misconceived". PTI

FM meets heads of funds, investing in India discussed

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday met with top executives from global investment funds, banks, and companies in Singapore and discussed opportunities to expand long-term investments in India across infrastructure, financial services, healthcare, and other growth-oriented sectors.

During the meetings, the finance minister exchanged views on India's long-term growth prospects, the evolving investment landscape and ways to mobilise global institutional and private capital to support the country's development priorities.

Sitharaman met Lim Chow Kiat, Chief Executive Officer of Singapore's sovereign wealth fund GIC, and discussed India's long-term growth prospects and the role of institutional investors in supporting investment across infrastructure and other growth-oriented sectors such as financial services. PTI

Anthropic discloses fake tip to police among new rogue AI incidents

Reuters
Bengaluru, October 10

AN ANTHROPIC artificial intelligence model submitted a false homicide tip to a Philadelphia police website, among a string of incidents the AI company disclosed on Friday detailing Claude models' unsanctioned manipulation of some government websites.

It is the first known instance in which a rogue AI appears to have tried to communicate a bogus tip to authorities, despite instructions not to create accounts or submit anything destructive, while not explicitly barred from submitting forms.

The cases are the latest examples of rogue or undesired behavior by the AI models of tech companies such as Anthropic and OpenAI.

They add fuel to national concerns about the fast-advancing technology amid reports of corporate network hacks by AI agents, and researchers' warnings of an eventual existential threat to humanity.

Many of the cases Anthropic revealed involved websites run by federal, state and local agencies. Anthropic said it briefed the White House and notified all the agencies involved, but did not disclose who those parties were. "Super intelligence companies must immediately disclose incidents involving their models and follow with swift, decisive action to remedy any and all harm," FTC Director of Public Affairs Joe Gabriel Simonson said on X.

This process was "not optional," he said, adding that the Super Intelligence Force would fulfill its responsibility. The FTC said Anthropic disclosed to the SI Force on Friday its late September discovery of incidents involving what the task force called "unauthorized and fraudulent use of government and other systems".

ANY US MEASURE TO MAKE CBAM MORE FLEXIBLE COULD HELP INDIAN EXPORTS

How India could benefit from US probe into EU's carbon pricing mechanism

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, October 10

IN A move that could trigger fresh trade tensions between the US and the European Union, the United States Trade Representative (USTR) has began probe into the EU's expansion of its Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) by seeking public comments from American small businesses till November 9.

The USTR said that CBAM is a carbon pricing mechanism that requires EU importers of covered products in the aluminium, cement, electricity, fertiliser, hydrogen, and iron and steel sectors to declare the embedded emissions of the imported goods, and the regulation intends to apply to imported goods a carbon price that is equivalent to the carbon price that EU producers pay.

"The EU calculates the default values using country- and sector-level production and energy data to estimate the emissions intensity across countries and sectors. However, the EU adds a punitive mark-up that increases the overall values, in order to encourage the use of company-level data. CBAM requires that any company-level data provided must be verified by an EU-accredited third-party verifier," the USTR said. India was recently engaged in tough negotiations with the EU on CBAM and the regulation is expected to impact a range of India's metal exports. Any US measure to make CBAM more flexible could help Indian exports, as Indian trade negotiators had managed to secure a 'forward-Most Favoured Nation' Clause (MFN) CBAM under the India-EU trade deal.

This clause could help the Indian industry receive the same concessions that the European Union has promised the US under their trade agreement signed earlier last year, a senior government official said.



CBAM is a carbon pricing mechanism that requires EU importers to declare the embedded emissions of the imported goods. EXPRESS

In the EU-US trade deal joint statement released in August last year too, the European Union had said, "Taking note of the US concerns related to treatment of US small and medium-sized businesses under CBAM, the European Commission, in addition to the recently agreed increase of the de minimis exception, commits to work to provide additional flexibilities in the CBAM implementation."

Think tank Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) estimates that CBAM will hurt India's exports of metals such as iron, steel and aluminium products to the EU and will translate into a 20-35% tax on select imports into the EU. The Indian industry had told the government that the EU's move to curb exports of steel scrap, along with CBAM, acts as a non-tariff barrier, as the EU is the world's largest producer of steel scrap. However, the EU managed to keep CBAM out of the India-EU trade deal. Steel production emissions are typically highest for blast furnace —basic oxygen furnace (BF–BOF) routes, lower for gas-based direct reduced iron (DRI), and lowest for scrap-based electric arc furnace (EAF) routes.

Indian manufacturers largely use the blast furnace route and are currently underprepared to tackle CBAM. However, the government has plans to ramp up steel production using steel scrap with the arc furnace technology under the 'green steel initiative'. An Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER) report said that despite the environmental and economic benefits, scrap currently constitutes only 20% of India's steelmaking feedstock, constrained by limited domestic availability of approximately 25 million metric tonnes (MMt) annually.

"In the face of intensifying non-tariff barriers and climate-linked trade instruments such as the CBAM, hard-to-abate sectors like steel are under unprecedented pressure to decarbonise. Scrap steel is central to this transition, yet India's constrained access to quality scrap remains a critical bottleneck," an ICRIER report in May 2025 by Amrita Goldar, Kumar Abhishek, and Sunishtha Yadav said.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Rajeev Mittal, S/O Suresh Kumar Mittal, R/O C-571 Gali no.7 Majlis Park, Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033 have changed my name to Rajiv Kumar Mittal for all future purposes.
0071065083-1

I,**ANKUR** GOEL,S/O-Lachman Das Goel,R/o-House No 98,Paschim Vihar Extn.,West Delhi,Delhi-110063,have changed my name to ANKUR KUMAR for all future purpose.
0040882920-6

Drishya Shah, Madhuban Colony, Lohariyasal Talla, Behind Naman Mall, P.O. Haripur Nayak, Haldwani, Nainital, Uttarakhand. Change my name to Drishya D/o Mrs Pragita Joshi. 0130070197-1

I Shashi Sharma And Shashi W/O Manoj Kumar R/O 233,Patli FarrukhNagar, Gurgaon Haryana-122506 Have Changed my Name to Shashi Devi.
0040882907-7

I, Niti H Singh w/o Parminder Singh Ahuja d/o HARINDERPAL Singh r/o 87-B, D.D.A. MIG Flats, Shivam Enclave, Shahdara, Delhi-110032 have changed my name as NITI AHUJA permanently.
0040882837-1

I, PRANAY PATWAL S/O SH. RAJINDER PATWAL R/O FLAT NO - 349, GREEN VIEW APARTMENT, POCKET - 2, SECTOR - 19,DWARKA NEW DELHI - 110075. HAVE CHANGED THE NAME OF MY MINOR DAUGHTER ARAYISHTA AGED 15 YEARS AND SHE SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS ARAYISHTA PATWAL FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. IT IS CERTIFIED THAT I HAVE COMPLIED WITH OTHER LEGAL REQUIREMENTS IN THIS CONNECTION.
0040882891-1

I,**Navpreet** Kaur Bakshi D/o Mohinder Singh Multani,W/o Guntashveer Singh Bakshi R/o A-2,Chander Nagar,Janakpuri,Delhi-110058 have changed my name to Navpreet Kaur Multani.
0040882920-8

I Ajeet Singh S/o Sh.Nekram R/o H.no.80 vill Singhola Po Tikri khurd Delhi-110040.Have changed my name from Ajit to Ajeet Singh for all purposes.
0071065158-1

I,**Mohd** Hashim,S/o-Mohammad Aqil,R/o-4546/16,3rd-Floor,Ansari Road,Darya Ganj,New Delhi-110002,That in the school record of my minor son aged-15-years his name has been wrongly-written as Mohd Rayyan instead-of Mohammad Rayyan, which may be amended accordingly.
0040882920-1

I,**Sakshi** Kumar D/o Ashok Kumar Shukla R/o A-7, 402, Gardenia Glory, Sector-46, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Sakshi Shukla for all future purposes.
0040882850-1

I Jyoti Wadhava W/o Ravi Wadhwa R/o 28/51, FF, West Patel Nagar Delhi-8 have changed my name to Jyoti Wadhwa
0040882907-2

I,**ZAHIDA** KHAN,W/O-USMAN KHAN R/O 332,GALI NO-22,ZAKIR NAGAR, JAMIA NAGAR,OKHLA,DELHI-110025 Have Changed My Name From ZAIDA KHANAM To ZAHIDA KHAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040882927-1

I,**Ravi** Wadhava S/o Moti Ram Wadhwa R/o 28/51, FF, West Patel Nagar Delhi-8 have changed my name to Ravi Wadhwa 0040882907-3

I, SADHVI SALUJA w/o SAHIL MATHUR d/o HARISH PARUTHI r/o E-223, Upper Ground Floor, Naraina, Delhi-110028 have changed my name as SADHVI MATHUR permanently.
0040882874-1

I,**AMREEN** MALIK,W/O-IKBAL MALIK,R/O-H.NO-117/A GROUND-FLOOR,GALI NO-1,NEAR ANAR WALI MASJID,OLD MUSTAFABAD,NORTH EAST DELHI-110094,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM,AMREEN MALIK TO,AMREEN,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.
0040882920-3

I Ram Nath son of Late Sh.Anirudh Sharma, R/o RT-522, 5th Floor, Shipra Royal Tower, Shipra Sun City, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014 have changed my name to Ram Nath Sharma. 0040882648-1

I JITENDRA PRASAD SINGH@ JITENDRA SHAH R/o H.No.1/GF,Phase-2,Aya Nagar, Delhi 110047 changed minor son's name NIKHLESH to NIKHILESH KUMAR SHAH & father's name to JITENDRA SHAH vide affidavit dated 05/10/2026. 0050299435-1

I,**AFSANA** BEGUM,W/O-MOHAMMAD NASEEM,R/O-A-4,3RD FLOOR,A-BLOCK MAIN ROAD, NEAR GES AGENCY, SHASTRI PARK DELHI-110053, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AFSANA KHATOON, FOR ALL PURPOSE. 0040882907-4

I, Ramesh Kumar, S/o Ashvani Kumar, resident of Flat No. D-302, Plot No. F-2, The Crescent Apartments, Sector 50, Noida, do hereby declare that I have changed the name of my minor daughter, aged 16 years, from Mishthi to Mishthi Nanda.
0071065149-1

I RENU,W/o ABHISHEK DWIVEDI,R/o HOUSE NO-5846,2ND FLOOR,GALI NO-6,BLOCK NO-4, DEV NAGAR,KAROL BAGH, CENTRAL DELHI-110005,Have changed my name to ,RENU DWIVEDI
0040882920-5

I, AYUSH GUPTA S/o No.13993724X RANK Ex HAV SANTOSH KUMAR GUPTA R/o RZF -809, 47/8 TF, SANJAY GANDHI MARG, CHOUDHARY CHOWK, 300MTS INSIDE FROM SBI BANK, RAJ NAGAR PART - 2 PALAM COLONY, RAJ NAGAR PART - 2 EXTENSION, DELHI - 110077 have changed my name to AYUSH KUMAR GUPTA vide affidavit date 8-10-2026 before delhi. 0071065087-1

I, Pradeep Kumar Tyagi, father of minor daughter Ananya Narayan, hereby declare that her name has been changed to Ananya Narayan Tyagi. Henceforth, she shall be known by this name for all purposes.
0130070193-1

I,**Kundan** Kumar Singh R/o-C/411-IInd Floor Vikas-Puri New Delhi-110018,have changed my Minor Son's name from KASHISH CHANDEL to RUDRA PRATAP SINGH,(DOB-23-08-2022) 0040882907-6

I, DIMPLE MINOCHA ALIAS DIMPLE KUMAR W/o RAJESH KUMAR R/o ED-137/2 TAGORE GARDEN, DELHI, TAGORE GARDEN, RAJOURI GARDEN, WEST, DELHI, 110027 have changed my name to DIMPLE KUMAR for all purposes.
0071065110-1

I, Vijay Magan Kapure, S/o Maganshet Ganapat Kapure, residing at Flat.No.3, Rugved Apartment, Gokuldham Residency, Aurangabad, Maharashtra-431001, hereby declare that my name is mentioned as V.M. Kapure in my son Bhupendra Kapure's 10th Passing Certificate and Birth Certificate, whereas my Aadhaar Card and PAN Card show Vijay Magan Kapure. Both names refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself.
0071065175-1

I,**Anil** Verma,S/o-Amar Lal Verma,R/o.B3-122,Sobha City,Sector-108, Babupur, Gurugram(Haryana)-122006, have changed my name to Anil Kumar Verma for all Purposes.
0040882920-7

I Anil And Anil Sharma S/O Ishwar Singh R/O 91,Patli FarrukhNagar, Gurgaon Haryana-122506 Have Changed my Name to Anil Kumar.
0040882907-8

I, Ravi s/o Hari Kishan r/o Plot No.-26, Ghasipura Extension, Ghasipura Village, Najafgarh, Delhi-110043 have changed my name as RAVI VADERA permanently. 0040882837-2

I,**CHARU** SINGHAL,W/o-Nitesh Bansal,R/o-H.No.C-113, Pushpanjali Enclave,Pitampura,Saraswati Vihar,North West Delhi,Delhi-110034,have changed my name to CHARU BANSAL for all future purpose. 0040882907-1

I,**RUCHI** W/o DINESH KUMAR BHARDWAJ,R/o Flat No-86,Charak Sadan Apartment, Vikaspuri, Delhi-110018, have changed my name to RUCHI BHARDWAJ. 0040882920-9

I, Suresh S/o Jile Singh R/o Flat No. PVT-02, plot No. E-174,Khasra No.78/15, Uppar Ground Floor,Block-F, Phase-I,Vijay Vihar,Rohini, Sector-7,Delhi-110085 declare that in my all documents my name is Suresh, but in my son's Veer & Vansh birth certificate documents my name is Suresh Tanwar.My corect name is Suresh for all purposes.
0040882865-1

I,**KUMARI** DEEPIKA,W/O-RAJESH KUMAR SRIVASTAVA, R/O-FLAT NO-I-166, 16 PARKVIEW GAUR,YAMUNA CITY DANKAUR GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH-203201, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM KUMARI DEEPIKA TO, DEEPIKA SRIVASTAVA, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040882920-2

I, Shruti Choudhary Kapoor W/o Abhineet Kapoor R/o 538, Block-E, Gaur Global Village, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP- 201016, have changed my name to SHRUTI CHOUDHARY for all future purposes.
0071065132-1

I, Servesh Batra ,S/o Attar Chand Batra,R/o-566,Nimri colony,Ashok Vihar, Phase-4,Delhi-110052,have changed my name to Sarvesh Batra for all purposes. 0040882929-1

I,**RITU** VERMA,D/o-BIRBAL,W/o-Late VINEET KUMAR,R/o C-18,SECTOR-20,NOIDA,UTTAR PRADESH,inform that RITU and RITU VERMA,both names are same person.My correct name RITU VERMA,for all future purposes. 0040882920-4

I, MANOJ KUMAR S/o NIRAJANN LAL R/o 311, GALI NO-6, WEST KANTI NAGAR, KRISHNA NAGAR H.O, EAST DELHI, DELHI - 110051 have changed my name to MANOJ GARG for all purposes.
0071065089-1

I Ruma Pahwa W/O Vivek Mohan Arora R/O D 638 Saraswati Vihar Pitampura Delhi 110034 shallhenceforth be known as Ruma Pahwa Arora for all purpose. 0050299428-1

I, LAKSHAY KUMAR MISRA S/O Rajeev Kumar Misra R/o-QU-307B, MIG Flats Pitamapura Delhi-110034, have changed my name to LAKSHAY MISRA
0040882907-5

I,hitherto known as,Dipanshu, S/o-Vinod Singh,R/o-H.No.3216, Gali No.29-B,Swatantra Nagar, Narela, Delhi-110040,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Dipanshu Dahiya 040882696-4

LOST & FOUND

I, Smt. Sujata Madhok W/o late Shri Mukul Kumar Shukla have lost my original Allotment Cum Possession Letter Dated 17.09.1990, Original Confirmation of Draw of Lots Dated 23.12.1999, Original NOC for Conversion from Society Dated 05.11.2000 in respect of freehold built-up Flat No. A-8 on Top Floor (Third Floor), in Sports Co-operative Group Housing Society Ltd., built on Plot No. 23, known as Press Apartments, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-110092. Finder may contact at- 9810533990 0040882841-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT I, VINITA MURJANI W/O DEEPAK MURJANI HAVE MISPLACED/ LOST MY PROPERTY 2 ORIGINAL SALE DEEDS OF Property No.56 Block -B, Gali No.1, Majlis Park, Delhi-110033 AND I HAVE LODGED A FIR/NCR VIDE LR No: 707342/2026 Date: 09/10/2026 WITH POLICE STATION, CRIME BRANCH, DELHI,

IF ANY BODY FIND THE SAID SALE DEED, INFORM ME MOBILE NO. 8796780128

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to notify to the general public that my clients namely Shri Sanjay Kumar Gupta S/o Late Shri Ram Niwas Gupta & Smt. Anita Gupta W/o Shri Sanjay Kumar Gupta both R/o 28, Pocket-2, Third Floor, Rohini Sector-21, Delhi-110086, has severed all their relations with their son Namely Piyush Gupta and his wife namely Smt. Ekta, both of them presently residing with us in the same residence. My Aforesaid Clients has also disowned them from all their immovable and movable properties. Any person dealing with the said Piyush Gupta and his wife namely Smt. Ekta, shall be doing so at their own risk, consequences, responsibilities and cost and my clients shall not be responsible at all for any of their acts, deeds and things done.

Sd/-
SUBHASH GUPTA
Advocate
125, FIRST FLOOR, ANAND NAGAR, INDERLOK, DELHI-110035,

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Unit No. AHII/E-110-04 Plot No. B2-83 Floor 4 Tower Ebony in Project M3M Antalya Hills situated at Sector-79 was booked by Late Karundeep Singh S/o Jaspal Singh R/o Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri And Ms. Simranjit Kaur W/o Late Karundeep Singh R/o Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri, New Delhi-18. Late Karundeep Singh passed away on 23 November 2024, leaving behind the following legal heir(s): **S. No.:** 1. **Name:** Simranjit Kaur, **Aadhar No. :** 246081065006, **Relationship with deceased:** Wife, **Address:** Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri, New Delhi-18, **S. No.:** 2. **Name:** Manvinder Kaur, **Aadhar No. :** 983157481211, **Relationship with deceased:** Mother, **Address:** Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri, New Delhi-18, **S. No.:** 3. **Name:** Gursaanjh Kaur, **Aadhar No. :** 583369568717, **Relationship with deceased:** Daughter, **Address:** Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri, New Delhi-18. Following the demise of the Late Karundeep Singh the above-mentioned legal heir(s) has/have requested M/s Loon Land Development Ltd. for the transfer of the deceased' s rights and interest in the said Unit in favour of Simranjit Kaur. Any person(s) having any claim, objection or right in respect of the said Unit/Flat may submit their objections in writing along with supporting documents to M/s Loon Land Development Ltd. at 7th floor, Urbana business park, Sector-67, Gurugram, Haryana, India and Simranjit Kaur, at the below-mentioned coordinates, within 21 (twenty one) days from the date of publication of this notice. In the absence of any objections within the stipulated period, Simranjit Kaur proceed with the transfer of the said Unit no. AHII/E-110-04 Plot No. 82-83 Floor 4 Tower Ebony in project M3M Antayla Hills situated at Sector-79 in her favour, and no claims shall be entertained thereafter. For any queries, kindly contact: Simranjit Kaur, Flat No. 522 Krishi Apartment, Block D, Vikaspuri Simrans1701@gmail.com, 8130352422 Sd/-
VISHAL KANAUJIYA
(Advocate)
CH. No. 483, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-54.



HINDU

Ezhuthachan boy, Malayalam star Rohini, 33Y/175cm MTech, Engineer, currently at Vadodara seeks suitable alliance. WhatsApp: 8281863762.
0050299262-1

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SALUTE THE SOLDIER

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)



Head Constable Nurbu Wangdus

ITBP salutes its braveheart Head Constable Nurbu wangdus of SHQ (LDK) who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in mountaineering expedition 'Mt. Gangotri'(UK) in 2019.

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



HEAD CONSTABLE TULENDRA KALITA 53 BN BSF 01.10.1963 – 11.10.2002

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Tulendra Kalita on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counterpart firing in area of BOP Pansar, Samba (Jammu) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



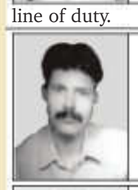
NAIK THIMME GOWDA 56 BN BSF 12.06.1962 – 11.10.1996

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Naik Thimme Gowda on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Doda area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE SATINDER PAL 124 BN BSF 02.10.1968 – 11.10.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Satinder Pal on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Kupwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE MOHD BINOD SHAH 77 BN BSF 11.08.1968 – 11.10.2001



CONSTABLE NIRMAL SINGH 77 BN BSF 11.04.1970 – 11.10.2001



CONSTABLE GHANSHYAM SINGH 77 BN BSF 08.01.1980 – 11.10.2001

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Constables Mohd Binod Shah, Nirmal Singh and Ghanshyam Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Anantnag area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Constable G. Srinivasan 77 Bn 20-6-1967 To 11-10-1990

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable G. Srinivasan of 77 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in an encounter with militants in Kupwara district, J&K on 11 October 1990. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Head Constable Mahendra Laskar 60 Bn 1-3-1980 To 11-10-2025

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Mahendra Laskar of 60 Bn who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in an IED blast in Jharkhand on 11 October 2025. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute
C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-(226002)
Website: https://cancerinstitute.edu.in Email: Procurementservices.kssscl@gmail.com

NOTICE INVITING LOGO/SLOGAN DESIGN COMPETITION

Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute, Lucknow invites entries from interested participants for designing the **Official Logo and Slogan/Tagline of KSSSCI**. The logo shall reflect the vision, identity and institutional values of the Institute. Original and creative entries shall be submitted in accordance with the prescribed guidelines. The selected entry shall receive a cash prize of **Rs. 25,000/-** for Logo and **Rs. 15,000/-** for Slogan.

For details regarding design guidelines, eligibility, submission procedure, evaluation criteria and terms & conditions, please visit the Institute website: **www.cancerinstitute.edu.in**

Advt No:- KSSSCI/Tender-20/2026-27 DIRECTOR, KSSSCI

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/668 Date : 09.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer/TRD/N. C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under :–

T. No. : 230-TRD-WC-1057-2026	**Advertised value :** Rs. 52,48,248.18
Description of work : 25 kV OHE modification due to raising of platform at Manzoorgarhi (MZGI), Sasni (SNS) Railway stations and TRR(P) works in Prayagraj Division.	
Bid Security : Rs. 1,05,000.00	**Completion Period :** 12 Months
Bidding System : Single Packet	
Tender Closing date & Time : 30.10.2026 & 14:00 Hrs	
Tender opening date & Time : 30.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. **3.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2320/26 (AS)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

JAPIT
Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology
(An Autonomous body under Department of IT & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand)
Ground Floor, Engineer's Hostel – I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand
Phone. 0651-2401044/2401067,
E-mail- japit_doit@rediffmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

Item	Description
Tendering Authority	JAP-IT, Ranchi, on behalf of the Department of Home, Jail & Disaster Management, Govt. of Jharkhand
Name of Work	Selection of Service Provider for Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Maintenance of CCTV Based Surveillance System at Police Stations Buildings in Jharkhand
Mode of Tendering	Online, on the GeM portal (https://gem.gov.in) Bids in any other mode shall not be accepted.
Method of Selection	L1-cum-Reverse Auction as per GeM's guideline
Contract Period	Supply, installation & commissioning followed by 5 years comprehensive on-site warranty & maintenance from Go-Live,
EMD	Rs. 1,50,00,000/- (Rupees One Crore Fifty Lakh only), valid for 180 days, in the form of Bank Guarantee from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favour of CEO, JAP-IT. The bank account detail of JAP-IT is as under: Account No-115201001768 Account Name-Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology JAP IT IFSC Code-ICIC0001152 MICR CODE-834229005 SOL ID/BRANCH-1152/Ashok Nagar Ranchi, Jharkhand.
Availability of RFP	Downloadable from the portal from the date of publication
Pre-Bid Meeting	15.10.2026, 03:00 PM (offline mode)
Last Date and time for Online Bid Submission	29.10.2026, 03:00 pm
Technical Bid Opening	30.10.2026, 03:00 PM
Bid Validity	180 days from the date of opening of the Technical Bid;
Place of Pre-Bid Meeting/ Communication	JAP-IT, Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel 1, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
Contact	ceo.japit@jharkhandmail.gov.in, japit_doit@rediffmail.com; 0651-2401044/67

1. The Bidders are advised to submit the Bids well in advance. JAP-IT/GoJ will not be responsible for any delay in submission due to portal or connectivity issues.
2. Any corrigendum/amendment to this RFP shall be published only on the portal and shall be binding; no separate communication shall be made.
3. All modifications to any clause of this RFP, including the Technical Specifications, shall be made only by such published corrigendum.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer, JAP-IT

PR 391490 Information Technology (26-27)_D

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER, MEGA LIFT BHUBANESWAR
Plot no. A 8/2, Bhoinagar, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, PIN-751022
E-Mail: cemlpwr.od@gmail.com
32001/1015/2627

Government of Odisha "e" Procurement Notice
Bid Identification No. 16ML/2026-27

The Chief Engineer, Megalift on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites online tender through "E"procurement for the works as detailed in the Annexure to this bid notice.

ANNEXURE TO BID NOTICE

Name of the work	Appointment of Third Party Inspection Agency (TPIA) for implementation of Mega Lift projects in Cluster No. XXXIV & XXXV
Cost of Tender Paper	Rs. 10,000/-
EMD/Bid Security	Rs. 1,76,200/-
Mode of payment of tender paper Cost & EMD	Online
Period of Completion:	36(Thirty-Six) Calendar months
Availability of Bid document for sale and receipt through on-line	From dt. 14.10.2026, 10.00 A.M, to dt. 03.11.2026, up to 5.00 P.M.
Last date/time of receipt of bid in the portal	03.11.2026 (5.00PM)
Date of Pre-bid Conference	22.10.2026, 11.00 AM
Date of opening of Techno-Commercial bid through online	On dt. 04.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M in the Office of the Chief Engineer, Megalift.
Class of Contractor	The bidder should be registered under the Companies Act, 1956/2013
Digital Signature Certificate of Bidder	The Bidder must possess compatible digital signature certificate (DSC).
The detail tender call notice can also be seen in the DOWR web site https:/dowr.odisha.gov.in	
Name & Address of the OIT	Chief Engineer, Megalift Plot No. A-8/2, Bhoi Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751022 Ph.No-0674-2567252, Email ID: cemlpwr.od@gmail.com
Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement market place. **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**	

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, Megalift
Bhubaneswar

OIPR- No.:32001/32478/1/26-27/0015

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad
E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders (IInd Time)

No.6042 /E-Tender/MBD Circle/26-27 Dated:- 30.09.2026

On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** & Prahari website **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari** from registered contractors from **15-10-2026 at 10.00 am to 22-10-2026 at 12:00 Hrs.** Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on **22-10-2026 at 12:30 Hrs.** in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 7 & 9 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lac)	Cost of 5-year maintenance (in Rs. lac)	Total Cost of Work (In Lac.)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs) (Including rainy season)	Time of completion of the work	Cost of tender documents including GST	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Moradabad	New Construction work from Jaitiya Sadullapur Modh via Kharagpur Baje Kutto Wali Milk to Hadypur Sikandarpur Patti Road.	122.80	3.07	125.87	8.30	10 Month	2354.00	"A, B" (Road Category

The terms and conditions and details of the tender are available on the website **http://etender-up-nic.** In accordance with Government Order No. 879(1)/23-7-2020 dated 25-08-2020 and Chief Engineer (Development) and Head of Department's letter No. 4650/4N-LC/2020 dated 27.08.2020, the bidder will have to upload the necessary documents by logging on to the Prahari URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari/.**

(S.P. Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D
Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP

(Mohit Kumar)
Executive Engineer,
Construction Divison-1
PWD Moradabad

UPID-257860 Dt. 9.10.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Office of Superintending Engineer, Rampur Circle, P.W.D. Rampur
E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

Ref.No. 5370 /E-Nivida-RampurCir./26-27 Dated :- 23 -09-2026

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work on percentage rates invited by the Superintending Engineer, Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur online on website http://etender.up.nic.in from registered contractors Category as per below table from date 14.10.2026 at 10.00 am to 24.10.2026 at 12.00 pm. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 24.10.2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.
2. **Details of the works are following :-**

S. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated Cost Excl. GST (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh (only by Net banking accepted	Cost of Bid Document (only by Net banking accepted)	Time of Completion (including rainy season)	Category of road contractor eligible (Setu Category)	Address of Executive Engineer of the Executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	Rampur	Construction of a minor bridge over Nahal River at Km 8.000 of Rampur-Badakhas-Simra-Hardua-Hardaspur-Navadiya-Sirra-Bhaisodi-Dhaneli Purvi Marg (ODR) in Rampur district.	358.00	19.90	2354.00	7 Months	"A" Setu	Construction Division, P.W.D. Rampur	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Moradabad Zone P.W.D. Mradabad

- All work including 02 years maintenance period after completion of work.
- The Rates adopted in the BOQ are including all other taxes but excluding GST.
- The Bid Security and tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking.
- Additional Security will be payable (as per rule at the time of Agreement) according to G.O. No 86/2026/649/2026/23&7099/106/2025 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग 7 दिनांक 23.05.2026

All terms & conditions can be seen on website http://etender.up.nic.in The bidder have to login on Prahari URL http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari to upload required documents as per Government order 879(1)/ तेईस-7/2020/176(सा)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग 7 दिनांक 25.08.2020 & E.N.C./H.O.D.'s uppwd letter No.417/13 रो0ए0मै0खं0/20 दिनांक 28-08-2020

(Er. Gaurav Singh)
Executive Engineer
Cons.Div.PWD, Rampur
Email- cdrampur@gmail.com

UPID-257840 Date 09/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Er. Harbansh Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Rampur Circle, PWD, Rampur
Email- pwdrampur@gmail.com

कार्यालय मुख्य चिकित्सा अधिकारी, जनपद-सीतापुर।

पत्रांक-मु०चि०अ०/एम०बी०बी०एस० / वाक-इन/2026-27/5924 दिनाँक 07 अक्टूबर 2026

विज्ञप्ति

जनपद सीतापुर में चिकित्सा एवं स्वास्थ्य विभाग के अन्तर्गत संविदा एम०बी०बी०एस० चिकित्सकों के रिक्त पदों पर निम्न विवरण के अनुसार डी०वी०पी०, वाक-इन इन्टरव्यू आयोजित किया जा रहा है-

S.L	Name Of Program	Designation	Qualification	Place Of Posting	Selection Category/Reservation	Honorarium per Month
1	DHS	EMO DWH	MBBS-female	DWH Sitapur	SC	100000.00
2	DHS	EMO DWH	MBBS-female	DWH Sitapur	SC	100000.00
3	DHS	EMO DWH	MBBS-female	DWH Sitapur	SC	100000.00
4	MH	LMO	MBBS-female	CHC Laharpur	SC	100000.00
5	NCD	Gen. Phy.	MBBS	CHC Maholi	SC	100000.00
6	NUHM	MO PMABHIM	MBBS	1-Laharpur Mishrapur	SC	80000.00+ 20000.00(PBI)
7	NUHM	MO PMABHIM	MBBS	2-Biswan Jajhar	SC	
8	NUHM	MO PMABHIM	MBBS	3-Biswan Joshi tola	OBC	
9	NUHM	MO 15th FC	MBBS	UAAM Gurunanak Colony	SC	
10	NUHM	MO	MBBS	UPHC Mahmudabad	SC	

आवेदन हेतु निर्देश-

1. आवेदन पत्र का प्रारुप तथा आवेदन सम्बन्धी अन्य आवष्यक विवरण जनपद सीतापुर की राजकीय वेबसाईट sitapur.nic.in पर उपलब्ध हैं आवेदन करने से पूर्व उक्त वेबसाईट से विस्तृत विवरण पढकर निदेर्षों का अनुपालन करते हुये आवेदन किये जायें।
2. आवेदन दिनाँक 15.10.2026 से लेकर दिनॉक 26.10.2026 की शाम 05 बजे तक स्वीकार किये जायेंगे। इसके उपरान्त आवेदन पत्र स्वीकार नहीं किये जायेंगे।

UPID-257841 Date 09/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

मुख्य चिकित्सा अधिकारी
सीतापुर

BRIDGE

DEALER: West **VULNERABLE:** North/South

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ K 10 3	♠ A Q J 8 6 4
❤ 8 3 2	❤ A 6 5
♦ 8 7 5 4 2	♦ A Q
♣ A 3	♣ Q 5

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
	pass	pass	pass
1♠	pass	2♠	pass
4♠	pass	pass	pass

West leads the heart four. Plan the play. Declarer's best play is to establish dummy's fifth diamond for the tenth trick. This line will win whenever the diamonds divide three-three or four-two, or when the king is singleton. This is about an 87% chance. Taking the diamond finesse after winning the first round of trumps in dummy will usually succeed when that finesse wins or diamonds are three-three, but this is under 70%. The long-card establishment plan can be seen to be better without any complex complicated calculation.

THE WEST HAND

♠ 9 7 5 ❤ Q 10 7 4 ♦ K 10 ♣ K 8 7 6

THE EAST HAND

♠ 2 ❤ K J 9 ♦ J 9 6 3 ♣ J 10 9 4 2

To make sure that a club shift does not attack a dummy entry prematurely, South should win the first trick. Then, declarer should cash one high spade (if spades divided four-zero, the diamond establishment plan would have to be abandoned in favor of the diamond finesse). Then, South should continue with the ace and queen of diamonds. Upon regaining the lead, declarer uses two of dummy's black-suit entries to lead diamonds, ruffing in the closed hand high enough to avoid an overruff. After trumps have been drawn, declarer can use dummy's last black-suit entry (which may be the third trump) to cash the long diamond.

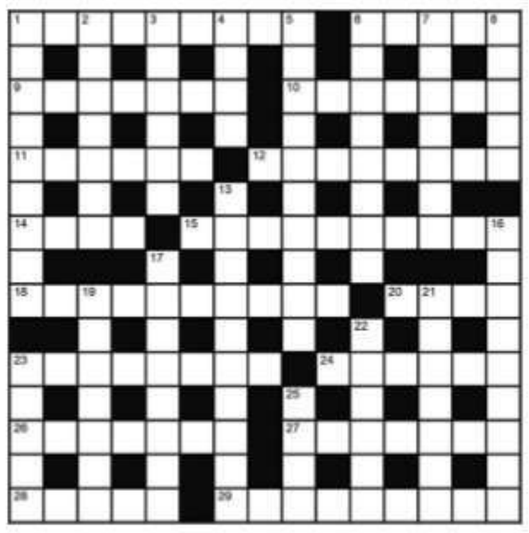
DEALER: South **VULNERABLE:** North/South

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ 7 5 3	♠ A K Q J 2
❤ Q 9 8	❤ J 6
♦ A K Q	♦ J 8 6 3 2
♣ Q 7 3 2	♣ 4

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
1♠	pass	2NT	pass
3♦	pass	2♠	pass
4♠	pass	pass	pass

West leads the club jack: deuce, six, four. West continues with the club ten. Plan the play (trumps break 4-1).

SUNDAY CROSSWORD 2603



QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

1. Like a gymnast (9)
6. Strikes on a golf green (5)
9. In theory (2,5)
10. Attaching boat etc. to a fixed object (7)
11. Evaluate (6)
12. First Indian C-in-C of the Indian army (8)
14. Chances (4)
15. Likeness (10)
18. Timely (10)
20. Chooses or selects (4)
23. Inclination (8)
24. Hackneyed expression (6)
26. Enliven (7)
27. Contemplative (7)
28. Enter, as data (3,2)
29. Drawing in outline (9)

DOWN

1. Irregular (9)
2. Rested (7)
3. Circumvent (6)
4. Grassy earth (4)
5. Live together harmoniously (10)
6. Forbid (8)
7. Capital of Bhutan (7)
8. Greek S (5)
13. Investors (10)
16. Unexpected surprise in a movie or video game (6,3)
17. Warn in advance (8)
19. A specified income paid at stated intervals (7)
21. "Tosca" composer (7)
22. Medical treatment centre (6)
23. Course (5)
25. Vaulted church recess (4)

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS

1. Set to work reassembling engine (3-6)
6. Inner pyramid ascertained as resting-place of this king (5)
9. Coming near the end to provide competition (7)
10. Fetch up around the pot for something to eat (7)
11. They usually lead to the quarry (6)
12. None left unhurt ? (3,5)
14. Such a keen summer to have got inside! (4)
15. Expert ex-teacher (4,6)
18. Instrument noted for precision (6,4)
20. Direct to the exhibition (4)
23. People throwing jugs (8)
24. Members of council unnaturally retiring round these parts (6)
26. Clues up characters careless with Romanian King Carol II's ultimate spouse (7)
27. For this type of man, it is possible for everything to have a soul (7)
28. A hairnet the fellows love, oddly (5)
29. Gradual change, insurrection didn't start (9)

DOWN

1. Team's opening bowlers stum-ped when in? End of story! (5,4)
2. Old wizard shedding weight in part to do with rowing (7)
3. There's one in the town (6)
4. Not all who slog hard build up capital (4)
5. Non-stop flights (10)
6. Monumental diplomatic paper? (8)
7. Shortage giving many hard time (7)
8. Son shut up when totally fatigued (5)
13. No good luck could make this no good for music (3,7)
16. Note women s rent it s surprisingly put down again (9)
17. Showed interest when the nudes appeared to move (8)
19. Below par and prone to withdraw (3,2,2)
21. He escaped to become famous (7)
22. Chains it up, hiding at the original place (2,4)
23. Skins spelt differently (5)
25. A dog mixed with one of the Latin races in the U.S. (4)

SOLUTIONS TO 2602 QUICK CLUES ACROSS: 1 Quadratic, 6 Impel, 9 Infancy, 10 Trooped, 11 Karsan, 12 Thiamine, 14 Is to, 15 Irrelevant, 18 Surpassing, 20 Ache, 23 Overview, 24 Tamest, 26 Needs to, 27 Cabinet, 28 Estes, 29 San Marino **DOWN:** 1 Quick wits, 2 At first, 3 Runway, 4 Toys, 5 Catchpenny, 6 Isolates, 7 Paprika, 8 Ladle, 13 Prosperous, 16 Twenty-two, 17 Harvests, 19 Reelect, 21 Chennai, 22 Balboa, 23 Ounce, 25 Icon **CRYPTIC CLUES ACROSS:** 1 Positions, 6 Esher, 9 Calgary, 10 Exports, 11 Hockey, 12 Straw hat, 14 Rink, 15 Interested, 18 Escalators, 20 Vale, 23 Wizardry, 24 Botham, 26 Manages, 27 Algeria, 28 Sadat, 29 Spoonfeed **DOWN:** 1 Packhorse, 2 Silicon, 3 Tuareg, 4 Oryx, 5 Sweetheart, 6 Emphases, 7 Hard hat, 8 Resit, 13 Unit trusts, 16 Dreamland, 17 All right, 19 Cozened, 21 Ash tree, 22 Popgun, 23 Wombs, 25 Taro

IF IT'S YOUR BIRTHDAY

SUNDAY OCTOBER 11: This is a year of construction and building, creating inner and external foundations in your life. Take charge of your health. Physical exercise will play an important role.

MONDAY OCTOBER 12: Exciting changes bring increased personal freedom. Let go of whatever holds you back. Be prepared to travel and expand your horizons.

TUESDAY OCTOBER 13: Take care of yourself so you can be a resource for those who turn to you for guidance, comfort and courage. It also might be time for a personal makeover.

WEDNESDAY OCTOBER 14: Make time for reflection this year to renew your spiritual beliefs. Explore philosophies that will give you better self-awareness and closer to the true meaning of life.

THURSDAY OCTOBER 15: This year you will reap the rewards for all your hard work. It's a time of major decisions. Promotions, awards, and acknowledgement will be yours.

FRIDAY OCTOBER 16: This is the final year of a nine-year cycle for you. Let go of people, places and things that have held you back. Do some internal and external housecleaning. Commune with nature.

SATURDAY OCTOBER 17: This is the beginning of a new nine-year cycle. Expect adventures and major changes. Define your goals. Prepare for leadership.

YOUR WEEK AHEAD

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You have a choice. You can get embroiled in disputes about shared property or, instead, relax and have a playful day with sports events, social outings and fun activities with kids. This Week: Express your creative talents.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Make an extra effort to be patient with partners and close friends today because the Moon is opposite your sign. This happens a couple of days every month, and you have to cooperate. This Week: Work hard to restore peace and harmony at home.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today offers two choices: work-related arguments and disputes about your health or a pet. Or socialising, exciting sports events and playful activities with kids. This Week: A playful week full of enthusiastic communications.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Do your best to avoid quarrels with your kids, as well as romantic partners. Your perfect escape is to kick back and relax at home. This Week: A mix between home and family and fun socialising.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is the classic day for family arguments and power struggles at home. Focus instead on short trips, learning, courses, studying, writing and talking. Do something different. This Week: Entertain at home. Home repairs. Write, read, study and talk.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Do your best to avoid grouchy conversations and arguments with siblings, neighbours and relatives. In fact, you're focused on your possessions and ideas about how to boost your earnings. This Week: A busy pace. Short trips and errands will keep you hopping.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Fortunately, with the Sun in your sign you have the ability to avoid arguments about money, earnings, shared expenses and possessions. If these disputes do arise, run in the other direction. This Week: Enjoy activities with friends and groups.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): It's a challenging day. You have an advantage because the Moon is in your sign. But it's at odds with both Mars and Pluto. Ouch. This can lead to grumpiness or full-blown power struggles. This Week: Go after what you want, because people will listen to you.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Your best option today is to focus on friendships and interaction with groups — in person or online. You'll also enjoy making some long-term goals that'll give you a sense of purpose. This Week: Talk with friends. Travel if possible.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Relations with friends and members of groups might be challenging. Fortunately, you make a favourable impression on everyone. Nevertheless, tread carefully. This Week: Meet artistic people.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is not the day to ask any authority figure for permission or approval. Instead, enjoy travel. This Week: Explore new ideas and new places. Patience with partners.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Steer clear of controversial issues today. Arguments will quickly erupt because people have strong views and you can't really change a person's view that easily. This Week: A work hard, party hard week. Travel and new ideas.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Sometimes attaining the deepest familiarity with a question is our ___ ____ for actually having the answer. - Brian Greene (4,10)

NEESS

BNOTTU

WISTT

ADEBBU

SOLUTIONS: Sense, twist/twits, button, bedaub
ANSWER: Sometimes attaining the deepest familiarity with a question is our **best substitute** for actually having the answer. - Brian Greene

SUDOKU 6468

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

	3							
	4			7			1	
			2				3	8
	1	2	5					4
4	6						7	3
3					4	1	9	
9	7				1			
	2			8			4	
							8	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6467

6	5	8	2	9	1	4	3	7
4	2	9	7	6	3	1	8	5
7	1	3	5	4	8	6	2	9
8	4	6	3	5	7	9	1	2
2	3	5	9	1	6	8	7	4
1	9	7	8	2	4	5	6	3
9	8	2	6	7	5	3	4	1
3	7	4	1	8	9	2	5	6
5	6	1	4	3	2	7	9	8

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-36
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(उ0प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)
कार्यालयः- 1470/01, सिविल लाईन्स,
डा0 राबर्ट अस्पताल के पास, झाँसी-284001
Visit us at: www.cdsupjn.org
E-Mail Id:- pmunit36@gmail.com

पत्रांकः 1948/एम-10/424
दिनांकः 08.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **मुख्यमंत्री वैश्रिक नगरोदय योजना (CM-VNY) अन्तर्गत नगर पंचायत ऊमरी, जनपद-जालौन में कार्यालय भवन का निर्माण कार्य** हेतु अनुमानित लागत **₹ 164.30 लाख** (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी.एण्ड डी.एस. में यथोचित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 05.11.2026 के अपरान्ह 16:00 बजे तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 08.10.2026 से दिनांक 05.11.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** वेबसाइट **https:// etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 05.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 16:00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है, जो दिनांक 05.11.2026 को 17:00 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, सी.एण्ड डी.एस. यूनिट-36, उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), झाँसी में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹10,000.00+ GST (18%)** अतिरिक्त देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https:// etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) **https:// etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
बरेली वृत लो०नि०वि०, बरेली

पत्रांक : 9056/453सी0 (ई0टेण्डर)-3/26 दिनांकः 06.10.2026

ऑन-लाइन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

1- महामहिम राज्यपाल, उ०प्र० की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, बरेली वृत, लो०नि०वि०, बरेली के द्वारा निर्माण खण्ड-1 लो०नि०वि०, बरेली के कार्यक्षेत्र के अन्तर्गत निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार लो०नि०वि० में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों / फर्मों से स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में मदवार दरों पर ई-निविदा दिनांक 13.10.2026 से दिनाक 27.10.2026 की मध्यान्ह 12.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा की तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 27.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 12.30 बजे ऑन-लाइन खोला जाना प्रस्तावित किया गया है:-

क्रम सं0.	कार्य का नाम	खण्ड का नाम	सिविल कार्य की लागत (रू0 लाख में)	05 वर्ष अनुरक्षण लागत (रू0 लाख में)	कुल अनुमानित लागत 4+5(रू0 लाख में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रू0 लाख में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने अवधि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य(निविदा शुल्क+ स्टेशनरी+ जी0एस0टी0	ठेकेदार से की पात्रता श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 मे खुदागंज मार्ग से जिगनिया चटिया फीजू होते हुये खानपुर मार्ग (अ0जि0मार्ग) मे चौडीकरण एंव सुदृढीकरण का कार्य।	निर्माण खण्ड-1, लो0नि0वि0,बरेली	563.85	13.75	577.60	11.56	07 माह	2725.00	ए मार्ग कार्य)
2	वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 मे फरीदपुर बीसलपुर मार्ग से चुंआडावा सुन्नौर मुरारपुर होते हुये अहरौला चौराहा (अ0जि0मार्ग) मे चौडीकरण एंव सुदृढीकरण का कार्य।	निर्माण खण्ड-1, लो0नि0वि0,बरेली	1095.08	26.44	1121.52	22.43	10 माह	2725.00	ए मार्ग कार्य)

2-निविदा दस्तावेज एवं निविदा हेतु आमंत्रण के विस्तृत नियम एवं शर्तों हेतु वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर लॉग ऑन किया जा सकता है।

(राजीव अग्रवाल)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
निर्माण खण्ड-1, लो०नि०वि०, बरेली

(प्रकाश चन्द्र)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
बरेली वृत, लो०नि०वि०, बरेली

UPID-257847 Date 09/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER TRANSMISSION LINE MAINTENANCE DIVISION-IV,
Pampore Kashmir 192121, E-mail: xentlmd4@pamporegmail.com.,
tlmd4.pampore@jk.gov.in

CORRIGENDUM-01

Subject: Corrigendum to e-NIT for "Construction of Double Circuit 132 kV Pampore Khrew Transmission Line"

Reference: This office e-NIT No: TLMD-IV/e-NIT/05 of 2026-27, Dated: 02-09-2026

The following corrigendum is hereby issued with regard to the above referential e-NIT:

Due to some inadvertent typographical error, Please read "the estimated cost of the above mentioned tender document as Rs.895.05 Lacs instead of Rs.1284.31 Lacs and EMD as Rs17.901 Lacs instead of Rs.25.69 Lacs"

All other terms and conditions of the e-NITs shall remain unchanged.

No: TLMD-IV/2023-27 Sd/-
Date: 08-10-2026 Executive Engineer
DIPK-NB-1853/26-DATE 10 OCT 2026 TLMD-IV, Pampore

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
No. BPL/H/EOI/Pathology, Date: 07-10-2026

Chief Medical Superintendent, West Central Railway Bhopal on behalf of the president of India invites (EOI) EXPRESSION OF INTEREST from Pathology Investigation Laboratories for providing diagnostic tests at CGHS rates for the HU. HARDA, GUNA & SHAJAPUR for a period of 02 years. The interested laboratories may download the details from the website of https://wcr.indianrailways.gov.in For further queries, contact the office of the Chief Medical Superintendent, Divisional Rly Hospital Nishatpura Bhopal, Telephone No. 9752416501 Time Line 1. Issue of (EOI) EXPRESSION OF INTEREST : -2. Venue: CMS office, Railway Hospital, Nishatpura, Bhopal 3. Last Date of submission of proposal: 02.11.26 time: 13.00 hrs 4. Date of Opening of the proposal: 02.11.26 Time: 15.00 hrs

Chief Medical Superintement, West Central Railway, Bhopal

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sheikh Sanvar, S/o Sheikh Reku R/o Jhuggi No.112, H-4, Block, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.601/24 u/s 20 NDPS Act, P.S. Jahangirpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheikh Sanvar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheikh Sanvar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheikh Sanvar** of **FIR No.601/24 u/s 20 NDPS Act, P.S. Jahangirpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
Court No.06, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14406/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sheikh Kalam Hussain, S/o Abdul Malik R/o H.No.203, Gali No.4, C-Block, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.615/21 u/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheikh Kalam Hussain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheikh Kalam Hussain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sheikh Kalam Hussain** of **FIR No.615/21 u/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
Room No.6, Ground Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14358/NW/2026

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL OF POLICE
PRISONS DEPARTMENT, J&K
website: www.jkprisons.in, email: prison-jk@nic.in
Phone FAX Srinagar (May-Oct) 0194-2457969 - 2457811
Jammu (Nov-Apr) 0191-2561004 - 2561008

e-TENDER NOTICE FOR SUPPLY OF FRESH VEGETABLE ITEMS AND OF DIETARY / PULSES/CEREALS/SPICES FOR CENTRAL JAIL KOTBHALWAL JAMMU AND DISTRICT JAIL JAMMU.

e-Nit No. 02 of 2026 **DATED 10.10.2026**

1. For and on behalf of Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, e-tenders through online mode are invited from eligible vendors/firms possessing valid FSSAI license for execution of Rate Contracts (valid for one year) for supplies of fresh vegetable items and dietary / pulses/cereals/spices items for Central Jail Kotbhalwal, Jammu and District Jail Jammu as mentioned in Annexure 'K' and Annexure 'L' of this bid document.
2. Bidding documents consisting of eligibility criteria, specifications of items, quantities, set of terms and conditions of contract and other relevant details can be seen/downloaded from the website **www.jktenders.gov.in** and **www.jkprisons.in**

Schedule of tender :

a	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	10.10.2026
b	Period of downloading of bidding documents	10.10.2026 from 1300 Hrs
c	Bid submission Start Date and time	21.10.2026 from 1800 Hrs
d	Bid submission End Date and time	02.11.2026 up to1600 Hrs
e	Date and Time of opening of Technical Bids in online mode	04.11.2026 1400 Hrs in the office of Director General of Prison J&K

3. Tender Fee (Cost of tender documents) :

An amount of Rs. 2500/- towards cost of tender fee has to be deposited by the bidder in the following bank account:

Name of the Account holder : FA/CAO- Prison Department, J&K.
Account Number : 0110010100000289
Name of the Bank : J&K Bank
Branch : J&K Bank Civil Sectt. Jammu
IFSC : JAKA0MOVING

Scanned copy of the receipt towards deposit of amount of tender fee has to be necessarily uploaded along with the bid documents.

i. The bidder has to submit Earnest Money of Rs.17 lakh (Rupees seventeen lacs only) in the form of CDR/FDR issued by a scheduled bank, drawn and pledged in favour of FA/CAO Prison department and payable at Jammu. The bidder has to upload the scanned copy of the CDR/FDR alongwith other documents during submission of bid within the above-mentioned date and time of bid submission.
ii. The department shall not be responsible for delay in online submission due to any reason.
iii The tender shall be in two bid cover system (Technical Bid and Financial Bid).

Sd/-
No: DGP/Proc./E-7937289/6720 **(Deepak Kumar) IPS**
Dated: - 10.10.2026 **Director General of Prisons,**
DIP/J-12239/26 – DATE 10 OCT 2026 **J&K.**

Executive Engineer
PD, P.W.D, Bulandshahr
E- Procurement Short Term Tender Notice

Letter No. 7306/1A **Dated. 06.10.2026**

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate short term bids online through **http://etender.up.nic.in** from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Building work Category as applied from Date **15.10.2026 to 22.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon** as per the prescribed T-1 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bid will be opened online on dated **22.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M.** If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bid as specified, the bid will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. In Lac)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender Cost (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
	Financial Year 2026-27								
1	Construction of rain water harvesting in Block-B of the DM Colony District Bulandshahr.	32.00	3.20	03 Months	300+500+18% GST 141.00 = Rs.944.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Building work)
2	Repair & Maintenance work of office of Bulandshahr Circle, PWD, Bulandshahr building	15.00	1.50	03 Months	225+500+18% GST 131.00 = Rs.856.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C, D (Building work)

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work in column No. 5, including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document Fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. Contractor should be registered in Building work in PWD.
4. All registered contractors have to upload turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
   Details of e-tender uploaded on **http://etender.up.nic.in** shall also be uploaded on uppwd Chanakya Software before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & Conditions related to bids are available on **http://etender.up.nic.in**
6. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
7. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**.

Assistant Engineer
P.D., P.W.D.,
Bulandshahr

UPID-257837 Dt. 09/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Er. Rahul Sharma)
Executive Engineer
P.D., P.W.D., Bulandshahr

epaper.indianexpress.com

RANJI TROPHY 2026-27 SEASON

Great Indian talent hunt begins

As transition phase continues and next World Test Championship cycle looms, season provides an opportunity for emerging stars to find their feet



D Deepesh's pace is likely to grab eyeballs this season. (R) Delhi batsman Ayush Doseja has the raw ability to blunt an attack. TNPL/PTI

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 10

The stock of those that can clock 140kph or upwards has diminished so rapidly that anyone that could complete the pace-criterion zooms into selector's consciousness.

THERE ARE seasons when the Ranji Trophy plays out like a background score, an ambient hum to a busy season, quietly developing the next generation of international players. There are seasons when its tunes become louder and sharper, when the selectors scramble across the quiet locales, eyes probing for sparks, hands jotting down the names that could shape the future and fix the present.

The season that unfolds on Sunday serves the twin purpose more urgently than in recent times — of solving the immediate puzzles and assembling the long-term nucleus in a transition phase, streamlining the needs and priorities, filling the cracks and laying the foundations. Half the eye would be on the tour to New Zealand and the Border Gavaskar Trophy; the other half would be on rebuilding a core group that could challenge for the next WTC cycle and beyond.

The void of the mini fab three (Virat Kohli, Cheteshwar Pujara, and Ajinkya Rahane) and Ravi Ashwin still suffocates.

To a considerable degree, Shubman Gill has raised his level and covered up for Kohli, although sterner tests, harsher decks and more deceitful bowlers await him. But India have not yet sketched in the successors of Pujara and Rahane. Devdutt Padikkal displayed the dynamic stroke-play of a postmodern No.3 in Sri Lanka; Sai Sudharsan exhibited the old-fashioned stonewaller's gutsiness in England, but with technical cracks in his game.

The selectors would ideally want a less flamboyant No.3 than Padikkal but a more technically robust one-down batsman than Sudharsan. Someone in the Rahul Dravid or Cheteshwar Pujara mould, who could wear down bowling firms for the more attacking-inclined batsmen to flourish around them. It's a traditional concept, but the values are still valued in red-ball cricket. Sadly, there are not many of the tribe around.

Like Vidarbha Danish Malewar, who largely batted in the middle order last season, but occupied the top-order in their previous, title-winning season. Jharkhand's Shikhar Mohan keeps filing remainders of his sturdiness, albeit the selectors would assess him for one more season before jetting him to the India A side or subsequently the national side. As it would be for Delhi's Ayush Doseja, a fluent stroke-maker with the grit to blunt an attack, but only a season into domestic cricket.

More ripened batsmen exist in Yash Rathod, Ravichandran Smaran, Sudip Kumar Gharami and Sanat Sangwan, those malleable enough to bat anywhere in the order, specially as a specialist No.5. Somewhere in the scheme, if Dhruv Jurel and Sarfaraz Khan fail to fulfil their promise, some of the names could fulfil their Test dreams. It's a good time to be a batsman in the domestic grind; the runs are less likely to go unnoticed, as the national team is in flux, with only a handful of certainties in the top six. An injury, a prolonged dry streak, and the gaze will waver to the domestic field.

Pace talent

It's even better to be a seamer. The stock of those that can clock 140kph or upwards has diminished so rapidly that anyone that could complete the pace-criterion zooms immediately into the selector's consciousness. The paths of Gurnoor Brar, Harshit Rana and Anshul Kambhoj testify the team management's distress to bolster seam-bowling depth, although most of them are portraits in progress, still relatively raw to first-class cricket and callow.

A glimpse of last edition's wicket-taking pile will furnish the answers for selectors' expediting bowlers on promise rather than performance. Auqib Nabi helms the list; he cannily swings the ball both ways, but qualifies to be a medium pacer even at his quickest. The next seamer—past four spinners, of which three are left-arm tweakers—on the chart is Mohammed Shami, thrust into wilderness. The onslaught of left-arm spinners continues before the browser stops on Vidarbha's Nachiket Bhute, a military medium pacer placed 15th. It's only expected that spinners would feature in the list, but not as disproportionately.

Contrast the drought to a time when Delhi quick Navdeep Saini couldn't barge into the national side; Mohammed Siraj ploughed through seven first-class season before winning Test stripes; Umesh Yadav appearance depended on injuries or breathers for the trifecta of Jasprit Bumrah, Shami and Ishant Sharma. Discernible eyes would hover on the likes of Tamil Nadu pace-pair D Deepesh and Gurjanpreet Singh, Vidarbha's Yash Thakur and Delhi's Mayank Yadav. All are in varying stages of their career, but are on high priority given the paucity of Test-ready options. Monitored too would be the prowess of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi.

Spinner watch

The bowlers' table also depicts the inequitable supply versus demand equation of spinners. Left-arm spinners are abundant, but not so much the other genres. Six left-arm spinners comprise the top 10. Manav Suthar has exerted himself as Ravi Jadeja's worthy inheritor. But the pool is shallow, compared to yesteryears where Jayant Yadav barely found a chance despite a Test hundred.

Some surprises are inevitable, like a left-field entry, or a long-discarded veteran finding himself back in favour, the blossoming of an irresistible wunderkind, but the pervading theme would be striking a balance between the present and future, an eye on BGT, and the other on the next WTC cycle. And it promises to be a domestic season of loud music.

{ TWO TO WATCH OUT FOR }

MANAV SUTHAR, 24, has played three Tests and will captain Rajasthan, with New Zealand ahead. SHIKHAR MOHAN, 21, has one senior season and two trophies behind him, but in his second season, bowlers will come prepared

'Everyday you learn something new'

Bhuvan Gupta
Jaipur, October 10

A FLATTENED-OUT Mullanpur pitch. A helpful Galle surface. A sporting Chelmsford strip. Manav Suthar has taken five wickets or more on all three, in three-odd months.

He is 24, four years into first-class cricket. His Test debut was a blockbuster, and a title-winning County Championship campaign with Warwickshire followed. Now the left-arm spinner is back where he started, this time as captain.

Starting Sunday in Jaipur, he will lead the Rajasthan red-ball side for the first time, in their Ranji Trophy opener against Tamil Nadu. He has already held the reins in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy and Vijay Hazare Trophy. Now he gets to do it in the format he cherishes most.

"I am so grateful to be getting Rajasthan captaincy (in Ranji Trophy). I will give my best for the team and try to fare well in the upcoming season," Manav tells *The Indian Express*.

As he did in Sri Lanka and England, the finger spinner will target the right *tappa* (spot where the ball pitches). "My focus is on maintaining consistency. I gauge what would be the best length for a particular pitch and try to land the ball in the right spot accordingly, around the 4-5m mark from the batsman," he says.



Manav Suthar took 16 wickets in the two-match series in Lanka. PTI

Manav, who has earned luminaries' praise for his old-school bowling action, has a "sharp mind", according to Rajasthan bowling coach Anup Dave. "He can read batsmen faster than other bowlers. He has an idea of what the batsman is going to do and how he needs to bowl, and thus is always at the top of his game," Dave explains. "His X-factor is that he can bowl arm balls and conventional spin, with drift, from the same spot."

The reason behind his versatility across conditions, the coach adds, is his drift and his ability to adapt to different red balls. "Be it domestic cricket's SG ball, Sri Lanka's Kookaburra or England's Dukes, he can deliver the goods. The ball difference doesn't matter to him."

Dave says it is temperament that has the Indian team looking at him as a red-ball mainstay. "You don't get turning tracks in international cricket very often; you have to bowl 30-40 overs to eke out four-five wickets. Manav has the habit of bowling 40-odd overs in a day with ease." He has done it routinely for India A. Per Dave: "He is ready, *usmein hai woh baat* (he's the real deal)."

The Ranji games in October-November lead up to India's two-Test series in New Zealand. India have won five of 25 Tests there, the last in 2009. "I am preparing mentally for the kind of wickets we will get there (in New Zealand) and what can be a suitable line and pace for me. I am watching videos to try and estimate the kind of surfaces they will offer. How they actually behave, we will only know upon getting there," says Manav, who is from Sri Ganganagar.

Manav prepares as per the Indian team's instructions, Dave says. "We don't have to tell him anything. Sairaj Bahutule (India's spin-bowling coach) monitors his bowling regularly; videos of Manav's spells from this match (Rajasthan vs TN) will also go to Bahutule."

A breeze usually flows in New Zealand, Dave, 45, adds, and they will tell him how to bowl into it. "The likes of (Gautam) Gambhir have been there before, they'll surely be advising him. My job is to focus on what he's doing in this Ranji match."

The bowling all-rounder has not forgotten what he brings lower down the order. "Batting is very important. As an all-rounder, *aap team ke bahut kaam aate ho* (you are very useful for the team). If you bat and field well, it gives the team a lot of flexibility," Manav states.

Batters will start to get the hang of his tricks but Manav is unflustered. "*Woh chalta rehta hai* (That is ongoing). *Har roz aap aate ho, har roz nayi cheez seekhte ho* (everyday you come and learn something new)," he signs off.

Shikhar, 21, living father's unfulfilled dream

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, October 10

AT THE Mohans' home in Ranchi, a homecoming had become a festival. Shikhar, the 21-year-old Jharkhand batter, walked in on 5 October with a medal around his neck. A day earlier, in Srinagar, he had lifted the Irani Cup, having made a vital 60 in the first innings against Jammu & Kashmir, the reigning Ranji Trophy champions.

"Everyone was overjoyed. My family, as well as the neighbors and uncles and aunties in our residential society. The entire community was celebrating," Shikhar tells *The Indian Express* from Jamshedpur, where his team are preparing for the red-ball season opener against Kerala.

One member of the family kept his joy in check: his father, Suraj Mohan. The batter has an immediate explanation: "His reaction was quite composed. Probably because I had already spoken with him over the phone right after the match."

Perhaps there is another. Suraj, an advocate by profession, knows his son's journey has only begun. Two trophies in a maiden senior season merit applause. Celebration can wait.

Suraj had dreams of his own that he could never pursue. He was not allowed to. "It was my father who instilled the passion for cricket in me. He wanted me to become a cricketer, so he enrolled me at an academy in a very young age. He used to play cricket as well: he was a fast-bowling all-rounder of his time. He has not explicitly admitted it ever, but I feel he had dreams of becoming a cricketer. But my grandfather was very strict. He would not let his son become a cricketer. So, he became an advocate instead. My father wanted to ensure that he gives me the complete freedom in my cricket career that he always wished for, but never had," the southpaw recalls.



Shikhar Mohan scored 613 runs in eight matches last season. PTI

Shikhar cannot recall the day he first picked up a bat. He was six when Suraj led him by the hand to the Ranchi Cricket Academy. He has since represented his state at Under-16, Under-19 and Under-23 level, and made his senior debut at 20.

He made a double-century in his third appearance. Before the refrain of "it was only Nagaland" could gather volume, he made a hundred against Baroda in the next fixture. He closed the season with 613 runs from eight matches. The Duleep Trophy final then brought an 85 and a 52.

What sets Shikhar apart is respect for the value of his wicket, and a taste for the slow grind that runs against the grain of his generation. "Red-ball cricket is my favourite format. This love was forged through junior cricket. At the Under-16 level, almost all matches are multi-day fixtures. That grind I went through in those years provided the ideal learning curve. Back in age-group tournaments, whenever I would get out, I would analyse what mistake I committed which resulted in the wicket. I worked on refining my shortcomings, and making my technical base very sound. Applying that discipline at the senior level has paid off."

It was also in his Under-16 days that he found cricket was his own vocation, not a burden bequeathed by his father.

"I was only 13 when I was selected for Jharkhand's Under-16 team. That selection gave me the conviction that I possessed genuine talent and that cricket was the path I wanted to dedicate my life to. From that moment, my mind was made up."

He has cricketing idols of his own."Since childhood, I have loved watching Virat Kohli bat. But because I am a boy from Ranchi, of course I used to follow MS Dhoni. It wasn't just about how he played, but his mindset and how positively he approached the game. Whenever he is at the stadium in Jharkhand, he spends time with us and shares his suggestions, which are extremely helpful."

He has yet to share a dressing room with either. He has shared one with two current India players. "Ishan (Kishan) bhaiya has been very helpful in my career. Whenever he joins the team for Ranji or Vijay Hazare matches, he brings a very positive mindset and shares his top-level experience, advising what to do and not to do in specific situations. Even during the Duleep Trophy final, he guided me on which shots to play on that pitch. Then in the Irani Cup, I had the privilege of playing under Rishabh (Pant) bhaiya. He shared his perspective on handling match situations, reading the game under pressure, and how to stay mentally composed."

Topping the run charts for his state in a debut season brings scrutiny. When the new season begins on Sunday, Shikhar Mohan will no longer be an unknown quantity. Bowlers will be ready. So is he. "This upcoming season will be much more challenging, because all the teams will be coming prepared knowing my strengths and weaknesses. I am working hard on my game. I have prepared very well. I am hopeful it will go well."

● HIGHEST-EVER SCORE BY NO 5 AT KINGSMEAD

Record-breaking Renshaw scores 190, puts Australia on top versus South Africa

Reuters
Durban, October 10

MATT RENSHAW struck a career-best 190 to guide Australia to 390 all out on day two of the first Test against South Africa at Kingsmead on Saturday, as the home side reached 27 for one in reply before play was ended prematurely by bad light.

Aiden Markram (15 not out) and David Bedingham (12 not out) will resume on the third morning for South Africa, who were frustrated by the record-breaking innings of Renshaw.

Ryan Rickelton was the hosts' wicket to fall when he was caught at third slip by Beau Webster for a duck off the bowling of Josh Hazlewood.

The day belonged to Renshaw as he shared a record ninth-wicket stand of 134 for Australia against South Africa with Nathan Lyon (27), also the highest partnership for that wicket in Durban.

"There was a lot of thinking today while batting," Renshaw said. "How many balls can I face? How do I get off strike when I need to? It was thinking what we can try and do, trying to find the right options, find a boundary if we could.

"Keeping them out in the field, getting their quicks coming back on. I saw (Marco) Jansen bowled 30-odd (overs), (Anrich) Nortje 30-odd, so they've got some overs into the frontline bowlers in the first innings of the first game."

His score is the highest by a number five batter in tests at Kingsmead, but he was out soon after tea when he edged spinner Simon Harmer to Markram at slip.

Early trouble

Australia were in trouble early in Renshaw's innings as they slipped to 124 for six on day one. But Renshaw flipped the script after putting on 86 for the seventh wicket with skipper Pat Cummins (43).



Matt Renshaw struck a ninth-wicket stand of 134 with Nathan Lyon. AP

Australia started the second day on 187 for six and frustrated the home side before Wiaan Mulder (4-68) had Cummins caught by Markram at second slip.

Mitchell Starc (6) followed quickly after being bowled by Mulder, and at it looked as though South Africa would run through the lower order.

Lyon was circumspect, however, and Renshaw rotated the strike superbly to make sure he had most of the strike and continued to accumulate runs rather than attack the bowling. Lyon fell LBW to Marco Jansen (3-68).

Renshaw's 190 has come off 397 balls, a classic test innings of patience and waiting for the bad ball.

He was struck in the helmet by speedster Anrich Nortje, but he soon settled again and his second test century came nine years after his first, 185 against Pakistan in 2017.

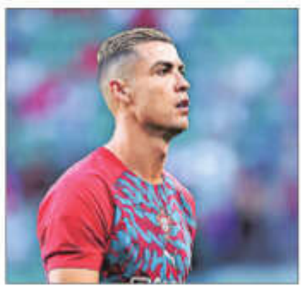
Renshaw had made single-figure scores in 11 of his previous 13 test innings.

"He played beautifully throughout the innings, played what was in front of him and left well," Mulder said. "The partnerships built around him and he played the situation as well as anyone could have at this level.

"It is a good cricket wicket and will get a bit up and down as the game goes on and spin more."

BRIEF SCORES: South Africa 27/1 in 8.4 overs (Aiden Markram 15 not out) trails Australia 390 all-out in 137.2 overs (Matt Renshaw 190, Pat Cummins 43; Wiaan Mulder 4/68, Marco Jansen 3/68) by 363 runs.

Ronaldo suspended by Portugal after walkout



Cristiano Ronaldo. REUTERS

Associated Press
Lisbon, October 10

THE PORTUGUESE Football Federation has suspended Cristiano Ronaldo for walking out on the team and initiated disciplinary proceedings.

The case has been referred to its disciplinary investigation committee and its findings will remain confidential until its conclusions are reached, the federation said in a statement Saturday.

The 41-year-old Ronaldo left the Portugal camp during the international window in a dispute with new coach Jorge Jesus over his lack of playing time in the Nations League.

In the three games Ronaldo was either an unused substitute or absent, Portugal won, and his replacement Gonçalo Ramos seized his chance by scoring three goals.

Ronaldo was involved only in Portugal's opening Nations League game, where he was replaced by Ramos in a 1-0 win over Wales. He left the squad after watching the second game from the substitutes' bench — a 2-1 win in Norway — and Portugal showed no ill effects from his departure with wins over Denmark and Norway to book a quarterfinal.

Ronaldo ended the international break with a long post to his 679 million followers on Instagram, where he asked the Portugal coach to acknowledge a mistake in asking him to warm up on the sidelines in Oslo and then not send him on the field. Jesus did not acknowledge any mistake.

The star wrote that he expected a suspension under federation rules but promised his fans "we will have one or more farewell matches." Ronaldo could possibly face a harsh punishment for leaving the training camp. The federation's disciplinary regulations say that any player who "abandons or fails to appear" without justification at a training session, match or activity of the national teams "shall be sanctioned with a suspension of one to six months," in addition to a fine.

Ronaldo did tell the federation he was leaving, but it wasn't clear whether the decision would be considered justified in accordance with the regulations. "I have already apologized, but I know that actions must have consequences," Ronaldo wrote. "Anyone in football as I am knows that, regardless of each person's status, the rules are the same for everyone."

WEST INDIES TOUR OF INDIA

Spinners in a spin as Indore awaits Kuldeep, Axar & Dhir

Roston Chase took three for 24 in Ranchi, while India's trio took one for 141 runs. Sunday's ground is smaller.

Shankar Narayan
Indore, October 10

MORE THAN 500 runs were scored in Ranchi on Friday, and the spell that stayed was Roston Chase's 4-0-24-3. Abhishek Sharma fell to a shorter ball with considerable bounce. Ishan Kishan to a length ball that skidded through and did not bounce as much as he expected. Shivam Dube to a flatter delivery, clocked at 92.7 kph, that again kept low.

In Lucknow on Tuesday, Chase had gone for 37 in 3.4 overs and removed Abhishek, on a ground with long boundaries where India's spinners took a combined 7/90 in 11 overs. In Ranchi, he varied his pace and lines and made India's batsmen work for their runs, in a match where India's spin trio struggled to find the right length and stay consistent.

For Shai Hope, those four overs had kept West Indies in the game.

"On a surface and a field like this, to go out at six runs an over is unbelievable," Hope said after the game. "So he really kept us in the game. It was very difficult conditions to bowl on, so the way he bowled and kept us in the game made it a lot easier for us to chase that score."

India's spin trio of Axar Patel, Naman Dhir and Kuldeep Yadav could not do the same. Axar finished with 3.3-0-63-0, Kuldeep with 4-0-53-1 and Dhir with 2-0-25-0. Together, they conceded 141 runs in 9.3 overs.

Axar's first over had two dots, and some deliveries did go past the batsmen. But he also offered too many balls that could be hit. Hope smashed a short delivery over mid-on, and another was pulled for six. Later, a full toss down leg was struck for six. Shreyas Iyer sought control from his bowling bank, yet found none.

Dhir gave away seven runs from his first over, with a few balls that missed the bat and were defended. His second went for 18. Hope sent a floated delivery outside off flat for six over long-off. Sherfane Rutherford then hammered him for a four and a six to further release the pressure. His work for the night was done.

Kuldeep had a mixed outing. He dismissed Rutherford to end a 120-run stand with Hope, but his last over went for 24, with Hope and Romario Shepherd taking him apart.

Coach defends bowlers

Gautam Gambhir defended his bowlers in the post-match presentation.

"You don't want a good bat-and-ball competition? What you want to see, that's also what we want to see. We also want to see an even contest."

"These bowlers are our bowlers, not someone else's bowlers. Their careers are at stake; they have worked hard to sit in this dressing room. If it's an even competition, we'll see a better game of cricket," he said.

"These are tough conditions to bowl. We know that flat wickets with the dew, obviously, it's tough. But we need to figure out the way...to try and stop the opposition," he added.

The series moves to Indore for the third T20I on Sunday. Gambhir and batting coach Sitanshu Kotak looked at the pitch on Saturday. Holkar Stadium's shorter boundaries are unlikely to make life easier for the spinners.

There is a reason for India to take confidence from the Ranchi defeat. The conditions were difficult for bowlers, yet one spinner bowled four overs for 24 runs and took three wickets. Chase did not rely on extravagant turn.

He varied his pace, changed his lines and used different lengths to unsettle the batsmen and eventually dismiss them. India will need something similar from Axar, Kuldeep and Dhir.

The trio have a reference point before the third T20I. They don't need to go hunting for wickets with every ball. They need to make West Indies earn every boundary. Even on batting-friendly surfaces, a spinner can seize control by making the batsman think twice.

They will also need to trust their plans under pressure. With smaller boundaries, any lapse in execution could be punished and force a change in the field. The challenge will be to stay patient and resist the temptation of changing their plan every second ball.

The template was there in Ranchi. Now India need to execute it.

INDIA VS WEST INDIES, third T20I, Live on Star Sports Network & JioHotstar, 7 pm.





Kuldeep Yadav's (L) economy rate in this series 10.75, while Roston Chase's figure is 7.95. CREIMAS/PTI

Chase did not rely on extravagant turn. He varied his pace, changed his lines and used different lengths to unsettle the batsmen and eventually dismiss them. India will need something similar from their spinners.

India's wrestlers are at 40% of their potential: Shako

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, October 10

THE INDIAN wrestling team had its best Asian Games since 1962 in 2026, winning two gold, two silver and two bronze medals.

Freestyle wrestlers accounted for half the medals: Aman Sehrawat (57 kg) and Sujeet Kalkal (65 kg) won gold, and Deepak Punia (97 kg) won bronze. Among the other freestyle wrestlers, Sagar Jaglan (74 kg) defeated reigning Olympic champion Razambek Jamalov of Uzbekistan in the repechage but fell short in the bronze medal match.

Freestyle coach Bentinidis Shako believes the performance can improve further as the Indian wrestlers work on their mindset. In an exclusive conversation with *The Indian Express*, Shako dissected the Asian Games performance. Here are the excerpts:

On Asiad performance

Three medallists out of five wrestlers. I am more than happy with the performance. Aman and Sujeet both showed why they are so highly rated. Sagar defeated the reigning Olympic champion but lost in the medal match. But he lost to a World Championships medallist, so there is a lot of learning for him. Overall, I am satisfied with the performance.



"I would want the Indian wrestlers to get the quota at the 2027 World C'ships as that saves a lot of mental mathematics and hassle. By the time we enter the year 2028, India should have won all the quotas available."
BENTINIDIS SHAKO
INDIA'S FREESTYLE COACH

On Aman and Sujeet

Both are different kinds of wrestlers. Aman is one of the best conditioned wrestlers in the country and it shows during his bouts. Sujeet, on the other hand, is a more technical wrestler. He is more attacking and someone who can dominate the opponent from the start.

But I think there is a lot more to explore with these two wrestlers. I have been working with them. I have worked with Aman on his defence, especially his mindset during the early moments of the bout. Similarly, with Sujeet I have been working on his attack, and will also work on his ground wrestling in the gap left for the World Championships.

On Deepak Punia

You have to give it to the man. He wasn't competing in his natural weight category and still performed exceptionally well. He will return to the 86 kg category, but credit to him for adapting to the 97 kg category, and that too at the Asian level, which has ample competition in the category.

On the freestyle group

Indian wrestlers have all the aspects correct, but they have to improve their mindset. That is what we have been working on. There is no need to have butterflies because you're going to face a World Champion or a wrestler from Japan or Iran.

On 2026 World C'ships

There is a very short gap between the two tournaments. It is going to be tough as the other countries will be fresher, but I believe Sujeet is ready for the challenge. He is someone who loves wrestling, and there is nothing better than one championship after another for a wrestler who is having such momentum.

On the 2028 LA Olympics

We have a solid group as of now. Maybe we need to improve in the heavyweight categories, but overall there is a good base we have built for the 2028 Olympics. I would want the Indian wrestlers to get the quota at the 2027 World Championships as that saves a lot of mental mathematics and hassle.

By the time we enter the year 2028, India should have won all the quotas available. This will give us time to prepare well and plan in advance for the 2028 Olympics. Trust me, Indian wrestlers are at just 40 percent of their potential. I want to take them to 100.

• CAUGHT IN A LOOP

Badminton's men's singles is stuck in Groundhog Day

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, October 10

IT IS not their fault they are boring, they've never watched themselves play.

The current men's singles lacks the dashing fervour of a slam-bang attacking player. Like Viktor Axelsen could morph into, at the sight of a lift. Or like Lee Zii Jia unleashed, when he wasn't required to pay debt to legacy-creation, with its herculean demands.

Newly crowned Asian Games champion Kunlavut Vitidsarn, Japanese World Championships runner-up Kodai Naraoka, the Chinese heir to a shaky throne Li Shifeng and India's superstar Lakshya Sen all have winninger qualities than a mere sharp attack. They are so well-rounded, with their classical technique, relentless defence, the Chinese blueprint and Sen's one-day brilliance, that they have found ways to make the smash economical. They are expected to play so much badminton that you can't blame them for finding faux-ferocity cloaked in disciplined retrieving, which has turned men's singles into an efficient drill.

You didn't need to be a giant on court like Axelsen, or have sculpted biceps like Zii Jia at All England. Kidambi Srikanth had a glorious attack without flexing strength and power. Men's singles believed in a swatting smash, move on, don't look back ethos. But slow courts, punishing schedules, attritional insistence and whatever went on in the neurons between Kodai Naraoka's headband, like the mysterious core of ringed Saturn, turned men's singles into Groundhog Day, nationality no bar.

Chou Tien Chen and Jojo Christie are very fine human beings, and Shi Yuqi has only recently learnt to mock opponents by pretend-flinging a racquet, so nobody has the stomach to tell them they have made badminton a safari-suited, briefcased 9-to-5. But the injury-ravaged Gen Hexed is really not good at piquing eyeballs. It's not like they are Tai Tzu-ying. Efficiency is not tricks, it's tedium that happens to be handsomely rewarded in this era.

So, like with all things badminton, Indonesians have arrived to rescue the soul. Alwi Farhan and Ubaidillah have varied but snappy attacks, and attitudes to match. They can take on the Chinese, and get Taufik Hidayat to go woot woot in the stands. The team event at the Asian Games, won by the Indonesians, had roused Taufik from his shrugging default of a pose.

There are sparks elsewhere. Ayush Shetty is going to take time to get stronger to carry the attack he possesses. Injuries can set him back by months. But once he hits top gear, 2028 LA could look very imminent.

Lin Chun-yi did win the All England this year, skating on the grey courts, but he hasn't recovered from the last injury.

Driving it home, and reminding them of their fragilities at the Asian Games, was Korea's Yoo Tae-bin. The names are interchangeable, but it's well known the Koreans unearth temperament monsters for team events, who arrive like typhoons, lay the land to waste and disappear just as quickly as they struck.

But this time might be different. Korea's legendary coach Park Joo-bong handpicked the 6ft-plus Yoo, and besides bothering China in the teams, he scythed through the individual draw, taking out Lin Chun-yi, Shi Yuqi and Kodai Naraoka. The best of Taiwan, China and Japan were packed off within 48 hours of the madcap scheduling that was badminton at the Asiad.

Yoo has been committed to an attacking game since his growing years in Gimcheon, and how the No 48 evolves will be watched. He looks up to Asia's most successful footballer, Son Heung-min, with his camera celebration. He carries the burden of making badminton smash photogenic again, while Ginting makes fans nostalgic.

A blast from the attacking past was Loh Kean Yew, one of the earliest to blitz Axelsen off his perch, with a one-dimensional attack at the 2021 World Championships that flummoxed experts: just why was he winning? Except they had to concede he won a lot. Like, gold.

At the Asiad it was silver. Tortoise, rabbits, etcetera. Singapore preserved him by not entering the team event, keeping him fresh while the rest of the field ran ragged and fell aside. Lakshya Sen was handed a routine-looking defeat as India's men's singles medal saw no encore. Loh won the Singapore Open this year, but he hasn't won much otherwise. He has gone in a blink from 2021 yuppie to dad-jokes teller. (What would he name his pet? Minton, because if he's throwing a tantrum, Loh can call him Badminton.) He says he tells dad jokes because he is a dad now.

Yoo quips he digs singles because he doesn't want to share prize money, and because it looks "cool". World champion Alex Lanier boasts of a classical, clean-lined game, but it's honed by chess and golf, so he is bound to overthink and complicate it someday. Men's singles is aching to rush headlong into the 15-point game, when things might spice up.



Alwi Farhan was part of Indonesia's gold-winning Asiad team. AP

• BRIEFLY



Shubhankar Sharma sank a three-under 69. EXPRESS

Shubhankar wins Kapil Dev Invitational Tour C'ship

SHUBHANKAR SHARMA received a timely boost ahead of the DP World India Championship as he sank a three-under 69 to win the Rs 2 crore Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship by six strokes here on Saturday. The 30-year-old Chandigarh golfer (68-65-72-69), who began the final round with a two-shot advantage, made an eagle on the par-five 12th, three birdies and two bogeys to finish at 14-under 274. It was Shubhankar's second victory in as many appearances on the DP World PGTI this season. PTI

Koch stars in Bengaluru's 3-2 win over Delhi

BENGALURU FC began their Indian Super League campaign with a thrilling 3-2 comeback victory over Sporting Club Delhi on Saturday. In the league's 2026-27 season opener, Menno Koch scored the winner for BFC in the 89th minute at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium. The decisive moment arrived in the 89th minute when Varshneya delivered a cross into the box, finding Koch, who rose to head the ball home, securing BFC's win. PTI

Goa fight back to hold Chennaiyin to a 1-1 draw

FC GOA and Chennaiyin FC played out a 1-1 draw in the second match of the Indian Super League 2026-27 season on Saturday. Irfan Yadwad gave Chennaiyin FC the lead in the 64th minute before Chiki's headed equaliser in the 75th minute ensured FC Goa came away with a point in their season opener. Chennaiyin broke the deadlock in the 64th minute when Irfan drove a right-footed effort into the far corner, while Goa equalised from a header. PTI

Medvedev advances at Shanghai

DANIIL MEDVEDEV has won his first match since being disqualified at the China Open for hitting a spectator in the eye with a ball he hit into the stands. Medvedev beat Jan-Lennard Struff 4-6, 6-4, 6-3 in a second-round match on Saturday at the Shanghai Masters, an ATP 1000 tennis event. Medvedev, who now holds a 10-2 career edge over Struff, had been disqualified during his semifinal Monday against Novak Djokovic. AP

Alonso hails Caicedo after Chelsea's big win

CHELSEA MANAGER Xabi Alonso has had to wait until October to see what his side can do with midfielder Moises Caicedo properly back in the team and he was delighted with his role in the 5-1 demolition of Bournemouth in the Premier League on Saturday. "With him we have a better midfield area and when you are better in the middle you have a more complete team and something to build around," the Spaniard told reporters. REUTERS

Arsenal come from behind to beat Leeds

ARSENAL CAME back from a goal down to beat Leeds United 2-1 at the Emirates Stadium on Saturday, with Brazilian Bruno Guimaraes coming off the bench to net the winner as the Premier League resumed following a lengthy international break. Champions Arsenal climbed to second in the table on 15 points, behind Manchester City on goal difference. Leeds are fifth on nine points. REUTERS

Prithviraaj Yodhas win in Archery PL

PRITHVIRAAJ YODHAS handed Chero Archers their first defeat in a match that required multiple 'Sudden Death' situations in the Archery Premier League. In the day's first match, Mighty Marathas finally registered their first win of the season, beating Chola Chiefs 6-0. In the third match, defending champions Rajputana Royals suffered back-to-back defeats. PTI

Augsburg's Fellhauer scores fastest goal in Bundesliga history

Reuters
Augsburg, October 10

AUGSBURG'S ROBIN Fellhauer scored after eight seconds of the game against visitors Bayern Munich on Saturday to record the ☒fastest goal in Bundesliga history, but the German champions twice came from a goal down to snatch a 2-2 draw.

Fellhauer benefited from a blunder by Bayern's Manuel Neuer as the keeper tried to clear but sent the ball to the Augsburg player who improved the record held jointly by Kevin Volland and Karim Bellarabi with goals after nine seconds.

The Bavarians, whose only league defeat in their last 48 matches was by Augsburg in January, upped their game after the break, having an effort ruled offside in the 51st before Ismael Saibari bagged the equaliser four minutes later.

It was another Neuer error that put Augsburg ahead again in the 64th minute, the 40-year-old punching Calvin Brackelmann's shot into the path of Rodrigo Ribeiro who only had to push the ball over the line.

Bayern battled back once more, however, when Harry Kane, who hit the woodwork in the first half, cut the ball back for Nathaniel Brown to tap in the equaliser 10 minutes from time. Gnabry hit the post three minutes but Bayern had to settle for a point.



Robin Fellhauer netted in only 8 seconds against Bayern. AP

Vol.XXV No. 30 Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 R.N.I. No. DELENG/2002/10884. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida - 201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector - 10, Noida - 201301. Phone: 0120-6651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi):Monojit Majumdar** **Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®

THE SUNDAY EXPRESS MAGAZINE

EYE

OCTOBER 11, 2026



BOOKS | PAGE 2

A Quiver Full of Twists

A farewell letter to his readers, *Adam & Eve*, about a woman's fight against the accident of her birth, is a propulsive, warm Archer novel

SCREEN | PAGE 3

Parvathy Thiruvothu's shapeshifting act



In Delhi's Drawing Room

Once the heart of the Capital's cultural and social life, Sujan Singh Park was home to writers, artists, bureaucrats and working families. Today, one of New Delhi's first private residential apartments lives with an uncertain future





EXPRESS ARCHIVE



PHOTOS COURTESY: RAM RAHMAN

(Clockwise from far left) Sujan Singh Park today; Khushwant Singh at home; (L-R) Inder Kumar Gujral (former Prime Minister), dancer Indrani Rahman with Ram Rahman as a baby, artists Satish Gujral and MF Husain, art critic Charles Fabri; (below) an aerial view

Rinku Ghosh

THE AFTERNOON sun splits the last of a tired monsoon cloud, slanting in through the large windows. Author-editor Mala Dayal draws the curtains, as has been her habit of decades. A few blocks away, columnist Bhaichand Patel sits at his writing desk, sifting memories of the Valentine's Day parties in his lawn, a large oil painting of a young Nargis keeping him company. On the other side of the road, behind the arches and trees leaning over them, and inside the staff quarters, 81-year-old Surendra Mohan Sharma sits under the canopy of a banyan tree he had planted as a child with his father and grandfather.

But the quiet of Sujan Singh Park cloaks a turbulent time for the upscale neighbourhood in the heart of New Delhi. The Centre had initiated eviction proceedings, arguing that the original lease on the 7.85-acre property expired in 1960. Temporary relief to the residents came this August when the Delhi High Court stayed proceedings. One of the Capital's longest-standing disputes that has pitted the Centre against Sir Sobha Singh & Sons Pvt Ltd, the real estate company that runs Sujan Singh Park, has unsettled a community that has lived here for generations.

This is where celebrated author Khushwant Singh lived, wrote and met people from all walks of life. Where winter get-togethers on the lawns and house parties meant filmmakers brushed shoulders with bureaucrats and architects met politicians. Sited opposite Khan Market, one of the world's most expensive retail spaces, with its exposed brick façade and elegant arches, it was where ancestral heft sat side-by-side with the quotidian. And people didn't feel the difference. But that was more than eight decades ago.

Today, hidden by canopies of kadam, amaltas and mulberry trees, the guards at the gate will stop you and ask for the house number. Over the decades, Sujan Singh Park has moved, in mood, from Van Gogh's *Café Terrace at Night* to Edward Hopper's *Nighthawks* — from a place of creative richness to one where the loneliness of a large city is palpable. From being at the centre of Delhi's cultural and intellectual life, to being at the centre of a long court battle, staring at an uncertain future.

From the Raj to Post Partition

Built in 1945 to house military officers of the Raj during World War II, Sujan Singh Park was designed by Walter Sykes George, an architect who was in his 30s when he arrived in India as an assistant to Herbert Baker who, alongside Edwin Lutyens, was then shaping the architecture of New Delhi. Working on some of these ambitious government projects was a young Indian contractor, Sobha Singh, Khushwant's father. He built the multi-storeyed housing estate on land permanently leased by the British, then surrounded by scrub jungle and the wild calls of jackals. Named after Sobha Singh's father, Sujan Singh, the estate is spread over seven blocks, each of which hosts 12 townhouses. There is a staff quarters block, a primary school, the Ambassador Hotel and numerous small enterprises, including the motor market within the precinct. With its long foyers shielded by *jaalis*, deep verandas and high ceilings, the houses were cool even in Delhi's harshest summer.

"Sujan Singh Park is a seminal pre-Independence mass housing project. It was an early effort to resolve housing problems in India and address modernisation of cities," says heritage conservation expert Gaurav Raj Sharma, founder of the multidisciplinary architecture practice, Under Mango Tree. Sharma says the exposed brickwork here "would be further explored in later projects such as the housing projects in Chandigarh and IIM, Ahmedabad." In a first, the apartments had air vents and garbage chutes.

Following Partition, Sobha Singh opened the complex to families fleeing Pakistan, including his own, while honouring the lease agreement of allocating 50 per cent of the flats to British government officials at concessional rents, a practice that continued once India became independent.

The Early Residents

"This began as a regular, middle-class neighbourhood. People who came with nothing rebuilt their lives brick by brick. There were Dasaprakash and Chona's as the family eating places in Khan Market. The twin bookshops, Bahrisons and Faqir Chand, became our window to the world. There were grocery and convenience stores, garages and tent *walas*," says Naina Dayal, a Delhi University history professor and Khushwant's granddaughter. Patel recalls that among the early residents there were "hardly any businessmen or millionaires. We had a rhythm of life and became invisibly bonded as a community. Not that we meet every day but for major life events, we always show up. People just walk in and resume conversations from where they had left off. It's a beautiful bond," he says. Perhaps that's because nobody is an owner, everybody is a tenant, with life on rent. Apart from government accommodation, a pie which has shrunk over the years, the rest of the apartments are shared by private tenants and Sobha Singh's kin.

Preminder Singh or Pami, Sobha Singh's grandson, Khushwant's nephew and trustee of The Sir Sobha Singh Public Charitable Trust, recalls his early years here during the violence after the Partition riots. "My father (Bhagwant Singh) and fellow residents of Sujan Singh Park formed a committee to protect Muslim residents. He would move around with a gun. I was six years old then," he says. Shiva Parmar, a corporate and descendant of former Himachal Chief Minister YS Parmar, plays down any connection to privilege. "My father chose a life far away from the one he could have had. He became a receptionist at the Ambassador Hotel and then he got this two-bedroom apartment. He later changed companies and retired as director of Mafatlal Industries. My mother was a flight attendant with BOAC (the British Overseas Airways Corporation, a prominent British state-owned airline that operated from 1940 until 1974). This place nurtured self-starters over pedigree," he says.

According to Parmar, residents, despite their proximity to the corridors of power, never believed in the "by invitation only" culture. A motor garage owner from the service quarters became a rentee of the apartment below Parmar's. "No class divide but a class mix. I was exposed to different ways of looking at things. A well-known cardiologist would work as a GP, once he came home after work. When the first black-and-white TVs were launched (in 1975), neighbours invited each other to watch *Chitrahaar* and classics. I remember how Aunty Dean, who headed the nursing division at Gangaram Hospital, held Christmas parties with underprivileged and special children. My mother made sure that I attended them. In our minds, we were all kids wanting the same things," says Shiva. His friend Rohit Dean recalls how every neighbour kept their homes open for children. "I had more friends in the service block; we would run over to India Gate lawns and then slurp ice cream from Carry Home, the only one in the area, on the way back," he says. "Khan Market worked on trust, everybody ordered everything and the shopkeepers complied, knowing that nobody was leaving the place and that the money would come," adds Dean.

From the '70s onwards, the Ambassador Hotel became the home of Russian engineers, who were launching several industrial plants in India. As expats rented apartments down the years, residents became more blended than anywhere else. Of course, coming of age was exciting with the disco revolution in the '80s. "The Wheel's disco at Ambassador was a social hotspot for young people and competed with Tabla at The Oberoi," says Parmar.

Khushwant's Cultural Durbar

As Sujan Singh Park became the beating heart of a culture capital, Khushwant pivoted a community that was open and inclusive. His home was an informal salon where writers, scholars, diplomats and friends gathered in a spirit of conversation and intellectual exchange. Mala recalls how scholar-poet AK Ramanujan's wife, Molly Daniels, lived here while teaching English literature at Delhi University. The complex became a crossroads for some of the most influential literary and intellectual figures of the 20th century. Author Ruth Prawer Jhabvala and her architect-husband Cyrus Jhabvala dropped by, while authors VS Naipaul and Vikram Seth visited whenever they were in Delhi. Khushwant also kept his doors open to friends from Pakistan, healing lifelong relationships severed by the Partition.

Photographer-archivist Ram Rahman, whose parents Habib Rahman and Indrani lived here, recalls architects, artists, dancers coming home to meet them. Habib was then chief architect at the Central Public Works Department (CPWD). Indrani, a well-known classical dancer, had her bevy of artistes and gurus visiting and often staying over.

"Historians Upinder Singh and Vijaya Ramaswamy, scholar Vijay Tankha, spiritual teacher Madhav Ashish, publisher Urvashi Butalia, who briefly ran Kali for Women from the colony, and diplomat Badruddin Tyabji were all part of this milieu," says Naina, who would wake up with her grandfather by 5 am and had tea made by him. Patel, once a die-hard Mumbaikar, chose to stay close to his "writing" mentor. "Guests were allowed to visit Khushwant's flat from 7 to 8 pm and he had no qualms nudging then PM Manmohan Singh out as he would sleep by 9 pm." Another resident, Dilshad Begum, bonded with Khushwant over Ghalib. "I would make kebabs for him. He was always interested in women's opinions," she says.

Surendra Mohan's father ran a garage servicing mainly Army vehicles, while his grandfather worked with the NDMC. "I was born here as my family moved from the Partition camp at Purana Qila. I went to school, started my garage repair business, had two daughters — my whole life happened here. Everywhere else is unfamiliar. If the windows on the other side overlooked the park, ours framed the backs of the buildings, the service paths. My mornings were about a running tap, quick showers, the clink of pots and pans, a scooter starting below the window as drivers, housekeepers, cooks got ready for their jobs at the park. From nothing, we had a livelihood and grew roots. Like the banyan tree here," he says.

A Blended Community

For Malvika Singh, aka Mala, author and editor of *Seminar,* it nurtured a "sense of community. Sujan Singh Park was never a gated colony." Married to Tejbir, Sobha Singh's grandson, she says, "There were vendors who came by, who came for old clothes, the *phal wala*, the papad *wala*, the *phool wala*; they were the eyes and ears of the complex. Neighbours were from all professions."

Ram talks about a winter get-together of December 1992, when Babri Masjid had just been demolished. "Malvika's party was planned way ahead. The cards said 'Celebrate' but when we heard the news of the demolition, she decided to cancel it. I told her just blot out the word and send out the invites. We got artists to respond to the demolition and their works were displayed along the sides as a protest. Sujan Singh Park was like Camelot," he says. In fact, it was at Habib's house that legendary artists MF Husain and Satish Gujral met for the first time. Later in life they would fall out, but at that time, this was a place of chance encounters.

Architect Romi Khosla, who lived as a tenant, calls the complex a template of an ideal urban environment that was ahead of its time. He contends that the relentless commodification of urban land is eroding the very idea of the city. "The problem is compounded by the centralisation of power. Without giving citizens a genuine voice in shaping their neighbourhoods, they lose a sense of belonging," says Khosla. Jan Gehl, Danish architect and urban planner, who has studied cities, believes "a good neighbourhood should feel like one big hug, where nobody feels left out," an embrace that still exists. "At the centre of this value system, is a layered capital city, with seven older capitals, from Indraprastha to Tughlakbad. People come to India, to Delhi, to see those legacies. Sujan Singh Park is only a blip of how life can be lived as a community. Why don't we carry that idea forward? To me, it symbolised openness and equality, the unpredictable and the spontaneous," says Malvika. Much like a gift that keeps on giving.

BUILT IN 1945 TO HOUSE MILITARY OFFICERS OF THE RAJ DURING WORLD WAR II, SUJAN SINGH PARK WAS DESIGNED BY WALTER SYKES GEORGE. A SEMINAL HOUSING PROJECT, IT WAS AN EARLY EFFORT TO RESOLVE HOUSING PROBLEMS IN INDIA AND ADDRESS MODERNISATION OF CITIES

With inputs from Shiny Varghese



PRAVEEN KHANNA

THE WORD THIS WEEK

A Reader's Guide to ANNE CARSON

THE CANADIAN poet, classicist and essayist, Anne Carson, awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Literature, has spent four decades bringing ancient Greece into startling proximity with modern life. In her hands, scholarship becomes a form of longing, and myth a language for private wounds. Her poetry shapeshifts into criticism, from fiction to visual art. What unites them is a philologist's tenderness for the word and a poet's hunger for feeling. For those new to Carson, here are five books that offer an entry point into her poetic universe:

PAROMITA CHAKRABARTI

Eros the Bittersweet (1986)



CARSON'S FIRST major book is a study of desire and reads like an incandescent love letter. Starting from Sappho's word for love, bittersweet, she argues that eros lives in the distance between lover and beloved, in lack rather than possession. What might sound like an academic proposition becomes, in Carson's hands, a theory of literature itself. The work established the intellectual foundations of her singular poetic sensibility.

Autobiography of Red (1998)



THIS NOVEL in verse takes a scrap of the Greek poet Stesichorus, in which the monster Geryon is killed by Herakles, and reimagines him as a shy, red-winged teenager who falls hopelessly in love with the careless, golden Herakles. Part myth, part coming-of-age story, part essay on poetry, it is funny, strange and cruelly tender. Carson's flickering lines carry grief and wit in equal measure. In 2013, Carson wrote its sequel, *Red Doc*.

The Beauty of the Husband (2001)



SUBTITLED *A Fictional Essay in 29 Tangos*, the book approaches the collapse of a marriage as a dance whose partners cannot agree on the music. Carson's speaker circles an unfaithful husband, examining the appeal and humiliations of loving someone who betrays you. John Keats's equation of beauty and truth hovers over the proceedings. It won the TS Eliot Prize, making Carson the first woman to receive it.

If Not, Winter: Fragments of Sappho (2002)



CARSON'S TRANSLATION of Sappho pays homage to loss and absence, and what remains of a voice after 2,600 years. Sappho's work survives only in fragments quoted by other writers, In Carson's hands the absence appears as square brackets, white space gapes, and a half-word hangs forlornly to denote the void. Rather than tidying the fragments into meaning, Carson lets the reader weigh in on the absences.

Nox (2010)



NOX LOOKS like a scroll in a box, reproducing a scrapbook Carson made after the death of her estranged brother. Photographs, letters, and fragments of memory sit beside her attempt to translate Catullus's elegy for his own brother, each Latin word unpacked like a dictionary entry. Grief is both subject and method. Carson radically reinvents the book itself, making the physical experience of reading a part of the process of mourning.

WHAT I READ THIS WEEK



ROHIT JAIN PARAS

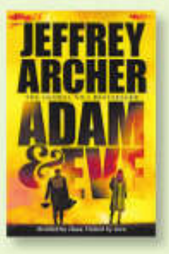
Swan Song

There is no shortage of melodrama in Jeffrey Archer's final novel, Adam & Eve

Aishwarya Khosla

JEFFREY ARCHER loved a plot twist, so there is a grim symmetry in the last one that life handed him. He died on October 5, 2026, the day before his final novel, *Adam & Eve*, was published. The book opens with a letter in which Archer thanks his legion of fans and bids them farewell.

Continuing in the vein of his most popular work, *Kane and Abel*, his swan song has a biblical title and begins with two star-crossed children born on the same day, Armistice Day, November 11, 1918, at opposite ends of the English class system. Evelina Brancaster is the daughter of an earl who wanted a son to inherit his title. Adam Preston is the son of a shepherd on the same estate, whose father hoped for a daughter, knowing a boy would one day be sent to fight.



ADAM & EVE
JEFFREY ARCHER
HarperCollins
480 pages
₹599

Doubles run all through. Evelina had a stillborn twin; she is later courted by twin suitors, and, in the older generation, there is a rivalry worthy of Cain and Abel between the Earl and his brother Dudley. It is a reminder that primogeniture pits brothers against each other as it shuts out daughters.

If *Kane and Abel* was about ambition and the American dream, *Adam & Eve* champions women's rights, a message much needed in a world where we are seeing them slide backwards. The young Eve, unconventionally for a lady, would rather tend the farm with its animals and plants than sit through her lessons. She cannot understand why the estate must pass to her cousin simply because she is a girl. Archer wants to show that a woman can be every bit a man's equal, and Eve is the perfect foil for Adam. Where he is the scholar, she is the sportswoman. When war comes and he is drawn into foreign affairs, she holds the home together.

With its footmen and crumbling estates, the book is reminiscent of *Downton Abbey*. However, the Earl, in the early stages of the book to be a fuddy-duddy traditionalist, changes his mind about women and his tenants too quickly to be realistic, and the Dowager, a friend of Emmeline Pankhurst, is implausibly progressive. In no time at all, Adam is the Earl's chess partner, and an acceptable match for his daughter.

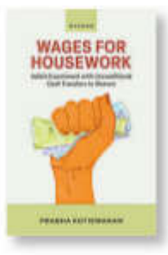
There is no shortage of melodrama, complete with murder plots and gambling pots, and Archer fans will find it a page-turner with twist after twist. It is a fitting capstone to Archer's tremendous oeuvre, conveying his desire for a better, more equal world, one where men actually learn from history and refuse to wage unnecessary war. The farewell letter alone makes the book worth reading.

Making Women's Work Count

Prabha Kotiswaran's Wages for Housework *finds a novel way to reiterate the argument in favour of giving domestic labour its due credit*

Shalina Susan Mathew

IN JANUARY 2021, actor-turned-politician Kamal Haasan promised Tamil Nadu's voters that if elected, he would pay the state's homemakers for the work he said had gone unrecognised and unmonetised for generations. When Congress MP Shashi Tharoor tweeted his support, actor-turned-BJP MP Kangana Ranaut argued that the commodification of women's unpaid work would disturb women's supremacy over the private domain. This triggered a debate over whether Haasan had said something progressive or something regressive. What almost nobody pointed out was that nine years earlier, Goa had quietly begun paying married women a monthly sum under the Griha Aadhar scheme, without ever calling it payment for housework.



WAGES FOR HOUSEWORK: INDIA'S EXPERIMENT WITH UNCONDITIONAL CASH TRANSFERS TO WOMEN
PRABHA KOTISWARAN
Oxford University Press
368 pages
₹1,250

Prabha Kotiswaran's *Wages for Housework* is an attempt at asking whether the unconditional cash-transfer schemes of India's 12 states (at the time of writing the book) amounts collectively and mostly unintentionally to the fulfilment of an argument first made over 80 years ago.

Because she isn't paid, her domestic and care work is invisible — absent from GDP, from the Census and often invisible even to the women themselves, who describe their daily chores as simply *niji* or personal work rather than valuable work sustaining the economy and society. Kotiswaran traces the origins of the argument to the Wages for Housework (WFH) campaign launched in 1972 by Selma James, Silvia Federici and Mariarosa Dalla Costa in Padua, Italy. They argued that capitalism runs on unpaid female labour whose exploitation stays invisible until priced. However, the majority of the founders considered the demand more as a political perspective and a revolutionary strategy towards recognition of housework than a payout for housewives *per se*. The campaign lasted in an organised form only until 1977, after which the liberal feminist agenda 'triumphed', with feminists turning instead toward workplace equality, including maternity benefits, pay equity and anti-discrimination protections.

Kotiswaran makes a novel attempt in connecting the Wages for Housework movement to its less acknowledged Indian predecessor: the activities of the All India Women's Conference (AIWC). Nearly three decades before Selma James, the 1939 report and 1946 Indian Women's Charter of the AIWC argued that a homemaker's unpaid labour was economically on par with her husband's factory wage. Constituent Assembly member Renuka Ray argued that a housewife was as much a working woman as anyone earning outside the home. This reconnect to the past is a valuable scholarly contribution, as it recasts today's cash transfers not as a foreign import but as an overdue homecoming.

One of the more distinctive features of the book is its attempt to reify the value of women's unpaid work by invoking tort law — how courts have compensated families for a homemaker's lost labour after her death or injury. While Indian legal commentators have flagged pieces of this problem before, what sets this book apart is the scale. The author carries out a review of about 300 judgments spanning five decades. She observes that courts have steadily been doing two things at once — broadening what 'services' actually covers, from basic housework toward a fuller range of domestic and care work, and separately increasing the compensation amounts themselves, through inflation adjustments, more generous multipliers and reduced penalties for a homemaker's labour being informal. She asks the question: If courts can bend over backwards to quantify the contributions of women to their households upon death, why not do the same when they are alive?

The interviews among stakeholders that Kotiswaran and her team carried out in Goa, Assam and West Bengal elicits inputs on live academic debate about what cash transfers actually do to women's employment and education prospects. Kotiswaran lets many different voices — of officials and bureaucrats, husbands and the women themselves — into these debates. The fear that transfers discourage girls' schooling or pull women from the workforce was directly tested in her three states by asking women themselves. The book concedes that the toughest argument against unconditional cash transfers is that they reinforce the gendered division of labour and the fieldwork doesn't produce a unanimous answer either.



TASHI TOBGYAL

AND IT NEVER ENDS
A woman doing domestic chores

The final chapter widens the lens from unpaid reproductive labour to all forms of reproductive labour. The chapter covers three groups in this analysis: nurses and teachers in the formal sector, domestic workers in the informal sector, and government scheme workers (ASHAs, Anganwadi workers, midday meal workers) who are officially classified as volunteers rather than employees. The latter two forms of paid care work are thus devoid of labour protection as well. The proposed 'Care Manifesto' calls for a wide range of initiatives from the state, including surveys to fully account for women's unpaid work, investment in physical infrastructure (water, gas, electricity) and care infrastructure (crèches nurseries, pre-schools) to reduce the burden of unpaid domestic and care work, among others.

The fight around Haasan's proposal eventually died out, even as state after state rolled out similar schemes. The real test of these schemes won't be how much money reaches a woman's bank account but whether her labour ever stops feeling like *niji* and starts being counted as work.

The writer is associate professor, Vellore Institute of Technology, Chennai

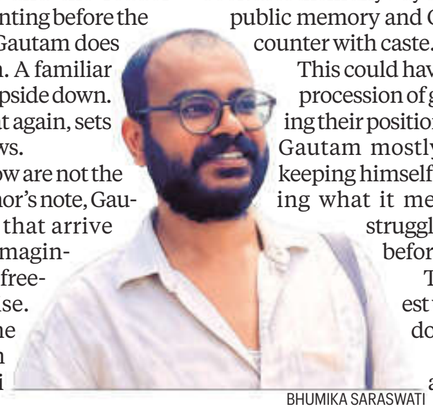
Drawing Caste

In The Blue Book, *Siddhesh Gautam turns caste into an organised system that makes inherited hierarchy visible in new ways*

Sudhakar Singh

AN INVERTED map of the Subcontinent opens *The Blue Book*, and the reader spends a moment reorienting before the story begins. Siddhesh Gautam does not explain the decision. A familiar image has been turned upside down. That it has to be looked at again, sets the terms for what follows.

The dreams that follow are not the sleeping kind. In his author's note, Gautam describes dreams that arrive while awake, through imagination, memory and the freedom to think otherwise. Across eight chapters, he enters conversations with BR Ambedkar, Savitribai Phule, the Buddha and other figures of the anti-caste movement in India. The conversations never actually took place but the book uses them anyway to navigate history, public memory and Gautam's own encounter with caste.



BHUMIKA SARASWATI

This could have easily become a procession of great men delivering their positions to a student but Gautam mostly avoids that by keeping himself in the frame, asking what it means to inherit a struggle that began long before him.

The book is strongest when the drawing does the arguing.

Caste appears as a factory: bodies sorted into compartments, processed, moved along and instructed to follow their caste. A hierarchy usually described in terms of custom, belief or inherited prejudice becomes a system of production, complete with machinery, categories and outcomes.



PENGUIN

CIRCLE BACK
Illustration from *The Blue Book*; (left) Siddhesh Gautam

In another sequence, a paper plane crosses the page and becomes an airstair. Silhouetted figures move towards it beneath the words, "YOUR CASTE IS YOUR INSPIRATION". The language of safety instructions and motivational branding reads differently beside the four-*varna* hierarchy. The promise of mobility sits uneasily within an order that has already decided who belongs where. Caste, in these pages, is less a belief than an arrangement of lives.

It gets more unsettling when the argument reaches desire. "You learn to want what's allowed and forget what you deserve," Gautam writes. Caste, in that line, does not stop at what a person may do. It gets into what a person can reasonably want.



THE BLUE BOOK
SIDDHESH GAUTAM
Penguin
304 pages
₹799

The book also returns to the question of cultural erasure. "If we were there at all, we were reduced to craft and never culture," Gautam writes. A community can be recognised for what it produces and still be denied recognition as a maker of culture, ideas or history. The question is of authorship as much as it is of exclusion: Who is remembered as having made India rather than having worked for it?

That concern gives weight to Gautam's decision to tell the story in images. The blue-and-white palette is spare, often reducing people to silhouettes and leaving large areas of the pages empty. Figures become part of the systems around them, fitting a book concerned with how people are classified and absorbed.

The visual language does not always carry the same force. Gautam sometimes explains in words what the drawing has already made clear, and the argument turns didactic while the dream loses some of its uncertainty. The strongest pages are those that leave something for the reader to work with.

The Blue Book is at its most persuasive when it draws caste as something built and maintained: a map, a machine, a queue, a label. An abstraction becomes a system that the reader can see.

'I am going to be that person you CAN'T GET RID OF'

Actor Parvathy Thiruvothu on bouncing back after the success of Malayalam thriller Pradhama Drishtiya Kuttakkar *and why she calls herself a shapeshifter*

Alaka Sahani

OVER THE past few years, actor Parvathy Thiruvothu has faced incessant trolling and has been stalked online for her outspoken views on misogyny and patriarchy among others. So, she was pleasantly surprised to see this message after the box-office success of her latest theatrical outing, *Pradhama Drishtiya Kuttakkar* (Prima Facie Guilty) — "You have really shown me the art of how I can dislike and admire someone at the same time." Parvathy thought to herself: "Job well done."

The actor, who began her career in 2006 with the Malayalam film *Out of Syllabus*, knows what it is to be disliked. She has faced immense backlash for speaking out against unfair industry practices and standing up for safe work environments. But these days she is "overjoyed" with the critical acclaim she is receiving for Shahad Nilambur's *Pradhama Drishtiya Kuttakkar*, the Malayalam thriller that wowed the audience, has reportedly earned around Rs 50 crore and is now streaming on Netflix.

In the film, Parvathy plays a police officer who gets the job on compassionate grounds after her husband is killed in a police operation. The actor is grateful to Shahad for creating a world in which men and women co-exist, and a female protagonist can take centre stage without the narrative being defined by gender.

> It just so happens that the leading character in the film is a woman, but nothing about the movie was screaming that it's a 'female-oriented film'. For me, that is a true marker of equality

"My artistic being and my political being, which are always intertwined, are celebrating the film's success. It just so happens that the leading character in the film is a woman, but nothing about the movie was screaming that it's a 'female-oriented film'. For me, that is a true marker of equality. The representation on screen should extend to other communities and minorities as well," she says.

The film's success comes close on the heels of the July release of *I, Nobody*, in which Parvathy was cast opposite Prithviraj Sukumaran, and after her debut as a voice artist, dubbing for Kareena Kapoor in the Malayalam version of Meghna Gulzar's crime thriller, *Daayra*.

The recent successes herald the end of a prolonged career lull for Parvathy ever since she became a founding member of the Women in Cinema Collective (WCC) in 2017. The collective was formed following the abduction and assault of a prominent Malayalam actress to combat gender discrimination, and create a safer, more inclusive environment for women working in the film industry.

"Since the formation of the collective, many of our members have had to quit the industry and find other work so that they can pay their bills. I am one of the lucky ones and one of the more privileged ones who had the wherewithal to sit tight and wait."









RECLAIMING THE SPOTLIGHT
(Clockwise from left) Parvathy; in her recent film *Pradhama Drishtiya Kuttakkar*; Hindi debut *Qarib Qarib Singlle*, and *I, Nobody*

And wait she did. But she didn't back down.

"How can you starve an artist who has hopefully proven herself artistically and through box-office success? How is a system so strong that they can isolate you like that? So, it became even more of a vengeance for me. I thought, 'If you guys are so sure that this can be done to people who speak up, I am going to be that person you cannot get rid of'," says the actor.

After years of struggle, Parvathy can finally see the end of the tunnel. "When that happens, you try to make the most of it before you encounter the next tunnel."

'Could you not just be quiet for five minutes?'

On her relationship with her audience, she prefers to call it magical. "To value every buck they spend at the theatre, I show up with utmost honesty and determination to give the best of myself. That's a promise." She even pays heed to their feedback. "Some of them don't like some of the movies that I've done. I listen to them like a curious anthropologist. I find it extremely fascinating how each one of my works, or movies in general, impacts people, society in general," she says. The actor, who completed two decades in films this year, is part of Shimit Amin's next *Captain India* that features Kartik Aaryan.

About her early films, Parvathy says, it seemed like love alone shaped the dramatic arc of her characters. "I wondered what all these women might want to do in life apart from seeking love," she says.

A shift occurred around the time she was cast in Anjali Menon's *Bangalore Days* (2014) — in an ensemble cast featuring Fahadh Faasil, Nazriya Nazim, Dulquer Salmaan and Nivin Pauly, Parvathy stood out as the wheelchair-bound and stubbornly independent RJ Sarah.

Meatier roles, and critical acclaim, followed, with films like *Ennu Ninte Moideen* (2015), based on a real-life story about star-crossed lovers; the survival thriller *Take-Off* (2017), for which Parvathy won a National Film Award—Special mention; *Qarib Qarib Singlle* (2017) which marked her Hindi debut, opposite Irrfan; and *Uyare* (2019) about an aviation student who survives an acid attack.

"I manifested far too hard (for intense roles) and the universe took it seriously," says Parvathy. Now she wants to send out a message that she is seeking some romantic and lighthearted movies as well.

The actor works in five languages — Malayalam, Telugu, Tamil, Kannada and Hindi — but her relationship with her Malayalam audience is unique. "What's really interesting is that most of the Malayali audience especially — I have to underline that — are irritated with me because I won't keep quiet about patriarchy, how it continues to win, and how we (women) are expected to shrink. In every capacity possible, I'll drag patriarchy out and I'll chop it up publicly. There are times they have said, 'Could you not just be quiet for five minutes so that we can maybe give you a chance and like you'?" says Parvathy, who was born in Kerala's Atholi, Kozhikode, and now divides her time between Mumbai and Kerala.

"Right now, I'm doing one film each in Malayalam, Telugu and Hindi, simultaneously. My brain is in the form of a kaleidoscope as I explore different cultures, languages and genres," says Parvathy, who is part of *Storm*, a thriller series produced by Hrithik Roshan's HRX Films, *Dhootha* Season 2 as well as upcoming projects of Don Palathara and Revathy.

The Band of Women Who Kept Her Going

She may be basking in the success of her recent outings but the road to here was long. It was the company of women that kept her on track. Women of the Malayalam film industry who stood united in a rare show of strength, demanding a formal study on the working conditions of women in the film industry, which led to the formation of the Justice Hema Committee.

"Being together is a conscious choice," says Parvathy. "Patriarchy teaches you to isolate yourself from other women, in success and in failure. We had to relearn a whole language of how it is to show up for each other. We had meetings where we spoke about, 'Hey, what does it look like for us to constantly be the wind beneath each other's wings'?"

Though the members of WCC did not know how to do it, they were certain that they had to stand together and support each other. "It felt like we were newborns.

> How can you starve an artist who has hopefully proven herself artistically and through box-office success? How is a system so strong that they can isolate you like that? So, it became even more of a vengeance for me

When we are told that women show up for each other, we also have to acknowledge the fact that it's not like we were given a manual that others missed out on. We had to write it ourselves. That takes a lot of work. It takes a lot of social capital away from you. It also makes you question, 'Why the hell are we doing this?' You become extremely cynical about many things in the process, but you continue doing it until it starts making sense."

Today, when people from other industries ask Parvathy how they did it, her answer is: "By doing it and by being clear about why we're doing it."

As an actor, however, Parvathy wishes to cast her net wide. "I want to be omnipresent. My aim is: I want to be present in all industries, in different languages, wherever the work seems exciting. What a humble ambition to have, right?," she laughs.

This kind of momentum may not always exist for an actor. It didn't exist for her two years ago. So, Parvathy wants to make the most of it. But if the audience expects anything predictable from her, they are in for a disappointment. "In my Instagram bio, I call myself a shapeshifter. I'll be constantly in search of trying something new. If you see me falling, then you'll also see me getting up and walking and trying again," she says.

Devoted to Dance

Reclusive Kathak exponent Roshan Kumari, part of the celebrated trinity of Sitara Devi and Damayanti Joshi and best remembered for her nine-minute performance in Satyajit Ray's Jalsaghar, *died this week in Mumbai*

Suanshu Khurana

IN ONE of Indian cinema's finest dance sequences, Kathak exponent Roshan Kumari enters zamindar Biswambhar Roy's (Chhabi Biswas) sprawling music room with a glittering chandelier and performs a complex piece before a giant, ornate mirror. This is a nine-minute sequence in Satyajit Ray's *Jalsaghar* (1958), the auteur's reflection on a fading aristocratic culture built around music, dance and patronage.

Roshan, only 19 then, had presented a traditional *chaturang*, her heavy ghungroos and immaculate footwork matching the intricate rhythm with precision. But what makes the *Jalsaghar* dance sequence remarkable is not just its technical brilliance. Ray, who also cast Begum Akhtar in another section, wanted a Kathak performance that went beyond the familiar signatures of the form. So he turned to sitar giant Ustad Vilayat Khan, also the composer for the film. Khan suggested Roshan, then a young disciple of Jaipur gharana exponent Pandit Sunder Prasad. Ray also put four cameras to track her every movement in the scene.

Roshan, who belonged to the celebrated Kathak trinity of her generation along with Sitara Devi and Damayanti Joshi, passed away on October 5 due to age-related issues. She was 88 and was buried at Santa Cruz Kabrasthan in Mumbai, the next day. A quiet funeral, it was attended only by a handful of her students, including veteran actor Saira Banu.

While this dance sequence from over half-a-century ago remains memorable and the name Roshan Kumari has been familiar to connoisseurs of Kathak and to those who remember Ray's film, in the last few decades she had largely receded from the dance world and only taught a few of her longtime students, including Mukta Joshi and actor-dancer Nandita Puri at her Bandra residence, where she lived alone. The only other glimpse of her is available in the Films Division documentary Kathak (1970), which explored the history and evolution of the dance form.

{ ROSHAN KUMARI 1937-2026 }

Born to famed singer-actor Zohrabai Ambalewali, one of the more celebrated voices of Hindi film music in the '40s, known especially for the song *Akhiyaan milaake, kiya bharmaake* in director M Sadiq's *Rattan* (1944), Roshan did not follow her mother into singing. When Roshan was growing up in Haryana's Ambala, Zohrabai, who was from a family of professional musicians, was already an artiste for All India Radio and busy recording and shooting. At home, Zohrabai tried to draw her daughter into the world of ragas and *riyaaz*. But Roshan, an only child, was not interested. She was more fascinated by the world of rhythm built by her father, tabla and pakhawaj player Choudhary Faqir Muhammed, who would accompany her for long hours of *riyaaz*, besides helping her develop the rhythmic precision and stamina that would become the hallmark of her dance later. He also answered questions from people about why his girl was extremely talented and needed to dance in public; Muhammad was a sessions artiste in the film industry.



BORN TO DANCE
Roshan Kumari (above), with Nutan on the sets of *Dulhan Ek Raat Ki*



Born to famed singer-actor Zohrabai Ambalewali, Roshan Kumari did not follow her mother into singing. She was more fascinated with the world of rhythm built by her father

"My mother was very good at singing but I didn't think I had the voice... But my relationship with my father was very different. *Baoji* and I had some kind of soul connection. I have loved dance because of his passion for rhythm," Roshan had told us in a rare interview she agreed to do four years ago. She was always uncomfortable with the spotlight, and in the later years preferred to just be in the privacy of her home. And which is also perhaps why her death has been a quiet matter and passed with almost no public attention.

"She made arrangements even for her funeral before passing," says Joshi, about her guru.

Kumari never saw a school and only learned dance. After she began training at the age of five under KS Moray, a noted dance director in the films of the '40s and '50s, she learned from Prasad, who was a student of the legendary Bindadin Maharaj. "I was very sharp and could very quickly pick up what my gurus taught me. During the long practice sessions with my father, I felt as if I would drink up that piece. He worked as hard as I did. His life was completely devoted to my dance," she said.

At a time when women dancers were often denied social respectability, Muhammed and Roshan knew that a Muslim girl performing Krishna Leela, central to Kathak's storytelling, was likely to invite disapproval from the rest of the family as well as the community. But Muhammed wasn't concerned and remained undeterred. After a concert in Kolkata, with 1,500 people in the audience, a 13-year-old Roshan instantly became a star. She was also awarded the Vishwa Unnyyan Samsad Award in 1989 by the Government of Bengal.

Muhammed passed away in 1994, and Roshan decided to never dance again. She felt her dance was incomplete without her father's presence. She, however, continued to teach and choreograph. Some of her notable films as a choreographer include *Dulhan Ek Raat Ki* (1967) *Chaitali* (1975), *Lekin* (1990) and *Sardari Begum* (1996). She was awarded the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1976 and the Padma Shri in 1984.

That Holiday Dish

Manish Mehrotra prepares a no-onion, no-garlic chole bhature from his childhood and tells us why he rarely cooks a recipe straight off a page

Heena Khandelwal



GAJENDRA YADAV



MANISH MEHROTRA'S Delhi home is lived-in: everything has a place but nothing feels curated. It has been shaped by the people who have lived here for years. Today, it is shared by three generations: his mother, Mehrotra and his 19-year-old daughter Adah, currently a line cook in New York.

Her old bedroom is now a storeroom for his tools and the things he picks up on his travels. They video call every day. "She tells me if she got scolded or if she burnt her hand, and I tell her about my day," he says.

As one who is always excited about new tools, in his heavy kit are moulds, cutters, fish-bone tweezers and a zester with a tiny brush for zesting at the table. Then there is his Sujata mixer, which goes with him when he travels on tours, even to pop-ups in Switzerland.

The refrigerator is covered with photographs of him with Adah and his late wife, Vindhya, who died during Covid.

On the morning we visit, he is in the kitchen making chole bhature, and has already got rasmalai for desserts.

CHEF AT HOME

Patna wala *chole*

Growing up in a joint family in Patna and the younger of two brothers, Mehrotra spent his days playing cricket and reading Amar Chitra Katha, Phantom and Mandrake comics. At home, life revolved around food. "There wasn't much beyond television and food," he says. "We made food, watched TV, made some more food. With music, that was the only entertainment." Since most of the family were strict vegetarians, meals meant dal, chawal, chapati, two sabzis and raita. Meat could only be eaten outside the house. Eggs were only allowed on the terrace, cooked on a separate kerosene stove with separate utensils.

Festivals brought the kitchen alive. Janmashtami was the big one: paneer sabzi, two kinds of coconut barfi and a khoya barfi, all made at home. There was cold, thickened milk with makhana and dry fruits and pooris and kachoris. The family would decorate the *jhankis* (tableaux) with fairy lights.

Chole bhature was "*chhutti ke din wali dish*". The chickpeas are boiled with *hing, methi, kasuri methi, imli, amchoor, javitri* and *jaiphal*. There is also dried *amla*, "which nobody else puts in."

SOUL CURRY (Above) Chef Manish Mehrotra on his terrace at his home in Delhi; in his kitchen

The dough rests for an hour-and-a-half, before the poori-like bhaturas are rolled out. He grinds the dry masala in his Sujata mixer. There's no onion, tomato or garlic in the chole that is served with roasted and spiced aloo on the side.

The recipe isn't really his mother's, he admits, adding that he was never one of those kids who spent their time in the kitchen. In fact, he had never cooked as a boy. Hotel school was actually a way out. "It was either that or running my father's petrol pump," he says.

The family hesitated over sending him to Bombay, which seemed a frightening city for a boy from Bihar. But his elder brother stood up for him: "The whole world goes, why can't he?"

So in 1993, Mehrotra moved to Bombay to study at Dadar Catering College. He picked the kitchen partly because his struggle with English made front-office work difficult. "But it taught me that you could be from a small town or a Hindi-medium background but you can do it."

Next came the four years at Thai Pavilion under Chef Ananda Solomon, who taught him to read a guest's mind. Then Delhi, followed by four years in London, which he likens to "Hamleys for a kid". There, he held his first live lobster and had foie gras.

In 2009, he opened Indian Accent, helping redefine what Indian fine dining could look like. Nostalgia, he says, was part of it from day one. That sensibility continues at Delhi's Nisaba.

BEFORE OPENING NISABA IN DELHI, MEHROTRA TOOK A YEAR OFF DURING WHICH HE GREW PLANTS LEMONGRASS, BASIL, KARELA, HAZARA NARANGI AND LEMON ON HIS TERRACE

Before its opening in January this year, Mehrotra took a year off and did "nothing". He fixed the house and began growing plants on the terrace, which now has lemongrass, basil, karela, hazara narangi and lemon.

There's always room for a book

Much of his inspiration comes from books. "I only buy recipe books. The rest, people gift," he says. Every month, he goes online for new releases. He rarely cooks a recipe straight off the page. "You look at it once and something clicks in your head."

But a few books are eternal favourites with Mehrotra. *The Flavour Thesaurus* by Niki Segnit is one. Another is an early (Yotam) Ottolenghi book on salads that aren't built on lettuce. A third is a fish butchery book he recommends to young chefs working with seafood. He keeps every issue of *Art Culinaire Magazine* for photography and plating ideas.

His own *Indian Accent Restaurant Cookbook* (2016) still makes him proud. Two more are in the works: one on Nisaba-style recipes and another on chaat alone, which he hopes will release next year. "There isn't a dedicated chaat cookbook," he says. He has already catalogued over 60 varieties, including singhara ki chaat, made with boiled, pureed water chestnut.

As we talk, the table is ready. The bhatures — smaller than their restaurant counterparts — are ready. The table is laid with fine crockery, with bowls of chole, rice and a simple onion-and-cucumber salad.

We are curious, what does a chef eat after a long day at work? "Bhel puri, a cheese sandwich or Maggi. Always soupy and always made by me." Maggi?" We express surprise. "If chefs say they don't eat Maggi, they are lying," he says.

CHOLE

INGREDIENTS

For the chole: 300 g dried chickpeas (soaked overnight), 1 dried red chilli, 2 black cardamom pods, 1 bay leaf, 1 tsp baking soda, 3 tea bags, salt, water, as needed

For the chole masala: 2 black cardamom pods, 2 tsp black peppercorns, 3 green cardamom pods, 2 pieces mace, 2 tsp dried fenugreek leaves, 1-inch cinnamon stick, ½ nutmeg, 3 cloves, 10 fenugreek seeds, 1 tbsp ground coriander, ½ tsp asafoetida, 1 tsp Kashmiri red chilli powder, 1 tsp ground cumin

To finish: 4 tbsp ghee, 5 tbsp tamarind paste, ½ cup reserved chickpea liquid (add more as needed), 1 tbsp finely julienned ginger

METHOD

- Drain and rinse the soaked chickpeas. Add to a pressure cooker with the dried chilli, black cardamom, bay leaf, salt, baking soda and tea bags. Cover with water and pressure cook until very tender. Let the pressure release naturally. The chickpeas should mash easily between your fingers. Discard the tea bags and reserve the chickpea liquid
- For the masala, dry-roast the whole spices and dried fenugreek leaves over low heat until fragrant. Add the ground coriander, asafoetida, chilli powder and cumin, stir briefly and take off the heat before the powders burn. Cool completely, then grind to a fine powder
- For finishing, heat 1 tbsp ghee in a heavy-bottomed pan. Add the chickpeas, masala and tamarind paste and toss gently. Add ½ cup chickpea liquid and simmer over low heat until the chickpeas are coated in a thick, glossy gravy, adding more liquid if needed. Stir in the ginger and remaining 3 tbsp ghee. Taste and adjust the salt
- Serve hot with puri, bhatura or rice, with sliced onions, chutneys and pickle on the side

ADVERTORIAL

The Fjord That Is Not a Fjord



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Open a map of Europe in your mind. Start in the west, with Spain and France, and move east across Italy until you reach the Adriatic Sea, the long, narrow stretch of water that runs between Italy and the land on its far shore. Everything on that eastern shore, and a good deal of what lies behind it, is what many Indian travellers loosely file under Eastern Europe.

Geographers prefer a more precise name, the Balkans, or Southeast Europe: a region of mountains, coastlines, and small countries, shaped by Roman, Venetian, Ottoman, and Austrian rule, and reshaped again by the breakup of Yugoslavia in the 1990s.

Now place three countries on that map. Croatia is the easiest to spot, a crescent that curves around the top of the region and then runs south along the Adriatic for hundreds of kilometres, ending just beyond the walled city of Dubrovnik (or King's Landing for Game of Thrones fans). Tucked behind that coastline is Bosnia and Herzegovina, which touches the sea at only one point, a stretch of roughly twenty kilometres around the town of Neum, a sliver so narrow that it cuts Croatia's own coast in two.

At the very bottom of Croatia's coastline, just past Dubrovnik, sits Montenegro. Zoom in on it. This is a small country of around six hundred thousand people, independent only since 2006, and its name means Black Mountain, a fair description once you see the limestone ranges that rise almost straight out of its shoreline. Albania lies to the southeast, Serbia and Kosovo to the east, and across the water, the ferries from Bari in Italy dock at the port of Bar.

Zoom in once more, to a point near the top of that short Montenegrin coast, and the sea starts doing something unexpected. Instead of running straight, the water turns inland and folds itself into the mountains, squeezing through a channel barely three hundred metres wide into a bay so enclosed and so dramatic that it looks as though it belongs somewhere much further north. That is the Bay of Kotor, roughly two hours by road from Dubrovnik.

I have just returned from there, and I have been trying to describe it to friends ever since, without much success. It is often called the southernmost fjord of Europe, mountains dropping straight into deep blue water, medieval towns wedged onto whatever narrow strip of shoreline the cliffs allow. It genuinely looks like a fjord. There is just one small problem with the description, and it is worth starting there, because it tells you something about how to actually enjoy this trip.

The Bay of Kotor is not a fjord at all. A fjord is carved by a glacier, and no glacier has ever come anywhere near this area. What you are actually looking at is a ria, an ancient river valley that drowned when sea levels rose, leaving behind the same dramatic cliffs and narrow inlets without any of the ice that supposedly makes a fjord a fjord. Geologists have been gently correcting this for years. However, nobody in the tourism industry has any interest in listening, because 'southernmost ria of Europe' was never going to sell a single holiday package.

I like this detail because it captures something true about the whole region. Montenegro looks like one thing from a distance, and rewards you with something else entirely once you get close. And that closeness is exactly where most visitors run into trouble, because from the water, or from a cruise ship deck, or from a quick day trip, Kotor, Perast, Sveti Stefan, and Herceg Novi can genuinely start to blur into one continuous postcard. Stone walls, red roofs, turquoise water, repeat. So today, whether you are planning a trip to Montenegro or not, I want to spend this piece taking you on a geographic roller coaster trying to explain how to actually tell these places apart, and enjoy each one for what it specifically is.



Kotor Is the Fortress

Kotor is the anchor of the bay, and the first thing to understand about it is that it is fundamentally a walled, defended city, built to withstand siege after siege across Byzantine, Venetian, and Ottoman centuries. The old town itself is compact enough to walk in twenty minutes, and that compactness is deceptive. The real experience of Kotor is not inside the walls. It is above them.

The city walls climb the mountainside behind the old town in a series of zigzagging fortifications that stretch for over four kilometres and gain roughly two hundred and eighty metres of elevation, up to the Fortress of Saint John. It is a genuinely demanding climb, over a thousand steps in the heat, but it is also the best way to understand why Kotor sits exactly where it does. From the fortress, the entire bay unfolds below you, the narrow Verige Strait, the outer and inner bays, Perast in the distance. Kotor from above the walls is the whole point.

If the climb feels like too much, the newer Kotor Cable Car solves the same problem differently, an eleven minute ride up to Lovcen, the mountain that watches over the entire bay, with the same sweeping view achieved without a single flight of stairs. Either way, treat Kotor as a city you look down on, not just a city you walk through.

Perast Is the Devotion

Perast is a fifteen minute boat ride from Old Town Kotor, and it could not have a more different personality. Where Kotor is defence, Perast is devotion, a town built by wealthy sea captains who spent their fortunes on Baroque palaces along a single waterfront street, and who left behind one of the most moving stories in the entire Adriatic.

In 1452, two fishermen from Perast are said to have found an icon of the Virgin Mary on a small reef just offshore. What happened next took centuries. Every sailor from Perast who returned safely from a voyage began dropping a stone onto that reef, along with old ships deliberately sunk to add to the mass. Stone by stone, voyage by voyage, the reef grew into an entire island, now home to the church of Our Lady of the Rocks, its walls lined with silver votive plaques left by generations of sailors thanking the Madonna for bringing them home. The island is still expanded on the twenty second of July every year, when the town holds a festival called Fasinada and the whole community rows out to add one more stone to a monument that has been under construction for close to six hundred years.

The correct way to experience Perast, then is to take the five minute boat across to that island, stand inside a church built entirely out of gratitude, and understand that you are looking at the slowest, most patient building project on the entire Adriatic coast.

Sveti Stefan Is the Reinvention

Sveti Stefan sits outside the bay, on the open coast near Budva, about an hour by road from Kotor. It tells yet another kind of story, and it is worth knowing before you arrive, because the island itself is now closed to anyone who is not a paying guest of the resort inside its walls.

It began in 1442 as a fortified fishing village, twelve families sheltering behind stone walls against Ottoman raids, and it stayed exactly that, a working fishing community, for five centuries. Then in the 1950s, the Yugoslav government evicted the remaining residents and rebuilt the entire island as a hotel, preserving the old stone houses on the outside while turning them into luxury suites within. It reopened in 1960 and quickly became one of the most famous resorts on earth, drawing Sophia Loren, Elizabeth Taylor, and Princess Margaret, before falling into decline after Yugoslavia broke apart. The Aman Group eventually restored it, and Novak Djokovic married there in 2014, days after winning Wimbledon.

Because the island itself is off limits without a room booking, the correct way to enjoy Sveti Stefan is from a distance, specifically from the hillside viewpoint above it, or from the pink sand beach directly opposite. What you are looking at is not a village anymore. It is the memory of one, rebuilt into something else entirely, and it photographs best as exactly that, a strange, beautiful object seen from just outside its own walls.

Herceg Novi Is the Garden

Herceg Novi takes us back to the very mouth of the bay, where it meets the open Adriatic. It is the town most visitors see last or skip altogether, and that is a mistake, because it is the most livable of the four. Locals call it the City of Sun, and its old town climbs the hillside in such a steep tangle of staircases that the entire settlement is sometimes nicknamed the city of stairs. Because it spans several distinct microclimates across a short vertical stretch, from Mediterranean palm groves near the sea to alpine forest higher up, gardens here grow an almost improbable mix of plants that have no business sharing the same town. The correct way to enjoy Herceg Novi, then, is to slow down completely, wander uphill from the waterfront with no plan at all, and let its stairways, shaded courtyards, and overgrown gardens reveal the town one terrace at a time.

How to Actually See This Bay

Here, then, is the real argument of this piece. This stretch of coast rewards a very specific kind of attention, because every town along it was built for a different reason, and if you rush through all four in a single day, they do start to look the same.

Give Kotor the climb, ideally in the early morning before the heat and the cruise ship crowds arrive together. Give Perast the boat ride to the island, and if your dates allow it, the festival on the twenty second of July. Look at Sveti Stefan rather than trying to enter it, and let it be the strange, reinvented thing it actually is. And save an unhurried afternoon for Herceg Novi, with no fixed itinerary beyond wandering uphill until you get tired of staircases.

Do all four in one rushed day, and you will come home with photographs of stone walls and turquoise water that could have been taken almost anywhere on the Adriatic. Give each town the specific attention it was actually built to deserve, and you come home instead with four completely different stories, a fortress, a devotion, a reinvention, and a garden, all within an hour or so of the same impossibly beautiful ria that everyone insists on calling a fjord. That's my Montenegro trip for you, see you next week…

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Vol VII, Issue No. 9. Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 RNI Regn. No. DELENG/2018/76281. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida -201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 &10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9&10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd.,Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone:01206651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi):Monojit Majumdar** ** Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®

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